

ITEM 16

באמא הבא]ה ל...]	בבואתך	4:3
אמות ארבע]ין כסף		4:4
כב 55		4:5

- 4:3 In the canal that goe[s to ...], as you come
 4:4 for[ty] cubits, (there are) 55
 4:5 k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(4:3) [...ל]הּ הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה בְּאֵמָהּ, “In/at/by a/the water canal that goe[s/com]es/-enter[s to ...]” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the *ʾm* which enters (?) [...]” ALLEGRO: [... (?) הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה, באמא, “In the water conduit which en[te]rs (?) [...]”¹ MILIK: [...ל]הּ הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה, באמא, “In the canal, which le[ads] towards [...]”² LURIE: באמא [...ל]הּ הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה, “In the water canal which is coming [from a certain place].”³ BEYER: באמא הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה לֹר, “In the water canal that lead[s to (the mentioned cistern)].”⁴ WISE follows Lurie, while the other scholars agree with Milik.⁵

Due to a lacuna in the middle of the top of column four, the place name is lost. The possible partial restorations are as follows. הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה בְּאֵמָהּ הַזֶּה אֵלֶּל [...ל], “in/at/by a/the canal that goe[s to ...]”; and הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה בְּאֵמָהּ הַזֶּה מִן (מְוִיָּה), “in/at/by a/the canal that comes[s from ...]” (cf. Lurie).

These suggestions can be compared to the possible restorations of אֵמָת הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה אֵלֶּל, “the water canal [that goes to] Secacah”; and אֵמָת הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה מִן (מְוִיָּה) הַבְּאֵר הַזֶּה, “the water canal [that comes from] Secacah” (see #21, 5:1).

(4:3) בְּבֹאֲתְךָ וּבֹאֲתִי, “as you (sg. masc.) go/come/enter,” occurs again in the Scroll (11:13), and so its variant בְּבֹאֲתְךָ וּבֹאֲתִי, “as you (sg. masc.) go/-come/enter” (10:5).

Both terms have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “in thine entering” (4:3); “in thine entrance” (11:13); “as thou enterest” (10:5). ALLEGRO:

1 Allegro, 39, 143 n. 81; Allegro^{rev}, 22.

2 Milik, 288-89; Milik^E, 140.

3 Lurie, 80.

4 Beyer, 226-27.

5 Wise, 193; Pixner, 347; Wolters, 38-39; Garcia Martinez, 461; Vermes, 375. (Regarding this item, there are minor typographical errors in some of these authors works.)

בביאתך, “as you go in/enter/approach”; כבואך, “as you enter.”⁶ MILIK: בביאתך, “proceeding” and “where you enter”; בבואך, “going down.”⁷ LURIE renders both בביאתך and בבואך as כבואך (i.e., “as you go/enter”).⁸ PIXNER: בביאתך, “as you proceed/pass”; בבואך, “as you go.”⁹ BENDAVID: בביאתך (MH) is the same as בבואך (BH).¹⁰ SHARVIT: בביאתך; the term ביאה is both Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew.¹¹ WOLTERS: בביאתך, “on your way in”; בבואך, “as you go in.”¹² GARCIA MARTINEZ: “when you go forward”; “at the entrance”; “going.”¹³ BEYER: both בביאתך and בבואך are rendered as “when you enter.”¹⁴ VERMES: “when you enter”; “where you enter”; “going.”¹⁵ WISE: all three cases, “as you enter.”¹⁶

It is also possible to read the word in question as בביאתך, “at your entry/-entrance” (preposition *bet*, ביאתך, fem., from the root באה, “to come/go,” and sg. sec. pers. masc. suffix). The noun ביאתך, “entrance,” appears elsewhere in the Scroll: ביאתו, “its (masc.) entrance” (2:12, 12:1), ביאתך, “its (fem.) entrance” (3:9), and בביאתך, “in (the) entrance” (5:13; alt.). ביאתך occurs once in the Masoretic Text (Ezek. 8:5), but it is commonly used in the Talmudim and Midrashim. E.g.,

(Scripture says,) “Upon the door posts of ביתך (your house)” (Deut. 6:9; that is,) upon the right (door post) and as you enter (your house); perhaps it is not so, rather upon the right side ביציאתך (at the exit [of your house])? Therefore the Torah says, “Upon the door posts of ביתך (your house),” (that is,) upon ביאתך (your entrance) of the right (door post) as you enter (your house) (Sifre on Deut. 6:9; cf. b. Men. 34a, a baraita).

(Scripture says,) “You shall be blessed כבואך (when you coming), you shall be blessed בצאתך (when you leaving)” (Deut. 28:6; that is,) יציאתך (your exit) from the world shall be כביאתך (like your entry), ביאתך (your entry) is without sin, so shall be יציאתך (your exit) without sin (b. B.M. 107a).

The first citation explains ביתך, “your house,” as if it were written ביאתך, “your entrance,” while the second equates כבואך, “your coming,” with ביאתך, “your entrance.”¹⁷ Moreover, in these citations both ביאתך and its

6 Allegro, 39, 51, 53; Allegro^{rev}, 22, 25-26.

7 Milik, 289, 296-97, 231 B-16b; Milik^E, 140-42.

8 Lurie, 80 and n.2, 114, 122. There is a typographical error in line 11:3.

9 Pixner, 347, 354, 356.

10 Bendauid 1, 99.

11 “Iyyunim,” 132.

12 Wolters, 38-39, 50-51, 52-53.

13 Garcia Martinez, 461, 463.

14 Beyer, 226-27, 230-32.

15 Vermes, 375, 377.

16 Wise, 193, 196-97.

17 Wartski discusses some of these Midrashic Halakhot, as well as the possible pronunciations of ביתך and ביאתך; *Lešon hamMidrašim* (1970), 195-96.

antonym **יֵצִיאָה**, “exit,” are used. The latter occurs in the Scroll, **עַל פִּי יֵצִיאַת**, “above the mouth of the exit of the water” (see #32, 7:14).

As mentioned above, **בּוֹאָתְךָ** and **בּוֹאָתְךָ** are variants of **בּוֹאָךְ** and **בּוֹאָךְ**, “as you come/go/enter.” The first letter, a preposition, can be read either as a *kaf* or a *bet* without changing its basic meaning; cf. the possible readings of **בּוֹאָה**, **בּוֹאָה**, **בְּבִיאָה** (see #24, 5:13), **בְּלָגִין וְכָלִגִּין** (see #4, 1:9), and **בְּכָלִי דָמַע**, **בְּכָלִי דָמַע** (see #50, 11:1).

In the Masoretic Text **בּוֹאָךְ**, also spelled as **בּוֹאָכָה** (inf. plus sec. pers. masc. suffix), “you come/go” or “your coming/going,” occurs 28 times. However, in a dozen cases **בּוֹאָךְ** is an idiom having a directional meaning, “until, as far as.” Both forms **בְּבִיאָךְ** (Deut. 28:6,19; 2 Sam. 3:13) and **כְּבִיאָךְ** (1 Sam. 10:5; Jer. 51:61) with the meaning, “as you come,” occur in the Masoretic Text.

בּוֹאָתְךָ and **בּוֹאָתְךָ** are expanded forms of **בּוֹאָךְ** and **בּוֹאָךְ**, with an extra *taw* before the final *kaf*. Four times in the Masoretic Text forms of **בּוֹא** have extra *taws*: (1) **תְּבִיאָתָהּ** (Deut. 33:16) vs. **תְּבִיאָה** - **תְּבִיאָה** (e.g., Gen. 41:50, 49:6), “it (fem.) will come”; (2) **תְּבִיאָתְךָ** (Job 22:21) vs. **תְּבִיאָךְ** (Ezek. 32:11), “it (fem.) will come upon you (sg.)”; (3) **וְתִבְאָתִי** (*ketiv*, 1 Sam. 25:34) vs. **וְתִבְאִי** (Ezek. 16:7), “and you (fem. sg.) will come” or “and you (fem. sg.) came”; and (4) **וְתִבְאָתָהּ** (*qeri*, 1 Sam. 25:34) vs. **וְתִבְאוּ** (Ezek. 22:4), “and she will come” or “and she came.”¹⁸ Likewise, Mishnaic Hebrew uses **בָּאָתָהּ** (e.g., t. ‘A.Z. 5:3) and **בָּאָתָהּ** (e.g., b. Git. 32a), instead of **בָּאָהּ** (e.g., Gen. 16:17), “she came.” These unusual forms in the Masoretic Text, Copper Scroll, and Mishnaic Hebrew indicate that there are two forms, **בּוֹא** and the expanded **בּוֹאָתָהּ**. The presence of **בּוֹאָתְךָ** (twice) and **בּוֹאָךְ** in the Scroll disprove the contention of those who consider **תְּבִיאָתָהּ**, **תְּבִיאָתְךָ**, **וְתִבְאָתִי**, and **וְתִבְאָתָהּ** as errors in the Masoretic Text.¹⁹

בּוֹאָךְ and **בּוֹאָתְךָ** when used as idioms, may not be infinitives with a second person masculine suffix. Rather, the final *kaf* could be a nominative formation. This suggestion can be compared with the problematic term **עֲרֻכָּךְ**, “wows of valuation,” which occurs 25 times in the Masoretic Text (21 in Lev. Ch. 27). Often **עֲרֻכָּךְ** cannot be explained as the masculine noun **עֲרֻךְ** - **עֲרֻךְ**, “value, valuation,” plus a second person suffix.²⁰ Mishnaic Hebrew

18 According to Radak, **תְּבִיאָתָהּ** is a conglomeration of the future **תְּבִיאָהּ** and the past **בָּאָתָהּ**, indicating “the agility of her coming,” and so is the *ketiv* **תְּבִיאָתִי** (cf. Rid). Ibn-Ezra compares **תְּבִיאָתָהּ** (= **עֲרֻכָּתָהּ** (= **עֲרֻכָּהּ**), thus it is the same as **תְּבִיאָתָהּ** (Deut. 33:16). Gordis (155, 202 n. 574) lists **וְתִבְאָתִי** and **וְתִבְאָתָהּ** among those cases where both, the *ketiv* and *qeri* are “unsatisfactory,” and adds that the *qeri* is an “unform.” In addition, perhaps the unusual formation of **בָּאָתָהּ** (Ps. 44:18), which is explained by Ibn-Ezra as **בָּאָתָהּ עָלֵינוּ**, “it (fem.) came upon us,” is derived from **בָּאָתָהּ עָלֵינוּ**. If so, it may be an archaic form.

19 See BY 1, 477-78 n. 6, 480 n. 2.

20 In the verse **וְאֵשׁ בְּעֶרְכּוֹ נָגַשׁ אֶת הַכֶּסֶף וְאֵת הַזָּהָב**, “(Jehoiakim) exacted the silver and the

employs the term עֶרֶךְ - עֶרְךָ (sg., pl. עֶרְכִּין), rather than עֶרְכֶּךָ. 'Arakhin is also the name of the Talmud tractate dealing with vows of valuation.²¹

Finally, פֶּתַח (masc.), "opening, entrance," a synonym of בִּיָּאָה, occurs seven times in the Scroll. Especially is interesting their similar usage, בִּיָּאָתוּ (2:12, 12:1) - בִּיָּאָתָה (= בִּיָּאָתָה, 3:9), vs. פֶּתַחוּ (1:11) - פֶּתַחָא (= פֶּתַחָה; see #60, 12:10).²²

(4:4) אַמּוֹת אַרְבַּעַיִן, "for[ty] cubits" — In the drawings, the bottom of the *bet* touches an almost V-shaped lacuna of three-four letter spaces. There are some differences between the drawings. BAKER^{dr}: A vertical line hangs down from the top left side of the *bet*. MILIK^{dr}: Between the *bet* and the lacuna there is a letter fragment that seems to be the right 'hand' of an *ayin*, running into the lacuna. ALLEGRO^{dr}: There is no trace of this fragment. The photographs of the Zuckermans support the drawings of Baker and Milik. After the lacuna there is an empty space of two-three letter sizes. MILIK^{dr}: The second half of this space has a dotted *taw*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: Dotted lines show where the opening cuts were made. One of these cuts Column 4, leaving about two-thirds to the right and one-third to the left side. Apparently, this cut goes through the left leg of Milik's dotted *taw* (see "The Drawings" in the Discussion). The next word is כֶּסֶף; the final *pe* has an unusual but different shapes in the drawings of Baker and Milik, and that of Allegro.

This phrase has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO and LURIE: אַמּוֹת [... אַרְבַּעַיִן], "four[...] cubits."²³ MILIK and PIXNER: אַמּוֹת אַרְבַּעַיִן וְאַחַת, "for[ty-one] cubits."²⁴ WOLTERS: אַמּוֹת אַרְבַּעַיִן, "four cubits [...]."²⁵ WISE follows Allegro, while the rest of the scholars agree with Milik.²⁶

The possible restorations for this phrase are as follows. BAKER^{dr} and ALLEGRO^{dr}: אַמּוֹת אַרְבַּעַיִן, "four[...] cubits," cf. אַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ, "three cubits"

gold from from each man according to his value" (2 Kgs 23:35), עֶרְכוֹ, "his value," is עֶרְךָ plus the third person masculine suffix י-).

21 This suggestion is similar but not identical with the unusual forms in Biblical Aramaic, דִּינִיָּא וְאַפְרִסְתִּיָּא טַרְפִּלִּיָּא אֶפְרָסִיָּא אֶרְכִּיָּא בְּבִלְיָא שׁוֹשְׁנִיָּא דְּהִיָּא עֶלְמִיָּא (according to the *qeri*), "the Dinites, the Apharesattechites, the Tarpelites, the Apharesites, the Archevites, the Babylonians, the Shusanchites, the Dehites, the Elamites" (Ezra 4:9; *Tanach*). This list has two cases of extra *kaf* before the Aramaic plural definite masculine ending, וְאַפְרִסְתִּיָּא and שׁוֹשְׁנִיָּא. The latter is explained as gentilic, i.e., Susians, people originating from Susan, Persia, and it is an Old-Persian borrowing (cf. BDB, 1114b-1115a). Rabbeinu Tam says that אִיטָלְקִי (MH) means "from Italy of Greece," i.e., Byzantine, where the *qof* is like the *kaf* in שׁוֹשְׁנִיָּא, from שׁוֹשֵׁן, Susan (Tosaphot on b. Qid. 2a), i.e., gentilic forms.

22 The other occurrences of פֶּתַח in the Scroll are: 1:8, 6:2, 6:3, 6:9, 10:10.

23 Allegro, 39, 143 n. 82; Allegro^{rev}, 22; Lurie, 80. Cf. Allegro^{pr}: "four cubits [...]."

24 Milik, 288-89; Milik^E, 140; Pixner, 347.

25 Wolters, 38-39.

26 Wise, 193; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 226-27; Vermes, 375.

(1:14), אַמֹות שֵׁשׁ, “six cubits” (1:12); and אַמֹות אַרְבָּע[ין], “four[ty] cubits.” MILIK^{dr}: אַמֹות אַרְבַּע [עֶסְרִי] ה, “fou[rtee]n cubits,” cf. אַמֹות שְׁתֵּימ עֶסְרִי, “twelve cubits” (6:13); אַמֹות אַרְבַּע [וּמֵאָה], “hundred and four cubits,” cf. כִּכְרִין תִּשְׁעֵ מֵאָה, “nine hundred talents” (1:8, alt.); and אַמֹות אַרְבַּע [מֵאָה]-ת, “four [hund]red cubits,” cf. כִּכְרִין אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת (7:7), and כִּכְרִין תִּשְׁעֵ מֵאוֹת, “nine hundred talents” (1:8).

Since in this item the measurement follows בְּבֹאֲתָךְ, “as you come,” it must describe a distance, rather than depth. Four, fourteen, forty, forty-one, hundred and four, and even four hundred cubits are acceptable distances. Should the reference be depth, only “four cubits” is plausible (cf. Allegro).

(4:4-5) 55 כֶּסֶף כֹּכ, “55 k(arsh) of silver” — The drawings after כֹּכ differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: Two *reš*-shaped numerals of 20, a small fragment that may be the right side of the numeral 10, a V-shaped lacuna, two vertical lines or *waws*, and an *’alef*. ALLEGRO^{dr}: Two *reš*-shaped numerals of 20, a small fragment that seems to be the right lower part of a *bet*, *kaf*, *mem*, *nun*, or *pe*, a V shaped lacuna, a fragment that looks like a narrow and small size *šin*, a *dalet* or *reš*, and an *’alef*.

This phrase has been interpreted as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “silver, *kk*” ALLEGRO: כֶּסֶף כֹּכ [ב]שָׂא 40+, “40+ talents of silver (in a) chest”; the two numerals 20 are “defective.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “40 talents of silver (in) a chest (?)”.²⁷ MILIK: 55 כֶּסֶף כֹּכ, “55 talents of silver.”²⁸ Apparently Milik reads the numerals as follows: 20 + 20 + 10 (the fragment) + 2 (the two vertical lines) + 3 (the *’alef* shaped sign of three lines) = 55. LURIE: כֶּסֶף כֹּכ [ב]שָׂא 40, “(hidden) [in] a chest forty talent of silver.”²⁹ The other scholars agree with Milik.³⁰

According to Allegro’s drawing, the reading is כֶּסֶף כֹּכ 40 בְּשָׂא/בְּשָׂא, “40 silver k(arsh) in a/the carrying chair,” or “40 silver k(arsh) in a/the box.” This would be a third case of the term שָׂא, “carrying chair, box,” in the Scroll (see #1, 1:3).

Since in several cases Milik recognized the proper numerals while Allegro did not, this would suggest that Milik’s interpretation is the correct one. However, since the drawings do differ, one must study all possible readings. Regarding the abbreviation כֹּכ, see Appendix A.

27 Allegro, 39, 134 n. 5, 143 n. 83 (the question mark after the numeral 40 instead of the plus sign is a typographical error; cf. “3+,” 4:14; also in the note 30 is a typographical error for 40); Allegro^{rev}, 22.

28 Milik, 288-89; Milik^E, 140.

29 Lurie, 80 and n. 3 ([בשָׂא]) is a typographical error for [ב]שָׂא; also in the translation כֶּסֶף is missing).

30 Pixner, 347; Wolters, 38-39; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer, 226-27; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193.

ITEM 17

בין שני הבתין שבעמק עכון 4:6
 באמצע חפון אמות שלוש 4:7
 שם שני דודין מלאין כסף 4:8

- 4:6 Between the two buildings which are in the Valley of
 Achor,
 4:7 at their center, three cubits (deep) there are
 4:8 buried two pots full of silver (shekels).

COMMENTARY

(4:6) בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבְּתִין, "Between the two buildings" — Regarding the third word, the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: הַכּוֹנִין, הַבִּינִין, הַבוֹנִין. ALLEGRO^{dr}: הַבְּתִין. Allegro's *taw* appears to be the same as Baker's and Milik's *yod/waw* and *nun* connected at the top. The photographs of the ZUCKERMANS seem to support the drawings of Baker and Milik.

The third word without the definite article has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: "ben trees" (i.e., בִּינִין). ALLEGRO: בְּדִין, "oil-presses (?)." There is confusion between *taw* and *he*, and between *dalet* and *reš*. Alternatively בְּתִין. ALLEGRO^{rev}: "buildings (?)" (i.e., בְּתִין).¹ MILIK: בִּינִין, "tamarisk trees," the plural of בֵּין; cf. בִּינָא in Talmudic Aramaic (b. Giṭ. 68b) and in Syriac.² LURIE: בְּתִין, "buildings."³ THORION: בִּינִין, but it is possible to read as בְּתִין.⁴ WISE: "boulders."⁵ PIXNER and GARCIA MARTINEZ follow Allegro^{rev} and Lurie, while WOLTERS, BEYER, and VERMES agree with Milik.⁶

Allegro's drawing clearly reads הַבְּתִין (pl. of בֵּית, masc., plus the prefixed definite article), "the houses." Regarding בֵּית, see #7, 2:3.

The drawings by Baker and Milik can be read, vocalized, and interpreted many ways. Except the last two suggestions, the first *nun* is considered as a

1 Regarding the *ben* tree, Allegro^{pr} refers to ZAW 63 (1951), 154-56; 64 (1952), 249-51, and to his letter (probably to Harding) dated January 15, 1956. Allegro, 39, 143 n. 84; Allegro^{rev}, 22.

2 Milik, 288-89, 242 C-47; Milik^E, 140. שׁוֹרְבִינָא וּבִינָא are certain trees (b. Giṭ. 68b; see Jastrow, 163a; AC 2, 56b; KS, 96a; Karo, 28a).

3 Lurie, 81 n. 1. Lurie does not mention Allegro's alternate reading of בְּתִין.

4 Thorion, 169, 173-74 (on page 173, HYWNYN is a typographical error for HBYNYN).

5 Wise, 193.

letter interchange for *reš*. Moreover, since this problematic plural noun is preceded by the masculine *שְׁנֵי*, “two (of),” the possible nouns must also be masculine.

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבּוֹרִין/הַבּוֹנִין = *בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבּוֹרִין*, “between the two uncultivated fields” — *בּוֹרִים* - *בּוֹרִים*, the plural of *בּוֹר* (MH), “uncultivated field” (e.g., m. Pe’ah 2:1; Num. Rabbah 3).

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבְּיִנִין = *בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבְּיִרִין*, “between the two wells/cisterns” — *בְּיִרִים*, the plural of *בְּיָר* (*qeri*, Jer. 6:7, a *hapax legomenon*), “well, cistern, pit.” The Targum (TO, PsJ) of *בְּיָר* (fem.) is *בְּיָר* (e.g., Gen. 26:21), and of *בְּיָרִין* (pl.) is *בְּיָרִין* (Gen. 26:15).⁷ Likewise, *וְכָל הַבְּיִרִין* and its Targum *וְכָל בְּיָרִין* could mean “and all the wells” (2 Sam. 20:14).⁸

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבְּיִנִין, “between the two structures” — *בְּיִנִין* is a *plene* spelling for *בְּיָנִין* (sg., Ezek. 40:5).⁹ Since there is no plural form of *בְּיָנִין* in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew (*בְּיָנִים* and *בְּיָנוֹת* are post-Mishnaic Hebrew forms), it may be a collective noun, and may refer to more than one structure; cf. the collective *בְּקָר*, “cattle, ox” (dual gender); e.g., *שְׁנֵי עֶשְׂרֵי בְּקָר*, “and twelve oxen” (Num. 7:3), vs. the rarely used plural *בְּקָרִים* (2 Chron. 4:3).¹⁰

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכּוֹנִין = *בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכּוֹרִים*, “between the two furnaces” — *כּוֹנִין* may be a variant of *כּוֹרִים*, plural of *כּוֹרִיב* (masc., BH, MH), “smelting furnaces” (cf. Deut. 4:20).

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכְּבִירִין = *בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכְּבִירִים*, “between the two stoves/furnaces” — *כְּבִירִין* could be a variant of *כְּבִירִים* (dual gender), “stove(s),” a dual formation (two pots could be placed on the stove), also used as plural. *כְּבִירִים* occurs once in the Masoretic Text (Lev. 11:35), but it is common in Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., *כְּבִירִים*, “stove(s)” (m. Shab. 3:2); *שְׁנֵי כְּבִירִים*, “two stoves” (m. Kel. 6:3). Perhaps the unattested singular form is *כְּבִיר* (masc.), while *כְּבִירָה* (m. Kel. 6:1; pl. *כְּבִירוֹת*, b. Shab. 37a) is its feminine form.

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכִּיּוֹרִים = *בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכִּיּוֹרִים*, “between the two (basin shaped) plat-

6 Pixner, 347; Garcia Martinez, 461; Wolters, 38-39; Beyer, 227; Vermes, 375.

7 The plural construct forms are *בְּיָרִים* (Gen. 26:18) and *בְּיָרִין* (Gen. 14:10; see Ibn-Ezra on Gen. 26:15). Neophyti renders *בָּר* (= *בְּיָר*) and *בְּיָרִין* (= *בְּיָרִים*), respectively.

8 Usually translated as, “and all the Beerites” (JPSⁱ, JPSⁱⁱ, *Tanach*; cf. Koren). Radak says that the places near *בְּיָרִים*, Beeroth (or Wells), a city in Benjamin, were called *בְּיָרִים*. Ralbag suggests that the *בְּיָרִים* were *בְּיָרִים*, “the men of Beeroth (or Wells)” in Benjamin. Regarding *בּוֹר*, see #3, 1:6.

9 Cf. Rashi on Ezek. 40:5, *רוֹחַב הַבְּנִין עוֹבֵי הַחוֹמָה*, “the width of the structure is the thickness of the city wall”; also *Mešudat David*. See also *Temple Scroll* (Heb.) 2, 100, note on 33:9; BDB, 125b.

10 *בְּיָנִין* may be the plural of the unattested *בְּיָנִי* (masc.), a parallel of *בְּיָנִיָּה* (fem., Ezek. 41:13) which occurs instead of *בְּיָנִי* (masc., final *nun-he* interchange); cf. *אֶכְסֹרֶת* for *אֶכְסֹרָה* (see #51, 11:3). Their Targum is *בְּיָנִיָּה* (emph. of *בְּיָנִי*), which also occurs in Biblical Aramaic (Ezra 5:4). *בְּיָנִיָּה* may be related *בְּיָרָה* (BH, MH), “fort, castle, metropolis, sanctuary” (*nun-reš* interchange).

forms" — כִּיּוֹר could be a variant of כִּיּוֹרִין. The word כִּיּוֹר (sg. masc.) means "(large) pot" (Zech. 12:6), "(washing) basin" (1 Kgs 7:38), or "(basin shaped) platform."¹¹ The plurals are כִּיּוֹרִים (2 Chron. 4:6) and כִּיּוֹרוֹת (1 Kgs 7:38). The terms כִּיּוֹר, כִּירָה, כִּיר, and כּוֹר, are from the root כּוֹר, "to be or make round,"¹² or from כּוֹרֶה, "to dig" (these two roots may be related).

So far the possible readings, בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבַּתִּיּוֹת־הַכִּנִּיּוֹת, have the same pattern as מִבֵּין שְׁנֵי הַכְּרוּבִּים, "from between the two cherubim" (Exod. 25:22; Num. 7:89); כּוֹתֵל שֶׁבֵּין שְׁנֵי בָתִּים, "a wall which is between two houses" (m. Oh. 6:4); כּוֹתֵל שֶׁבֵּין שְׁנֵי כּוֹכְבֵּין אוֹ בֵּין שְׁתֵּי מְעֻרוֹת, "a wall which is between two burial niches or between two burial caves" (m. Oh. 6:6). However there is an additional possibility.

בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבִּינִין, "between the teeth of the structure," means "between the towers of the structure (or city wall)." שְׁנֵי is the construct state of שָׁנִים, dual/plural of שֵׁן, "tooth, ivory, peak"; cf. בֶּשֶׁן הַסֵּלַע, "at the peak of the rock" (see #10, 2:11).

(4:6) שְׁבַעֲמֶק עָכוֹר is a variant of שְׁבַעֲמֶק עָכוֹר, "which is/are in the Valley of Achor" (see #1, 1:2); cf. חֲפוֹן־חֲפוֹר is a variant of חֲפוֹר־חֲפוֹר (*nun-reš* interchange). It is discussed in greater detail below.

(4:7) בְּאֶמְצָעָנָם, "at their (masc.) center" — אֶמְצָע or מִצָּע, "middle," is Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., וְהוּא בְּאֶמְצָעָן, "and he is at their (fem.) center," i.e., in the middle of an area of four by four cubits (m. 'Eruv. 4:5); "from the beginning of the field וּמֵאֶמְצָעָהָ (and from its [fem.] middle)" (m. Pe'ah 1:3). The verbal form מִצָּע (MH) means "to place in the middle" or "to cut into halves." E.g., וְהַמְּוֹנֶה מִצָּעוֹ בֵּינוֹ וּבֵין הָעָם, "and the assistant places him (the high priest) between him (the assistant) and between the people" (m. San. 2:1). The Aramaic cognates are מִצָּעָא, מִצָּעָתָא, מִצָּע. E.g., the Targum of בְּתוֹךְ הַמַּיִם is בְּמִצְעֵיּוֹת מַיָּא (TO, PsJ, TN), "in the middle of the waters" (Gen. 1:6).¹³ The 'Arukh derives אֶמְצָע, from the Greek μέσος, *mesos*, "middle."¹⁴ However, Kutscher suggests that אֶמְצָע - מִצָּע must be of Aramaic origin, since בְּמִצְעָתָא (construct state of מִצָּעָא with the preposition *bet*) occurs twice in the Zinjirli inscriptions (Ya'udic, c. 8th cent. BCE).¹⁵

11 Cf. עָשָׂה שְׁלֹמֹה כִּיּוֹר נְחֹשֶׁת, "for (King) Solomon had made a bronze platform" (2 Chron. 6:13). Ben-Yehuda (3, 2341b, nn. 2-3) says that the origin of כִּיּוֹר is unknown, the Greek and Latin translations render "base," and the Peshitta אֲסִטוּא. Regarding the latter, see #3, 1:7.

12 Cf. BDB 468; Jastrow, 625a, 636b; SB, 367b, 373; BY 3, 2307a, 2350b-51b; ESh^{dic} 3, 1036b, 1047a, 1049b.

13 Rashi explains as, בְּאֶמְצָע הַמַּיִם, "in the middle of the waters."

14 AC 1, 125b; 5, 220a; He'Arukh, 33a; also ESh^{dic} 1, 112; 4, 1488b. Ben-Yehuda (4, 3254a n. 1) notes that מִצָּע occurs in Aramaic and Syriac.

15 E.Y. Kutscher, "Some Problems of the Lexicography of Mishnaic Hebrew and its

(4:7) חֲפֹר־חֲפֹר אַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ = חֲפֹר־חֲפֹר אַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ, “three cubit (deep) are buried,” or “dig three cubits deep” — The first word in the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: תַּבִּין, תַּבִּין, חֲנִין, חֲנִין, חֲנִין, חֲנִין, and perhaps תַּבִּין; ALLEGRO^{dr}: חֲפִין, חֲפִין.

The scholars analyzed חֲפֹן, which also occurs in lines 5:14, 8:14, 9:5, as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: חֲפִין is from חָפָה, to “cover,” thus “strewn” in the House, but better taken with the Arabic sense *ḥafin*, “hidden” (9:5; cf. חָפֹר in line 9:2); “hidden” (4:7, 5:14). ALLEGRO^{pr}: “dug” (9:5). ALLEGRO: חֲפֹן, but read as חָפֹר (*nun* for *reš*), “buried.”¹⁶ MILIK: חֲפֹר, *het-pe* ligature, cursive *reš* (4:7), חָפֹר (5:14), חָפֹר (8:14), חֲפֹר, cursive *reš* (9:5), “dig.”¹⁷ LURIE: חֲפֹן, “hidden”; form חָפָה, “to hide, cover.”¹⁸ BEYER: חָפֹר, “dig.”¹⁹ WOLTERS (4:7, with the previous word): בְּאֶמְצַע נֶחְנִין, “in the middle of *nḥyn*”; the other three cases, חָפֹר, “dig.”²⁰ WISE: “dig down.”²¹ The rest of the scholars render “dig,” as does Milik.²²

One may accept Wolters’ suggestion (in this item), but read it with a *taw* (rather than a *het*), בְּאֶמְצַע נֶתְנִין, “in (the) midst of (the) Nethinim,” i.e., in the midst of the dwelling place of the Nethinim. Regarding the Nethinim, see #60, 12:10.

MUCHOWSKI suggests that the phenomenon of weakening of the pharyngeal sounds and *reš* resulted in the loss of these letters, thus the word ended with an open syllable. A second phenomenon involved adding a nasal *mem* or *nun* to the open syllable at the end of the word, like האֶסְטָאן (11:2) and האֶכְסָדֶרֶן (11:3). Thus, the sequence was חָפֹר > חָפּוּ > חֲפֹן > חָפֹר and עָכֹר > עָכוּ > עֲכוֹן.²³

חָפֹר is a variant of חָפֹר, like עָכוֹן is for עָכֹר, a *nun-reš* interchange. חָפֹר occurs 22 times in the Scroll (once reconstructed, 7:1). It is spelled four ways: חָפֹר (defective, 3:6, 6:3, 6:9, 6:12, 7:9), חָפֹר (*plene*, 2:14, 4:13, 5:3, 5:10, 7:12, 7:15, 8:5, 8:9, 8:12, 9:8, 9:12), חָפֹר (with double *waw*,

Comparison with Biblical Hebrew” (in. Heb.), *Archive* 1 (1972), 65 and n. 152. Also, *KAI* 1, 40 (#215:10; #216:9-10).

16 Lines 8:14-16 are missing in the copy of Allegro^{pr}, which was received from Mrs. Allegro. Allegro, 39, 41, 47, 49, 143 nn. 85-86, 149 n. 119, 156 n. 184, 157 n. 200. Allegro^{rev}, 22-25.

17 Milik, 288-90, 292-95, 315a; Milik^E, 140-41; Milik^F, 325-26 (*creuse*, but in line 4:7, it is in a different typeset, i.e., a questionable translation).

18 Lurie, 81 and n. 4, 88-89, 101-02 (חָפֹן in the translation is a typographical error for חָפֹר), 108. Lurie independently arrived at the same solution as Allegro^{pr}.

19 Beyer, 227-30.

20 Wolters, 38-41, 46-49.

21 Wise, 193-95.

22 Pixner, 347-48; Garcia Martinez, 461-62; Vermes, 375-76.

23 Apparently Muchowski reads these cases as does Milik (“Dysorthographic Forms *ḥāpōn* and *ākōn* in 3Q15,” *Intertestamental Essays* [1992], 131-33).

10:13), and חפון (with final *nun*, 4:7, 5:14, 8:14, 9:5).

חפור (from the root חפר, "to dig, search") can be vocalized either as חפור, "buried, hidden" (*Qal* pass. part. masc. sg.; so Allegro and Lurie); or חפור, "dig" (*Qal* imperative masc. sg.; so the other scholars). Likewise, חפון can be vocalized as חפון or חפון. Since the Copper Scroll is a secret document listing hidden objects, it is probable that its compiler(s) would not instruct someone to "dig" out these hidden objects. Therefore, the preferable reading is חפור־חפון, "buried, hidden" (like סתום = סתום, "concealed" 1:7), rather than חפור־חפון, "(you) dig."²⁴ The plurals חפורות and חפירות, "pits," are also derived from the same root (see #38, 9:1-2).

There are cases in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew, variations between the Dead Sea biblical readings and the Masoretic Text, as well as between cognates of Hebrew, Aramaic, and other Semitic languages, where *nun* and *reš* interchange.²⁵ E.g., בחן, "to test," and בחר, "to select," are used interchangeably in Hebrew and in Aramaic. אָנִי ה' חָקֵר לֵב בָּחֵן כְּלִיּוֹת, its Targum is אָנָּה ה' חָקֵר לְבָא בְּחַר כּוּלֵּיָתָא, "I the Lord search the heart, test the kidneys" (Jer. 17:10). ה' צִדִּיק יִבְחֵן, "The Lord tests the righteous" (Ps. 11:5) can be rendered as if were written יִבְחֵר, "The Lord chooses the righteous." הִגֵּה צִרְפָּתִיךָ וְלֹא בִכְסֵף בְּחַרְתִּיךָ בְּכוֹר עֲנִי, "Behold, I have refined you, but not with silver, I have tested you in the furnace of adversity," rather than "I have chosen you" (Isa. 48:10). The Targum renders בְּחַרְתִּיךָ. This translation is supported by the reading of בְּחַנְתִּיכָה, "I have tested you," in the Isaiah Scroll.²⁶ Scripture says, צִדְיָנִים יִקְרְאוּ לְחֶרְמוֹן שְׂרִין וְהָאֹמְרִי יִקְרְאוּ לוֹ שֶׁנִּיר, "the Sidonians call (Mount) Hermon Sirion, while the Amorites call it Senir" (Deut. 3:9).²⁷ These variants suggests that the old pre-Israelite names were

24 This distinction is similar to the possible vocalizations of the preposition *bet* (see #20, 4:13). Regarding the vocalization of מִשָּׁה ("measure," imperative, or "measurement," noun), see #26, 7:6; and for Lurie's reading of חִבּוּאָה, "hidden," see #1, 1:2.

25 Cf. SB, 401, 522a, 762a; BY 7, 6277b). These two phonemes are members of the letter group *lamed-mem-nun-reš* (voiced sonorous). Regarding this group, see G. Bergsträsser, *Hebräische Grammatik* (1918) 1, 35; S. Moscati (ed.), *An Introduction to the Comparative Grammar of the Semitic Languages: Phonology and Morphology* (1969), 31-32; Z.S. Harris, *Development of the Canaanite Dialects* (1939), 3; Z. Ben-Hayyim, "Hebrew Grammar," *EJ* 8, 81-82.

26 See Radak's second explanation on this verse; also, BDB, 104a; SB, 98a. When בחן = בחר, Ben-Yehuda (1, 169-70, 505b n. 5, 508b-509a n. 4) lists it as a separate root, notes that its Aramaic and Syriac cognate is בחר, and that some manuscripts have בחנתך. Mandelkern (1, 183c-d) connects בחן with בחר. Steinberg (97b-98a, 105b) relates the roots בחן, בחר, בכר, and בקר with each other. Jastrow (155) equates the Hebrew and Aramaic בחן with בחר, and derives בחן, בחר, בהל, and בחש from the bilateral root בה. Twice בחן is rendered by Onkelos as בחן, while Pseudo-Jonathan as בחר (Gen. 42:15-16). Kasovsky's *Ozar Leshon Targum Onkelos* (1, 65b-66a) lists these two cases as בחר. Kutscher notes that in the Masoretic text in three-four cases בחר means בחן (*LLBIS*, 169-70).

27 שְׂרִין also occurs in Ezek. 27:5; Songs 4:8; 1 Chron. 5:23; while שְׂרִיִן in Ps. 29:6. Mount Hermon also had a fourth name, וְצֶדֶר הָר שִׁיאֵן הוּא חֶרְמוֹן, "and unto Mount Sion which

kept alive. Both forms have Akkadian parallels, Sirara and Saniru (i.e., the same interchange). Moreover, these variants have double interchanges, *nun-reš* and *reš-nun*. They also suggest that certain languages or dialects prefer one form to another.

Finally, there are of words in the Scroll, where a *waw* or *yod* may be read as a short headed *reš* or a short legged final *nun*. In both possibilities, based on the *nun-reš* interchange, the final results are the same (see #38, 9:2).²⁸

(4:8) שָׁמ שְׁנֵי דוּדִין מְלֵאִין כֶּסֶף, “there are two pots full of silver (pieces/shekels)” — The drawings differ. BAKER^{dr}: דוּדִין or דוּדִין, the *nun* looks like a combination of a regular and final *nun*, and it left touches the upper part of a *lamed* in the next line; מְלֵאִין, no *yod*; *bet/kaf*, *nun*, followed by a ligature of a regular *nun* and final *nun*, i.e., כְּנָנִין or כְּנָנִין. MILIK^{dr}: דוּדִין, clear final *nun*; מְלֵאִין, a very small *yod* touches the bottom of the left side of the *alef*; *bet/kaf*, a *waw* touching the bottom of the previous letter, and on its left side a thin almost vertical line hangs on it, followed by a regular *nun*-final *pe* ligature, i.e., כוּנָף or כוּנָף. ALLEGRO^{dr}: דוּדִין, the vertical and horizontal lines of the regular *nun* crosses each other; מְלֵאִין, the *yod* touches upper part of the left side of the *alef*; כֶּסֶף, where the left lower part of the *samekh* and the final *pe* is connected by a almost horizontal line.

The term שָׁם, “there,” appears in additional two places in the Scroll: שָׁמ קָלִיל, “there (is) a *qalal* (vessel)” (see #25, 6:4), and שָׁמ כְּלֵי־כֶסֶף, “there (are) silver vessels” (see #58, 12:6; alt.). Cf. וְהָיָה הָאָרֶץ טוֹבָה שָׁם הַבְּדִילָח, “and the gold of that land is good, there are bdellium and onyx stone” (Gen. 2:12). It should be added that in Hebrew the English expressions “there is/are” is understood and usually not indicated.

דוּדִין or דוּדִין, same as דוּדִין and דוּדִין (2 Kgs 10:7 and 2 Chron. 35:13, respectively) is the plural of דוּד (masc.), “pot, cauldron,” also used in Mishnaic Hebrew (e.g., m. Naz. 6:8).²⁹ Its Aramaic cognate is דוּדָא; e.g., the Targum of סִירוּתֵי, “its pots” (Exod. 27:3) is דוּדִיתָה (PsJ), דוּדִיתָה (Frag.); of הַסִּיר הַגָּדוֹלָה, “the large pot” (2 Kgs 4:38), is דוּדָא רַבָּא (TJ). Also, וְהִקְדָּשִׁים בְּשִׁלּוֹ בְּסִירוֹת וּבְדוּדִים וּבְצִלְחוֹת, and its Targum, וְיִתְּנָם בְּכֶסֶת, קוּדְשֵׁיָא בְּשִׁילוֹ בְּקִדְרֵיָא וּבְדוּדֵיָא וּבְמִלוֹסְיָא, “and the holy offerings they boiled in pots, and in cauldrons, and in pans” (2 Chron. 35:13). The *dema*’ vessels of סִירָא (11:14) and סִנָּה (= סִירָה, 11:4) may be variants or feminine forms

is Hermon” (Deut. 4:48). It is possible that in שִׁיאוֹן the *nun* or *reš* assimilated. שִׁיאוֹן seems to be related to שָׂא, both from the root נָשָׂא, “to lift” (cf. BDB, 673a). Regarding שָׂא, see 5, 1:13.

²⁸ The topic of letter interchanges with many examples is discussed in Lefkovits^{diss} 2, 962-96.

²⁹ *דוּד* occurs eight times in the Masoretic Text. It is more common in the Talmud.

of סִיר, a synonym of דֹּדֵיךָ. Both דֹּדֵיךָ and קֶלֶל (6:4) could be *dema'* vessels (see Appendix D).

מִלֵּאִין is the plural of מִלֵּא, "full" (adj., fem. מִלְּאָה, pl. מִלְּאוֹת, BH, MH; from the root מלא, "to be full, to fill"). E.g., גִּבְעִים מִלְּאִים יֵין וְכֶסֶת, "pitchers full of wine, and cups" (Jer. 35:5); כְּלִי חֶרֶשׁ חֲדָשִׁים מִלְּאִים מַיִם, "new earth vessels full of water" (m. Shab. 16:5); קִדְרָה שֶׁהִיא מִלְּאָה מַיִם, "a dish which is full (fem.) of water" (m. Makhsh. 4:8). כְּלִי דְּמִלְּאָה, "of fullness [offering] vessels," appears as an alternate reading in the Scroll (11:14, see Appendix D).

Often כֶּסֶף means "silver shekel/*sela'*." E.g., the Targum of אֶלֶף כֶּסֶף, "one thousand silver (shekels)," is אֶלֶף סֵלַעִין וְדֶסֶלַעִין דְּכֶסֶף, "one thousand silver *sela's*" (Gen. 20:16; see #1, 1:4; #59, 12:9).

The phrase "two pots filled with silver (shekels)" suggests that occasionally reading of בְּכַדִּין, "in pitchers," instead of כִּכְרִין, "talents," in the Scroll is reasonable (see Appendix A).

ITEM 18

בשיח האדמא שבשולי העצ 4:9
לא כסף ככ מאתין 4:10

4:9 In the clay pit which is at the edge of the wood,
4:10 in it (are) two hundred k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(4:9) בשוחבשיחובשית consists of the letters *bet/kaf*, *šin/sin*, *waw/yod*, and *he/het/taw*. Regarding the latter, in most cases *he* and *het* are indistinguishable in the Scroll. Moreover, when the 'foot' of the *taw* facing left at the bottom of the left 'leg' is missing, then it looks like a *he* or *het*. Usually this foot is evident in MILIK's drawing, while in BAKER's and ALLEGRO's it is frequently absent. Therefore, this word, which appears six times in the Scroll, can be read as: בְּשִׁיחַ־בְּשִׁיחַ or בְּשִׁיחַ־בְּשִׁיחַ, "in/at/by a/the pit/cistern," and בְּשִׁיחַ־בְּשִׁיחַ, "in/at/by a/the deep pit." The table below presents various readings for these six cases.

READINGS OF THE DRAWINGS

LINE:	3:8	4:9	4:11	9:14	12:4	12:10
BAKER ^{dr}	שית	שיח	שית	שית	שיח	שית
MILIK ^{dr} - WOLTERS	שית	שיח	שית	שית	שית	שית
ALLEGRO ^{dr} - LURIE	שית	שית	שית	שית	שיח	שית
ALLEGRO	שית	שיח	שיח	שית	שיח	שית
MILIK - BEYER	שית	שית	שית	שית	שית	שית

In line 4:9 there is a lacuna right behind the the letter *het/taw* in all three drawings. In BAKER's this lacuna touches the left leg of the *het*, thus it could be a damaged *taw*. If so, this would agree with ALLEGRO's drawing.

ALLEGRO in line 4:9 and 4:11 does not follow his own drawing. He is inconsistent in his readings and translations. Allegro points out that in every case it is possible to read שיח, "pit," or שית, "Pit, *Shith*, base, foundation, ditch," also "underground chamber" (cf. m. Mid. 3:3), and "tomb chamber" (AAC, 395b).¹ MILIK reads שית in all six cases (even in line 4:9, where his

1 Allegro^{pr}: "pit" (3:8, 4:9, 12:4), "*Shith*, base, foundation" (9:14, 12:10), "pit (or foundation)" (4:11). Allegro: "pit (?)" (3:8); "pit" (4:9, 4:11, 12:4); "sepulcher" (9:14); "Pit (*Shith*)" (12:10) (Allegro, 37, 39, 49, 55, 142 n. 70, 143 n. 90, 158 n. 219, 168 n. 300, 169-70 n. 313). Allegro^{rev}: "pit" (3:8, 4:9, 4:11, 12:10); "ditch" (9:14, 12:4) (Al-

drawing has שִׁיחַ), renders five times "pit," *fosse*, and once "tunnel," *galerie* (12:10).² LURIE follows Allegro's drawing. שִׁיחַ means "base or a deep hollow pit" (cf. m. Mid. 3:3; y. Suk. 4:6); while שִׁיחַ is a "pool." In addition, Lurie reads in line 1:13 שִׁיחַ, *plene* spelling for שִׁיחַ.³ SHARVIT lists only שִׁיחַ, "deep pit," thus presumably he reads all six cases as שִׁיחַ.⁴ PIXNER reads and/or renders "channel" (3:8), שִׁיחַ, "trench" (4:9), "pit" (4:11), "ditch" (9:14, 12:4), and שִׁיחַ, "underground passage" (12:10).⁵ WOLTERS follows Milik's drawing; renders שִׁיחַ as "reservoir," and שִׁיחַ as "cavern." In addition, he reads שִׁיחַ, *plene* spelling for שִׁיחַ in line 1:13 (as Lurie), and alternatively in line 8:10.⁶ GARCIA MARTINEZ renders "tunnel," i.e., שִׁיחַ (3:8, 4:9, 4:11, 12:4, 12:10), and "cistern," i.e., שִׁיחַ (9:14) and שִׁיחַ (1:13).⁷ BEYER reads six times שִׁיחַ (as Milik), "hollow space, cavity," and in line 1:13, he equates שִׁיחַ with שִׁיחַ, "pound, pool" (1:13).⁸ VERMES translates six times "underground cavity," i.e., שִׁיחַ, and in line 1:13, "hole."⁹ WISE renders "dry well" (3:8, 4:9, 4:11, 9:14, 12:10), "ditch" (12:4), and in line 1:13 "reservoir."¹⁰

שִׁיחַ = שִׁיחַ (with a *het*; Lurie, Wolters), שִׁיחַ = שִׁיחַ, and שִׁיחַ = שִׁיחַ (with a *taw*) instead of שִׁיחַ are plausible alternates, where the extra 'alef may represent a Tiberian *pataḥ*; cf. לֵא = לֵא (see #55, 11:14). Likewise, שִׁיחַ may be a variant of שִׁיחַ (Beyer), an 'alef-*het* interchange (see #5, 1:13).

שִׁיחַ (MH, masc., pl. שִׁיחִים) means "pit, cistern, pool, ditch, ritual bath, burial pit."¹¹ E.g., בּוֹר שִׁיחַ וּמַעְרָה, "a cistern, a pit, or/and a cave" (e.g., m. B.Q. 5:5);¹² מֵי בּוֹרוֹת מֵי שִׁיחִין מֵי מַעְרֹת, "waters of cisterns, waters of pits, waters of caves" (m. Miq. 1:4). שִׁיחַ also occurs in 4Q184 (1:3).¹³ The rare-

legro^{rev}, 22-23, 25-37).

2 Milik, 287-89, 294, 241 C-38; Milik^E, 139-42.

3 Lurie, 65-66 and n. 1, 76-77 and n. 1, 82 and n. 1, 83, 110 and n. 1, 123-24 and n. 3, 126 and n. 1.

4 Sharvit lists שִׁיחַ among those words which are both Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew, but is used in the Mishnaic sense, "deep pit" ("Iyyunim," 131; תפירה is a typographical error for חפירה).

5 Pixner, 347-48, 353, 357-58.

6 "Vocabulary," 486, #26, #27; "The Fifth Cache," 171-72; Wolters, 36-9, 48-49, 54-55.

7 Garcia Martinez, 461-63.

8 Beyer, 225-27, 230, 232.

9 Vermes, 374-75, 377-78.

10 Wise, 191, 193, 196, 198.

11 Regarding the traditional Ashkenazic pronunciations of שִׁיחַ (with a *šin*), rather than שִׁיחַ (with a *šin*), see S. Sharvit, "Studies in the Lexicography and Grammar of Mishnaic Hebrew Based on the *Introductions* of J.N. Epstein" (in Heb.), *Archive* 2 (1974), 121.

12 *Mele'khet Šelomoh* points out that occasionally מַעְרָה, בּוֹר, and שִׁיחַ are synonyms of מַקְוָה, "ritual bath" (m. Miq. 5:1; cf. Bertinoro).

13 Qimron says that many nouns in the Dead Sea Scroll Hebrew "have a pattern distinct from that known from the Tiberian tradition." He lists among the examples שִׁיחַ ("ditch") of

ly used שוּחַ (MH, prob. masc.), “pit, grave,” is a variant of שִׁיחַ (discussed later).¹⁴ שִׁיחַ and שוּחַ are related to or variants of the feminine שִׁיחָה (Ps. 57:7; pl. שִׁיחוֹת, Ps. 119:85), שוּחָה (Prov. 23:27, etc.),¹⁵ שִׁחַת (Prov. 26:27, etc.; 1QS 9:22, etc.; pl. שִׁחָתִים in וּמִן הַשִּׁחָתִים, “and from the nether-worlds,” Midrash Tadshe’ 12), שִׁחוֹת (in בְּשִׁחוֹתָיו, “in his pit,” Prov. 28:10), שִׁחִית (in בְּשִׁחִיתוֹתָם, “in their pits,” Lam. 4:20; and מִשִּׁחִיתוֹתָם, “from their pits,” Ps. 107:20). These are related to or variants of the masculine אֲשוּחָה or אֲשוּחָהּ or אֲשִׁיחָהּ (pl. אֲשִׁיחוֹת or dual אֲשִׁיחָיוּ; with a prosthetic *’alef*) that appear in the Scroll five times, as well as in other sources (see #55, 11:12). Basically all of these have the same meaning, and all of these are derived from the root שִׁיחַשׁוּחַ, “to sink.”

The שִׁית (MH, masc., pl. שִׁיתִּין) was a “deep pit” below the altar of the Temple where the priests poured the unused portions of the libations. E.g., “(if the wine already) went out into the שִׁיתִּין” (m. Me’il. 3:3); “in which one goes down to the שִׁית” (m. Mid. 3:3); “the שִׁית was hollowed out as far as the abyss” (baraita, y. Suk. 4:6 [18a]). Moreover, the Midrash says:

Shem and Eber walked in front of the bier of Sarah and they saw what type of שִׁית has been prepared for our forefather Abraham (Gen. Rabbah 63:3).¹⁶

Since Sarah and Abraham were buried in מְצֵרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה, “the cave of Machpelah” (Gen. 23:19, 25:9), here obviously שִׁיתוֹשִׁיחַ means מְצֵרָה, “burial cave.”¹⁷ Likewise, שוּחַ could refer to a “burial pit”; e.g., בֶּן תִּשְׁעִים לְשׁוּחַ, “a ninety (years old man) is (ready) for the burial pit” (m. ’Avot 5:24).¹⁸ Thus, בְּשׁוּחַ וּבְשִׁיחָהּ or בְּשִׁיחָהּ וּבְשִׁיחָהּ, “in/at/by a/the burial pit which is (the) Melah,” is a perfect synonym of בְּקִבְרוֹ וּבְקִבְרָהּ, “in/at/by a/the grave which is in (the) Melah” (3:11).

שִׁית is considered to be Mishnaic Hebrew, and it is of obscure origin.¹⁹ Al-

4Q184, but does not mention שִׁיחַ of the Copper Scroll and in the Mishnah (*The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1986], 66).

14 בָּנוֹת שוּחַ (MH), “daughters of *šuah*,” is a certain type of fig (e.g., m. Demai 1:1). It may have some relationship with שוּחַ, “pit.”

15 Cf. the *ketiv-geri* case in the verse, כִּי כָרוּ שִׁיחָהּ (כ, שוּחָה, ק) לְלִכְרֹנִי, “because they have dug a pit to catch me” (Jer. 18:22).

16 In some readings שִׁית is spelled as שִׁיית, others have מְקוֹם, “place” (Theodor-Albeck, *Bereschit Rabba, mit kritischem Apparat und Kommentar* [1965], 675; M.A. Mirkin, *Bereschit Rabbah, with a New Scientific Commentary* [1971] 2, 329; *The Midrash Rabbah* [1977], 553). שִׁית is explained as “grave site” (גְּרָאב אָרֶט = *Grabort*; He’Arukh, 555a, also 156b), or “grave” (*Grab*, from the Greek *σῆδος*; AC 8, 69a, also 3, 47a). The Vatican manuscript has שִׁיחַ, with a somewhat smaller *het* than the average letter (*Midrash Bereshit Rabba, MS. Vat. Ebr.* 30 [1970], on Gen. 25:10, np.).

17 See also, AAC, 395b, where S. Krauss equates שִׁית (and שִׁיית) with הַפִּירָה (“pit”) and קִבְרָה (“grave”); and suggests the vocalization of שִׁית - שִׁיית, like מִיָּם.

18 See *Mahzor Vitry*, Bertinoro, *Tosephot Yom-Tov*. Even-Shoshan considers לְשׁוּחַ as an *Qal* infinitive form of the verb שׁוּחַ, “to sink, immerse” (Esh^dic 7, 2631b).

though twice in the Masoretic Text *שִׁית* is explained as “garment” or “foundation,”²⁰ it may mean “deep pit”: *לָכֵן עֲנֻקְתָּמוּ גִּאָוָה יַעֲטֹף שִׁית חֲמָס לָמוּ*, “Therefore, their necklace is pride, their violence covers a deep pit” (Ps. 73:6);²¹ *וְהִנֵּה אִשָּׁה לִקְרָאתוֹ שִׁית זֹנָה וּנְצָרָת לֵב*, “And behold, a woman comes toward him, a deep pit, a prostitute with a concealed heart” (Prov. 7:10).²² Cf. *כִּי שׁוֹחָה עֲמָקָה זֹנָה וּבְאֵר צָרָה נִכְרְיָה*, “For a prostitute is a deep pit, and a strange woman is a narrow well” (Prov. 23:27).

Moreover, *שָׁתוֹת*, the plural of the assumed *שֵׁת* (masc.), which occurs twice in the Masoretic text, usually explained as “foundation, base,” may mean “pit” or “cistern”: *וְהָיוּ שָׁתוֹתֶיהָ מְדוּכָאִים*, “And it shall be its (fem.) cisterns crushed” (Isa. 19:10);²³ and *כִּי הַשָּׁתוֹת יִהְיוּ שָׁתוֹת*, “When their cisterns are destroyed” (Ps. 11:3).²⁴ These translations are based Rit’s definition of *שָׁתוֹת*, “pits for gathered water” (Isa. 19:10, where he refers to Ps. 11:3).

שִׁית might have evolved from *שִׁיחַת* or *שַׁחַת*, due to the weakening of the gutturals. If this is the case, *שִׁית* and *שׁוּחַשִׁיחַ* are related. Although in Mishnaic Hebrew both *שִׁית* and *שִׁיחַ* are masculine, in the Scroll *שִׁית* and probably *שׁוּחַשִׁיחַ* are feminine; e.g., *בְּשִׁיתֵיבִשִׁית הַמִּזְרָחִית*, “in the eastern (fem.) deep pit” (4:11); *הַשִּׁית הָעֲלִיוֹנָא*, “the upper (fem.) deep pit” (12:4).

Based on the above suggestions: (1) *שִׁית* may be both Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew. (2) *שֵׁת* (masc., pl. *שָׁתוֹת*, BH) may be a variant of *שִׁית* (pl. *שִׁיתִּין*). (3) *שִׁית* may be related to *שִׁיחַ* and *שַׁחַת*. And (4) both *שִׁיחַ* and *שִׁית* may be dual gender nouns.

19 The following solutions are offered for *שִׁית*: it is from *שַׁחַת*, “foundation” (Jastrow, 1570a); related to *שַׁחַת* and *אֲשַׁחַת* (Syriac), *Grundfeste*, *Grund* (“foundation, base”; AC 8, 180); related to *שַׁחַת* (BH), “foundation” (BY 8, 7080a-81b and n. 3); a variant of *שַׁחַת* (ESH^{dic} 7, 2680a).

20 E.g., BDB, 742a, 1011b; Harkavy, 715a; ESH^{dic} 7, 2679b; ESH^{con} 3, 2119b. For Steinberg (838a, 874b) *שִׁית* is a variant of *שֵׁת*, “buttocks.” As an alternate explanation, Ibn-Ezra suggests that *שִׁית* (in Ps. 73:6) may mean *פֶּאֶה*, “corner.”

21 Translated as, “Therefore pride is as a chain about their neck; Violence covereth them as a garment” (JPSⁱ); “So pride adorns their necks, lawlessness enwraps them as a mantel” (JPSⁱⁱ); “Therefore is their necklace; violence covers them like a garment” (Koren); “Therefore arrogance is their necklace; the violence wraps their hips [with fat]” (Tanach); etc.

22 Translated as, “And, behold, there met him a woman With the attire of a harlot, and wily of heart” (JPSⁱ, cf. Koren); “A woman comes toward him Dressed like a harlot, with set purpose” (JPSⁱⁱ, noting that the Hebrew of the second half of the verse is uncertain); “Then behold, a woman approached him, bedecked as a harlot and with siege in [her] heart” (Tanach); etc.

23 Translated as, “And its foundations shall be broken” JPSⁱ (cf. JPSⁱⁱ); “And her foundations shall be crushed” (Koren); “The foundation of its fish pools will be battered” (Tanach; Isa. 19:10); etc.

24 Translated as, “When the foundations are destroyed” (JPSⁱ, JPSⁱⁱ, Tanach, cf. Koren; Ps. 11:3); etc.

(4:9) בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה (= בְּשִׁיחַ שֶׁל הָאֲדָמָה), “In the clay pit,” or בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה “In the red pit” — ALLEGRO²⁵: “In the pit of the soil.” ALLEGRO: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “In the clay pit.” אֲדָמָה, “earth” (BH), “clay” (MH).²⁵ MILIK: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “In the Red Pit”; it may be connected with the toponym מַעֲלֵה אֲדָמִים, Ascent or Hill of Adummim, or “the Red Hill.” (Josh. 15:7, 18:17). אֲדָמָה is the feminine form of אָדָם (adj.), “red.”²⁶ LURIE: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲרָכָה, “In the long pit.”²⁷ PIXNER: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “At the earth trench.”²⁸ WOLTERS: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “In the red reservoir.”²⁹ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the earth tunnel.”³⁰ BEYER (reads as Milik): “In the (from outside) red-brown cavity.”³¹ VERMES: “In the red underground cavity.”³² WISE: “In the red dry well.”³³

This phrase consists of the letters *bet/kaf*, *šin/śin*, *waw/yod*, *he/ḥet/taw*, *he/ḥet/taw*, *ʾalef*, *dalet/reš*, *bet/kaf/mem*, and *ʾalef*. Thus, seven out of nine letters can be read more than one way. In addition to the earlier discussed possible readings of the first word as בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, and בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, alternatively it can be read as בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “in (the) Shaveh/Plain” (see #5, 1:13). Moreover, these two words can be separated not only between the fourth and fifth, but between the fifth and sixth letters too. If the fifth letter is the first of the second word, then it is the definite article *he*, if it is the last letter of the first word, then it is the feminine *he* or *taw* ending, or it is a *ḥet*. The ninth letter, an *ʾalef*, often occurs in the Scroll instead of *he*, usually the feminine ending.

Based on the above, the additional readings for the first word are: בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “in/at/by a/the pit” (sg. non-const.); בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “in/at/by a/the pit of” (sg. const.); בְּשִׁיחַ הָאֲדָמָה, “in/at/by (the) pits (of)” (pl. non-const. or const.).

As noted earlier, the second word may or may not have the prefixed definite article *he*. The following are some of the possible readings.

אֲדָמָה = אֲדָמָה (fem. adj., masc. אָדָם), “red” (Milik; from the root אָדָם, “to be red”), e.g., פָּרָה אֲדָמָה תְּמִימָה, “a perfect red heifer” (Num. 19:2).

אֲדָמָה = אֲדָמָה (fem., Allegro), “earth, clay, ground, land”; its synonym קֶרֶק occurs in the Scroll (see #5, 1:14). Other explanations will follow.

אֲרָכָה = אֲרָכָה (fem. adj., masc. אָרָךְ), “long” (Lurie; from the root אָרָךְ,

25 Allegro, 39; 143 n. 89; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

26 Milik, 288-89, 239 C-15 (מעלי is a typographical error for מַעֲלֵה), 263 D-6. Milik^E, 140; cf. Harkavy, 401.

27 Lurie, 82 and n. 1.

28 Pixner, 347.

29 “Vocabulary,” 486, #26; “The Fifth Cache,” 171-72; Wolters, 38-39.

30 Garcia Martinez, 461.

31 Beyer, 227-28.

32 Vermes, 375.

33 Wise, 193.

“to be long”), e.g., אֶרְכָּה מֵאֶרֶץ מִדְּה, “longer than earth its (fem.) measure” (Job 11:9). If the second word is an feminine adjective, then שוֹחֲשִׁית must also be feminine (see #13, 3:8).

אֶרְכָּה = אֶרְכָּה, Arkah, could be a toponym or a personal name; cf. אֶרֶךְ, Erech (Gen. 10:10), a city in Babylon; also, אֶרְכִּיָּה, “those who live in Erech” (BA, Ezra 4:10); and גְּבוּל הָאֶרְכִּי, “the border of Archi” (Josh. 16:2), and חוּשֵׁי הָאֶרְכִּי, “Hushai the Archite” (e.g., 2 Sam. 16:16). אֶרְכִּי is a gentile form, probably of the place/family אֶרֶךְ, Erech, located/dwelt near the border of Ephraim and Benjamin.

אֶרְבָּה = אֶרְבָּה (masc.), “locust” (e.g., Exod. 10:4).

אֶרְבָּה = אֶרְבָּה (fem.) — (a) “lattice, window, sluice” (e.g., Gen. 8:2; Isa 60:8). (b) Arubbah could be a singular form of the toponym אֶרְבוֹת (pl. formation), Arubboth in the Sharon (1 Kings. 4:10). (c) Arubbah may be a variant of אֶרֶב, Arab, a city near Hebron (Josh. 15:52).

Moreover, both בְּבוֹר הַמֶּלֶח and בְּשׁוּחַבְשִׁיחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה (2:1) could be unattested compound toponyms; cf. בּוֹר הַסִּירָה, Bor-sirah (2 Sam. 3:26). Also, אֲדָמָה וְחָצוֹר, “and Adamah, and Haramah, and Hazor” in Naphtali (Josh. 19:36); and אֲדָמָה וְצִבּוֹיִם, “Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim” (Deut. 29:22).

Scripture says, “In the plain of the Jordan King (Solomon) cast (the large Temple vessels) בֵּין הָאֲדָמָה וּבֵין הַצִּבּוֹיִם between Succoth and Zarethan” (1 Kgs 7:46). Its parallel verse reads, “בֵּין הָאֲדָמָה וּבֵין הַצִּבּוֹיִם between Succoth and Zaredah” (2 Chron. 4:17).³⁴ BDB renders הָאֲדָמָה as “in the compactness of the soil, i.e., clay ground or clay mold,” but suggests the reading for both verses as בְּמַעְבַּר אֲדָמָה, “at the ford of Adamah”;³⁵ thus, considering אֲדָמָה as a toponym. However, מַעְבַּרְתֵּי הָאֲדָמָה may be a compound toponym where the first element has two forms. Therefore, there is no need to emend the text, it simply means, “in Ma’aveh/‘Avi-Adamah between Succoth and Zarethan/Zaredah.”

The Targum of הָאֲדָמָה is גִּרְגִּישָׁתָא (as Rashi notes). For עֲבִי הָאֲדָמָה Pseudo-Rashi uses the Old-French בארדילא - ברזילא, *ardille* - *arzille*, modern French *argile*, “clay.”³⁶ Thus, אֲדָמָה means “clay” also in Biblical Hebrew. Radak explains גִּרְגִּישָׁתָא as “good clay” (1 Kgs 7:6) or “red clay” (2 Chron. 4:17) from which furnaces for casting metals were made. For these huge vessels forms were shaped into the ground in which the metal was cast. According to Jastrow, עֲבִי (JA) is the construct state of עֲבִיָּה, “thick

34 In the name צִרְתָּן the *dalet* of צִרְתָּן assimilated into the *taw*, plus a final *he-nun* interchange (see #35, 8:8).

35 BDB, 716a.

36 Greenberg, 235, 310 n. 700. Likewise, in the Babylonian Talmud Rashi renders אֲדָמָה and גִּרְגִּישָׁתָא אֲרִזְלָא, *arzil(le)*, “clay” (Catane, 20b #311, 75b #1132, 77a #1157, 100a #1502, 123b 1874; Gukovitzki, 18 #258; HR 3, 217-18).

mass, thick part,” which is like עָבָה (BH, MH), “thickness”; and גִּרְגִּשְׁתָּא, גִּרְגִּשְׁתָּא, or גִּרְגִּשְׁתָּא is the same as the Hebrew גֹּשׁ, “clod, lump of earth,” also means “certain reddish clay” used for vessels and medicine. Thus, עוֹבִי גִּרְגִּשְׁתָּא means “thick (reddish) clay.”³⁷

מַעְבָּה (perhaps with a locative *mem*) and עָבִי could be singular construct states, both from the root עָבָה, “to be thick.” מַעְבָּה - עָבִי could be a hole shaped in the earth or clay in which the melted metal was cast (cf. Radak’s explanation of גִּרְגִּשְׁתָּא). Therefore, they may originate from a second root עָבָה rather than יָעָבָה, “thick” (see #5, 1:13).

There are remarkable similarities between במַעְבָּהוּבְעִי הָאֲדָמָה, “in a certain shape of hole in the clay ground” used for casting Temple vessels, and בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה, “in the (deep) pit of the clay ground,” which also might have been used for casting Temple vessels. Thus, one may argue that some of the vessels mentioned in this Scroll were cast in this pit. מַעְבָּא or הַמַּעְבָּא, as an alternate, occurs in the Scroll (see #5, 1:13).

Based on the above, the following readings, vocalizations, and interpretations are offered for this phrase (including those of the scholars). In some the definite article are absent, in others the plural forms are unusual, but many similar cases do occur in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew.

בְּשֹׁחַת הָאֲדָמָה — (a) “in/at/by a/the plain of the land”; (b) “in/at/by the Shaveh/Plain of (the) Adamah.”

בְּשֹׁחַת הָאֲדָמָה, “in/at/by the Shaveh/Plain of (the) Admah.”

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה, “in/at/by the red plain,” or “in/at/by the Red Plain” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲרָכָא, “in/at/by a/the long plain,” or “in/at/by a/the Long Plain” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַת הָאֲרָכָא, “in/at/by the Shaveh/Plain of (the) Arkah” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַת הָאֲרָבָא, “In/at/by the Plain of (the) Locust” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַת הָאֲרָבָא, “in/at/by the Plain of (the) Arubbah” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה — (a) “in/at/by the (deep) clay pit”; (b) “in/at/by (the) (Deep) Clay Pit” (as toponym); (c) “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit of the clay-ground”; (d) “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit of the Adamah,” i.e., located in Adamah; (d) “in/at/by Shuah/Shiah/Shit Adamah” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה — (a) “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit of the Admah,” i.e., located in Admah; (b) “in/at/by Shuah/Shiah/Shit Admah” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲדָמָה — (a) “in/at/by a/the red (deep) pit”; (b) “in/at/by (the) Red (Deep) Pit” (as a toponym).

בְּשֹׁחַתְבִּישְׁחַבְשִׁית הָאֲרָבָא — (a) “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit(s) of (the) locust”; (b) “in/at/by the (Deep) Locust

37 Jastrow, 265a, 1047a.

Pit(s)” (as a toponym; cf. בּוֹר הַסֶּרָה, Bor-sirah).

(a) — בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת אֲרָבָא — “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit(s) of (the) lattice/window/sluice” (perhaps the pit(s) had an extra upper window); (b) “in/at/by the (deep) pit(s) of (the) Arubbah,” i.e., located in Arubbah (as a toponym).

בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא or בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא, “in/at/by a/the long (deep) pit(s).”

בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא - בְּשׁוּחַת־בְּשִׁיחַת־אֲרָבָא, “in/at/by a/the (deep) pit(s) of (the) Arkah,” i.e., owned by, named as, or located in Arkah.

Finally, Milik originally read בשוח סלע rather than בשוח הסלע in line 2:11. Following that approach, this phrase can be read as בְּשׁוּחַ סֶלַע or בְּשִׁיחַ סֶלַע, “in/at/by a/the pit of the rock,” and as בְּשִׁיחַ סֶלַע, “in/at/by a/the deep pit of the rock,” although the definite article is missing, i.e., הַסֶּלַע (see #10, 2:11).

(4:9-10) שְׁבִשׁוּלִי הָעֵצ לְאֹלָא (= לְהוֹלֹוֹבְהוּבֹ) כֶּסֶף כַּח מֵאֵתַיִן (4:9-10), “which is in/at/by the edge/bottom/base of the tree/wood, it has (or in it are) two hundred k(arsh) of silver.”³⁸

The first part of this phrase have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “which is the trunk of the tree, it has” (i.e., שְׁבִשׁוּלִי הָעֵצ לָא). ALLEGRO: עֲצָלָא, “which is in the bottom of the wine-press.” עֲצָלָא, “press,” a phonetic confusion between *lamed* and *reš*. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “which is through of the ...”³⁹ MILIK: שְׁבִשׁוּלִי הָעֵצָלָא, “situated at the outlet (of the spring) ha-‘Aṣla.” A large torrent in the Desert of Judah is called successively Mukellik, ‘Aṣla, and Daber.⁴⁰ LURIE: שְׁבִשׁוּלִי עֲצָלָא, “which is by the small spring.” שִׁילוּחַ, “spring,” is not identical with the Pool of שִׁילוּחַ, Siloam near Jerusalem. עֲצָלָא is related to עֲצָל, “to be lazy.” עֲצָלָא means “lazy spring,” i.e., “small spring.”⁴¹ PIXNER: “which is on the margin of Aṣla (הָעֵצָלָא).” North of Qumran there is a hill named Gofet el-Aṣla. Wadi el-Aṣla is the long Judean desert wadi opening to the northwest of the Dead Sea which is called successively Mukellik, ‘Aṣla, and Dabre.⁴² THORION: שִׁילוּחַ, the vocal “i” is spelled *plene*; cf. נִיקְרַת (1:12), גִּרְיִיזִין (12:4).⁴³ The rest of the scholars agree with Milik.⁴⁴

38 This suggestion is one of the alternates offered by Lefkovits^{diss} (1, 391, 398-99). It turns out to be somewhat similar to the translation given by Allegro^{pr}.

39 Allegro, 39, 137-38 n. 27 (*šālīm* is typographical error for *šūlayim*), 143 n. 91; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

40 Milik, 288-89, 239 C-5, 263 D-6; Milik^E, 140.

41 Lurie, 82 and nn. 2-3.

42 Pixner, 347-48 and n. 19.

43 Thorion, 165. Regarding שִׁילוּחַ, see #49, 10:15; #52, 11:7.

44 Wolters, 38-39; Garcia Martinez, 461; Bayer, 227-28; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193.

There are several possible word separations, readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the phrase in question.

שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הָעֵץ = שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי הָעֵץ, “which is in/at/by the edge/bottom/base of the tree/wood,” where שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵי refers to the tree.

שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵיהָ עֵץ = שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵיהָ עֵץ, “which in/at/by its (fem.) edge/bottom/base (there is a) tree/wood,” where שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵיהָ refers to the שְׁוֹחַשִׁיחַאשִׁית, “(deep) pit,” which in this case must be feminine.

שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵהָ הָעֵץ = שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵהָ הָעֵץ, “which in/at/by its (masc.) edge/bottom/base (there is) the tree/wood,” where שְׁבִשְׁוֹלֵהָ refers to the שְׁוֹחַשִׁיחַאשִׁית, “(deep) pit,” which in this case must be masculine. According to the last two suggestions, this item reports that in/at by the edge/bottom/base of the clay/red (deep) pit there is a tree, and that pit contains two hundred *kk* of silver.

שְׁוֹלֵי is the construct state of שְׁוֹלִים, which is always plural or dual. שְׁוֹלֵי consists of שְׁוֹלִים plus the third person masculine/feminine possessive suffix. For a detailed discussion of the term שְׁוֹלִים, see #38, 9:1.

עֵץ = עֵץ (masc.), “tree,” may be a collective noun, i.e., “wood.” For a further discussion, see #8, 2:5.

Since often the prepositions *bet* and *lamed* are interchanged, לוֹ = לָּהּ, “it (masc.) has,” could mean בּוֹ = בָּהּ, “in/at/by it (masc.),” and לָּהּ = לָּהּ, “it (fem.) has,” could mean בָּהּ, “in/at/by it (fem)” (archaic spellings, and/or ‘alef-mappiq *he* interchange). לָּהּ refers to שְׁוֹחַשִׁיחַאשִׁית, “(deep) pit.” If the latter is feminine (as it seems to be in the Scroll), then it should be vocalized as לָּהּ = לָּהּ = בָּהּ, if it is masculine (as in Mishnaic Hebrew), then it should be vocalized as לוֹ = לוֹ = בּוֹ (see #10, 2:11; #11, 2:14; #13, 3:9).

Such interchanges can be found in various sources. E.g., וְהָאִישׁ מִשְׁתַּאֵה לָּהּ is rendered by Onkelos as וְגִבְרָא שְׁהִי בָּהּ, “and the man stares at her” (Gen. 24:21); also,

אֲבָל מִקְוֵה שְׁאִין בּוֹ אֲרֻבָּעִים סָאָה וְנִפְלוּ בּוֹ שְׁלוֹשָׁה לֹגִין (but a ritual bath that does not have in it forty *se'ah* [water] and fell in it three *log* [of drawn water] ... כָּל מִקְוֵה שְׁאִין בּוֹ אֲרֻבָּעִים סָאָה וְנִפְלוּ לוֹ שְׁלוֹשָׁה לֹגִין (every ritual bath that does not have in it forty *se'ah* [water] and fell in it three *logs* [of drawn water]) ... הַבּוֹר שֶׁבְּחֶצֶר וְנִפְלוּ לוֹ שְׁלוֹשָׁה לֹגִין (the cistern which is in the courtyard and fell in it three *logs* [of drawn water] ... (m. Miq. 3:1-2).⁴⁵

45 Similarly, the Targum of וְלֹא תִשְׁקַר בִּי וּבִבְרִי וּבִרְבִּי אִין תִּשְׁקַר לִי וְלִנְיָנִי וְלִנְיָנִי (TO), אִין תִּשְׁקַר בִּי וּבִבְרִי וּבִרְבִּי אִין תִּשְׁקַר לִי וְלִנְיָנִי (PsJ), “that you neither will deal with me falsely, nor with my son, nor with my son’s son” (Gen. 21:23). Rashi points out that לִפְשָׁתִים וְלִצְמָר means שֶׁל פְּשָׁתִים אוֹ שֶׁל צְמָר, “of (the) linen or of (the) wool” (Lev. 13:47), and לִפְשָׁתִים וְלִצְמָר means שֶׁל פְּשָׁתִים אוֹ שֶׁל צְמָר, “of (the) wool or of (the) linen” (Lev. 13:52). Likewise, לְתוֹךְ פִּי means בְּתוֹךְ פִּי, “in his mouth” (m. Ter. 8:2). Also see Radak, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion* on 1 Sam. 20:30; Ibn-Ezra, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion* on Ps. 45:15; S.Z. Hanau, *Binyan Šelomoh* (1708), 97b; W. Chomsky, “The Ambiguity of the Prefixed Prepositions ב, ל, in the Bible,” *JQR* 61 (1970), 87-89; C.F. Whitley, “Some Functions of the Hebrew Particles *Beth* and *Lamedh*,” *JQR* 62 (1971-72), 199-206.

Likewise, the Scroll uses both **שָׁל** and **שָׁבֿ** interchangeably; e.g., **בִּיגְרוֹבִיגְר**, **שָׁל גִּי הַסֶּכָּא** (or **שָׁלִגִּי**), "In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by the Valley of Secacah" (see #20, 4:13), vs. **בִּיגְרוֹבִיגְר שְׁבָמְגוֹת הַבוֹהֶן הַגְּדוֹל**, "In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by the Bridge/Pass of the High Priest" (6:14-7:1).

The phrases, **בְּשִׁיחַ ... לְאוֹלָא כֶּסֶף כַּח מֵאתִין**, "In a/the pit ... in it (there are) two hundred k(arsh) of silver"; **בּוֹ בְּלוֹבְבוֹר ... בּוֹ בְּלִין**, "In a/the cistern ... in it (masc., there are) vessels" (2:7-8); **בּוֹ בְּלִי דְּמַע**, "In a/the grave ... in it (masc., there are) dedicated vessels" (11:9-10); **בְּשִׁית־בְּשִׁית ... כָּל שְׁבָאוֹשְׁבָא חֲרָם**, "In a/the deep pit ... everything in it (fem.) is consecrated" (9:14-16); as well as **בְּאֵא ... בְּבִרְכָּא־בְּבִרְכָּא**, "In a/the pool ... in it (fem.)" (2:13); resemble the verse, **וְהָיָה עֵץ אִם אֵין**, "and what (about) the land (of Canaan) ... whether there are trees in it (fem.) or not" (Num. 13:20); and the Mishnaic usage **בּוֹ בְּיוֹם**, "on that day" (e.g., m. Yad. 4:1). Moreover, in these cases in the Scroll, the first *bet* should be rendered as "in," since it is followed by the words "in it." Regarding the abbreviation **כַּח**, see Appendix A.

On the other hand, the five letters after **שְׁבָשׁוּלִי** may constitute a single word, i.e., **הַעֲצֵלָא**, as the scholars suggest. If so, the word is interrupted, **הַעֲצֵ** is at the end of line 4:9, while **לָא** is at the beginning of the next line. Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1-2.

There are several possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for the difficult word **הַעֲצֵלָא**.

הַעֲצֵלָא, **שְׁבָשׁוּלִי הַעֲצֵלָא**, "in/at/by (the) rim of the (place/wadi) 'Eṣelah" (cf. Milik, Pixner) — The Targum of **עֲצֵלָא** is **עֲטָלָא**, "lazy, slow" (Prov. 10:26; *šade-ṭet* interchange).⁴⁶ In addition, **עֲטָל** is a personal name; e.g., "Rabbi Hanina the son of 'Atal" (Esth. Rabbah Uvimelo^t).⁴⁷ **עֲצֵל** (masc.) or **עֲצֵלָה** (fem.), a variant of **עֲטָל**, could be name of a person, place, wadi, etc.

הַעֲצֵלָא־הַעֲצֵלָא for **שְׁבָשׁוּלִי הַעֲצֵלָא־הַעֲצֵלָא**, "which is in/at/by (the) rim of the (place/wadi) Ezlah/Azelah" — Jastrow renders **עֲצֵל** (masc.) as "(standing aside), slow, sluggard, lazy," and compares it to **אֲצֵל**, "by the side of, near, with"⁴⁸ (cf. Lurie). **עֲצֵלָא** may be a variant of **אֲצֵלָא**, an *'alef-ayin* interchange; cf. **אֲכַל** (BH, MH) vs. **עָכַל** (MH, JA), "to eat, consume." Accordingly, **עֲצֵלָא** = **אֲצֵלָא** may be a variant of: (1) **בֵּית הָאֲצֵל**, Beth-ezel (Micah 1:11) in Judah. (2) **אֲצֵל**, Azel (Zech. 14:5) near Mount Olives. (3) **אֲצֵל־אֲצֵל**, Azel, a descendant of King Saul; e.g., **אֲלֵה בְּנֵי ... וְלְאֲצֵל שֵׁשָׁה בְּנִים**, "and for Azel (there were) six sons ... these are the children of Azel" (1 Chron. 9:44, cf. 8:37-38).

46 Such interchange occurs also within Hebrew; e.g., **וְאֶקֶץ**, "and I was disgusted" (Lev. 20:23), vs. **אֶקֶט**, "I was disgusted" (Ps 95:10).

47 See also AC 6, 186b; Jastrow, 1063b.

48 Jastrow, 111a, 1102b.

ITEM 19

4:11 בשית־בשית המזרחית שבצפון כח<->
4:12 לת כסף ככ שבעין

4:11 In the eastern deep pit which is at the north of Kahe-
4:12 let, (there is) seventy k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(4:11-12) בשית־בשית המזרחית שבצפון (= שבצפון) כחלת — “In/at/by the eastern deep pit which is in/at (the) north of Kahelet” — The first word can also be read as בשית־בשית המזרחית שבצפון, “in/at/by a/the pit” (see #18, 4:9). Eastern deep pit suggests that Kahelet had more than one pit.

This phrase can be compared to: בשית־בשית שִׁיבְצָפוֹן פִּי הַצֹּק שֶׁל בֵּית תָּמָר, “In/at/by a/the deep pit which is in/at/by (the) northern edge of the peak of Beth-Tamar” (see #43, 9:14-15); בשית־בשית שְׁבִינְחָא שְׁבִינְחָא בְּצָפוֹן כחלת, “In a/the deep pit which is in/at (the) Janoah in/at (the) north of Kahelet” (see #60, 12:10); and בְּבִרְכָא בְּבִרְכָא שְׁבִמְזִרָה כחלת, “In/at a/the pool which is in/at (the) east of Kahelet” (see #11, 2:13). In these cases the direction is in the construct state.¹ Cf. בְּגִלְגַל בְּקֶצֶה מִזְרָח יְרִיחוֹ, “in the Gilgal in/at a border of east of Jericho,” i.e., “in Gilgal, at the eastern border of Jericho” (Josh. 4:19).

Additional cases of צפון in the Scroll are: צפון, “north” (8:12); מן הצפון, “from the north” or “northward” (1:11, 5:2); ממזרחו בצפון־בצפון, “from its (masc.) east at (the) north,” i.e., “in/at (the) northeast” (3:11-12); בצפונו, “in its north” (4:2); מבצפונו, “from in its north” (3:8); and הצפוני, הצפוני, “the northern” (2:14, 6:3, 7:4, respectively). Also, once צפון can be vocalized either as צפון, “north,” or צפון, “hidden” (see #60, 12:10).²

In the Masoretic Text בצפון and בדרום appear only in the verse, ואם יפול

1 That is, בצפון של = שבצפון; שבצפון של = שבצפון; and שבמזרח של = שבמזרח.

2 The other directions also occur in the Scroll. דרום, “south” (10:1); בדרום־בדרום, “in (the) south” (8:11); הדרומית, “the southern (fem.)” (3:1, 11:2); מזרח, “east” (6:2, 9:5); (the) south” (8:11); מזרח, “east of” (8:1 and 5:5, respectively); מן המזרח, “from/to the east” (2:10); למזרח־למזרח, “to (the) east” (1:2, 6:9); שמזרח, “which is east of” (8:2); שבמזרח, “which is at east of” (2:13); המזרחית, “the eastern (fem.)” (3:5, 4:11, 7:12); מערב, “west” (8:11, 11:5); מן המערב, “from/to the west” (12:1, alt.); המערבי, “the western (masc.)” (6:12, 10:8, 11:16); מן הצד המערבי, “from/to the western side” (10:12-13); המערבית, “the western (fem.)” (3:10); ים, “sea, west” (9:7); לים־מול־ים, “to (the) sea/west” (11:13, alt.). See #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

עץ בדרום ואם בצפון, “and if a tree falls in the south or if in the north” (Eccl. 11:3), but neither occurs במזרח, “in the east,” nor במערב, “in the west.” However, these are commonly used in Mishnaic Hebrew.³ E.g.,

There were seven gates in the (Temple) courtyard. שלושה בצפון (three at the north), ואחד במזרח (and one at the east), ושלושה בדרום (and three at the south), שני לו שער (which on the south), שער הדלק (Gate of the Fire), שני לו שער המים (third [next] to it, Gate of the Firstlings), שער המים (second [next] to it, Gate of the Water). שער המזרח (which on the east), (the) Gate of Nicanor ... ושער הנצוץ (and which on the north), שער הנצוץ (Gate of the Spark), and it was like an אכסדרה (exedra), ועליה בניה על גביו (and an upper room was built on it) ... ופתח היה לו לחיל (and it had an opening to the rampart), שני שער הקרבן (second [next] to it, Gate of the Sacrifices), שער המוקד (third [next] to it, [Gate of the] Room of the Hearth) (m. Mid. 1:4-5).⁴

And there were thirty eight cells (in the Sanctuary), fifteen בצפון (at the north), fifteen בדרום (at the south), and eight במערב (at the west). שבצפון (which [were] at the north) and שבדרום (which [were] at the south), were five on top of five, and five on top of them. And שבמערב (which [were] at the west), three on top of there and two on top of them (m. Mid. 4:3).

שבצפון has a final *ṣade* in medial position, while later it is spelled with an extra *yod* and a regular *ṣade*. It is like the final *nun* in פנת (= פנת), “corner (tower) of” (11:2);⁵ cf. מזואת (= מצות), “unleavened breads, matzos” (4QPhyl M:14, twice, with an extra *’alef*);⁶ also למרבה (ketiv) vs. למרבה (qeri), “for the increase” (Isa. 9:6; see #3, 1:7);⁷

The toponym כחלת is interrupted, כח is at the end of line and לת is at the beginning of the next one. Regarding כחלת, see #4, 1:9; for interrupted words, #12, 3:1-2.

(4:12) כספ ככ שבעינ, “(there is) seventy k(arsh) of silver” — Regarding the abbreviation ככ, see Appendix A.

Finally, the spellings of כספ and שבעינ (medial *pe* and *nun* in final position), שבצפון (final *ṣade* in medial position), as well as the interrupted word of כחלת, clearly indicate scribal inconsistency (see #43, 9:14-15).

³ Bendavid (1, 99) considers בצפון and בצפון as Mishnaic Hebrew. He does not mention שבצפון of the Copper Scroll.

⁴ Many of these terms occur in the Scroll, אכסדרה (11:3), בית (2:3, 7:9, 8:1, etc.), חיל (10:15, alt.), מוקד (7:8, alt.), מים (5:1, 7:14, 9:11, 10:15), עליה (10:1), פתח (1:8, 1:11, 6:2, 6:3, 6:9, 10:10, 12:10), שלישי (1:5, 2:4), שני (1:1, 9:4, 10:1), שער (2:7).

⁵ Occasionally *waw* may be read as final *nun* in medial/final position in the Scroll (see #38, 9:2).

⁶ See *The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls*, 20 n. 11.

⁷ 1QIsa has למרבה, as the *qeri*. See *LLBIS*, 413.

ITEM 20

4:13 ביגר של גי הסככא חפור

4:14 אמה כספ ככ 12

4:13 In the heap which is in the Valley of Secacah, (there)
is buried

4:14 one cubit (deep) 12 k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(4:13) בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ שֶׁל גִּי הַסִּכְכָּא “In/at/by a/the heap of the Valley of Secacah” — בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ בִּיגְרוֹ — “in/at/by a/the heap,” occurs at two additional places in the Scroll (6:14, 8:8).

יֵגֶר has been translated as follows. ALLEGRO^{pr}: “hill (or heap of stones)”;
ALLEGRO: “dam-sluice (?)”;
ALLEGRO^{rev}: “dam (?)”;¹ MILIK: “tumulus”;²
LURIE: “dam, earth dike”;³ PIXNER: “stone mount” and “stone heap”;⁴ WOLTERS and WISE: “cairn”;⁵ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “(burial-) mound” and “burial-mound”;⁶ BEYER: “rubble heap, moraine”;⁷ VERMES: “heap of stones.”⁸

Scripture says, “And Laban called it (in Aramaic) יֵגֶר שְׁהָדוּתָא (Heap of Witness), but Jacob called it (in Hebrew) גִּלְעָד (Heap of Witness)” (Gen. 31:47).⁹ Since Jegar-sahadutha is in Aramaic, Onkelos does not translate it. However, Pseudo-Jonathan renders it as אוֹגֶר סְהִיד, and Neophyti as אוֹגֶר אוֹגֶר סְהִידוּתָא; cf. יֵגֶר סְהִידוּתָא (y. Shevi. 6:1 [17b]) vs. אִיגֶר סְהִידוּתָא (Rehob, line 17); and יֵגֶרִי טָב (t. Shevi. 4:8) vs. אִיגֶרִי חוּטָם (Rehob, line 11).¹⁰

יֵגֶר (masc.) may be an Aramaic loanword (perhaps it should be vocalized

1 Allegro^{pr}; Allegro, 39, 43, 47, 143-44 n. 95; Allegro^{rev}, 23-24.

2 Milik^E, 140-41; Milik, 289, 291, 293, 245 C-77.

3 Lurie: 83-84 and n. 1, 94-95 and n. 1, 99-100 (יֵגֶר in the translation must be a typographical error).

4 Pixner, 348, 349, 351.

5 Wolters, 39, 43, 47; Wise, 193-95.

6 Garcia Martinez, 461-62.

7 Beyer, 228, 230.

8 Vermes, 375-76.

9 Similarly, the Targum for גְּלִים (pl. of גֶּל) is יֵגֶרִין or יֵגֶרִין (pl. of יֵגֶר), “heaps” (Jer. 9:10). The Targum leaves untranslated גְּלִים, Gallim (Heaps, 1 Sam. 25:44) and בֵּת גְּלִים, Bath-gallim (Daughter of Heaps, Small Heap, Isa. 10:30).

10 See Y. Sussmann, “כתובת הלכית מעמק בית-שאן” in *Tarbiz* 43 (1973/74), 125; “בריתא דתחומי ארץ ישראל” in *Tarbiz* 45 (1975/76), 237-38.

Kidron" (see #35, 8:8); and *בְּיָמֵימָּה שֶׁל גֵּיא וְךָ*, "In/at/by a/the pool which is in (the) Pure Valley" (see #47, 10:8), vs. *בְּיָמֵימָּה שֶׁבְּמִגְזֵת הַכּוֹהֵן הַגָּדוֹל*, "In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by the Bridge/Pass of the High Priest" (see #28, 6:14-7:1); also, *בְּגֵי הַחֲצוֹנָא*, "In/at/by the Outer Valley" (see #34, 8:4). *גֵּי* as an alternate reading occurs twice in the Scroll (see #43, 9:15).

The dual gender *גֵּי וְגֵיא* (abs., *גֵּיא וְגֵיא*, const.), "valley, gorge," is several times in the Masoretic Text the first element of compound toponyms. It is spelled with and without a silent final *'alef*.¹⁷ E.g., *וְגֵיא בֶן הַנֶּם כִּי אִם גֵּיא*, *וְהַרְגָה*, "and the Valley of the Son of Hinnom but the Valley of Slaughter" (Jer. 7:32, 19:6); the variants *גֵּי מֶלַח*, *גֵּיא מֶלַח*, *גֵּי הַמֶּלַח*, and *גֵּיא הַמֶּלַח*, Valley of Melah or Valley of Salt (e.g., 2 Sam. 8:13; 2 Kgs 14:7, *ketiv-qeri*).

סֶכְכָּה, Secacah (Covered [area], Booth), as well as *סֻכּוֹת*, Succoth (Booths, Gen. 33:17; Exod. 12:37; 1 Kgs 7:46), are from the root *סִכַּךְ* - *שָׁכַךְ*, "to cover, protect, weave together."¹⁸ Prior to the deciphering of the Scroll, the only known reference of Secacah appeared in the Masoretic Text. Secacah is one of six cities in the Wilderness of Judea in the vicinity of *יָם הַמֶּלַח*, the Salt Sea (commonly known as the Dead Sea), allotted to the Tribe of Judah: "Beth-Arabah, Middin, and *סֶכְכָּה* (Secacah), and Nibshan, and *עִיר הַמֶּלַח* (the City of Salt), and Ein-Gedi" (Josh. 15:61-62).

The Scroll mentions four times Secacah with the following details. The existence of a Valley of Secacah; there was a hill (or stone heap, grave site); in it (this item). The city of Secacah must have been located in this valley. From the north a water canal entered Secacah. At the start of this canal there was a large stone monument or a sealing stone (5:1-2). There was a fissure in Secacah east of the Pool of Solomon. This pool was located in or near Secacah (5:5-6). The Trench of Solomon seems to be connected with the Pool of Solomon, and located in or near Secacah. The Large Sepulcher (or large earth clod, Regev, Ragav) was not far from Secacah (5:8-9). Wadi Kippah or Wadi Kefah connected Jericho with Secacah. There was a tomb in this wadi (5:12-13). If *מֶלַח*, Melah, of the Scroll is identical with *עִיר הַמֶּלַח*, City of Salt, then it was located near Secacah (see #13, 3:8).

Sacacah has been identified with the following places. ALLEGRO: Khirbet Zaraniq, Khirbet 'Abu Tabaq, or Khirbet Qumran.¹⁹ MILIK: Khirbet Samra, the central ruin of el-Buqe'ah, not far from Qumran.²⁰ LURIE: It is located

17 Regarding *גֵּי* and *וְךָ*, Thorion (198) notes that already in the Masoretic Text the silent *'alef* after a vocal occasionally disappeared.

18 BDB, 697a-98a; SB, 594a.

19 Allegro, 144-47 n. 97. Also, W.H. Brownlee, *The Meaning of the Qumran Scrolls for the Bible* (1964), 58-60; R. De Vaux, *Archaeology and the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1973), 91-94.

20 Milik, 263 D-7; Milik^E, 146. F.M. Cross, Jr., and J.T. Milik, "Explorations in the Judaean Buqe'ah," *BASOR* 142 (1956), 15-17; J.T. Milik, *Ten Years of Discovery in the Wilderness of Judaea* (1959), 51 n. 1.

between En-gedi and Wadi Qalt.²¹ PIXNER: Khirbet Qumran.²² AHARONI: Karm as-Sumra.²³ BEYER: גִּי הַסֶּכְכָּה is Wadi Qumran.²⁴ WISE: Many scholars think that Secacah is the ancient name for Qumran.²⁵

(4:13-14) 12 חֲפֹרִי־חֶפֶז אֶמָּה כֶּסֶף כֹּךְ, “(there) is buried one cubit (deep) 12 k(arsh) of silver,” or “dig one cubit (deep, there is) 12 k(arsh) of silver” — Regarding חֶפֶז, see #17, 4:7.

אֶמָּה has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO: אֶמָּה, “one cubit.”²⁶ MILIK: אֶמָּה (defective for אַמּוֹת), “<...> cubits” (the numerical value is missing due to a scribal error). Alternately, אֶמָּה, “one cubit.”²⁷ BEYER: אֶמָּה-אֶחָד, <one> cubit.²⁸ WILMOT: for אֶמָּה כֶּסֶף read אֶמָּה כֶּסֶף <שְׁלוֹשׁ>? אֶמָּה.²⁹ LURIE, WOLTERS, and VERMES follow Milik, while PIXNER, GARCIA MARTINEZ, and WISE agree with Allegro.³⁰

The letters *he*, *het*, and *taw* are often indistinguishable in the Scroll. Thus, this word can be read as אַמּוֹת (pl., defective) or אֶמָּה (sg.). Since no numerical value is mentioned, the correct reading is אֶמָּה, “one cubit” (Allegro). This suggestion is somewhat similar to the case where the drawings of Baker and Milik have אֶמָּה = אֶמָּה while Allegro’s has אֶמָּה = אֶמָּה (see #11, 2:14).

In the verse עֶשְׂרֵי אַמּוֹת אֶרֶץ הַקֶּרֶשׁ וְאַמָּה וַחֲצִי הָאַמָּה רֹחַב הַקֶּרֶשׁ הָאֶחָד, “Ten cubits is the length of the beam, and one cubit and one half cubit the width of one beam,” i.e., each beam is twenty by one and half cubits (Exod. 36:21), אֶמָּה means “one cubit,” and אַמּוֹת is spelled defectively. Likewise in the Scroll, שָׁמ קָלִל בּוֹ סֶפֶר אֶחָד, “three (is) a *qalal* (vessel), in it (there is) one document” (see #25, 6:5). Regarding אֶמָּה, see #1, 1:2-3.

The drawings of BAKER and MILIK read 12 כֹּכ. ALLEGRO’s drawing after כֹּכ has a lacuna of about two letter spaces, followed by a numeral fragment and then by two vertical lines. Therefore, ALLEGRO reads “kk [...] 3+”³¹; cf. the lacuna in line 3:13. Regarding the abbreviation כֹּכ, see Appendix A.

21 Lurie, 83-83 n. 3.

22 Pixner, 336, 348 n. 21

23 Y. Aharoni, *Carta’s Atlas of the Bible* (Heb., 1974), 83 map 130, 111 map 173, 124b. See also, Z. Kalai, “סֶכְכָּה” in *EB* 5, 1044-45.

24 Beyer, 227-28.

25 Wise, 193.

26 Allegro^{PF}; Allegro, 39; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

27 Milik, 288-89, 228 B-5b; Milik^E, 140.

28 Beyer, 227-28.

29 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20.

30 Lurie, 83-84; Wolters, 38-39; Vermes, 375; Pixner, 348; Garcia Martinez, 461, Wise, 193.

31 Allegro, 39 (“kk[...] 3+” seems to be is a typographical error for “kk [...]3+” or “kk [...] 3+”).

ITEM 21

5:1 בְּרוֹשׁ אֲמַת הַמִּימָה [הַבָּאָה ל־]
 5:2 סַכְכָּא מִן הַצִּפּוֹן ת[חַת הָאֲבָן]
 5:3 הַגְּדוּלָּא חֲפוּר אֲמ[וֹת שְׁלוֹ-]
 5:4 שׁ כֶּסֶף כֶּכ 7

5:1 At the head of the water canal [that goes to]
 5:2 Secacah from the north, be[low] the large
 5:3 [stone (monument)], is buried [thr]ee cu-
 5:4 [bits] (deep) 7 k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(5:1) בְּרוֹשׁ אֲמַת הַמִּימָה [הַבָּאָה ל־] סַכְכָּא מִן הַצִּפּוֹן (5:1) “In/at/by the head of the water canal [that comes/goes to] Secacah from/to the north” — The first word, בְּרוֹשׁ, is a phonetic spelling for בְּרָאשׁ, *waw* instead of *’alef*, like שְׁלוֹמוֹ for שְׁלֹמֹה and לְסִמּוּלוֹ for לְשִׁמְאֵלוֹ (see #22, 5:6; #23, 5:8-9; #46, 10:6). בְּרָאשׁ, is in the construct state (same as the non-construct שֵׁל בְּרָאשׁ), “in/at/by (the) head of”; e.g., בְּרָאשׁ הַר גֵּרִיזִים, “at the top of Mount Gerizim” (Judg. 9:7). רֹאשׁ (masc., pl. רְאשִׁים/ן, BH, MH; רֵאשׁ, A), “head, start,” is later spelled with a hanging *reš* (scribal correction), *’alef*, and *šin* in the phrase, בִּתְבַסֵּת רֹאשׁ הַפֶּלֶע, “In/at/by (the) ruin of the top of the rock” (see #52, 11:5). רֹאשׁ is spelled several ways in the Dead Sea Scrolls; e.g., רֹאשׁ (4Q216 f1i:4), רוֹשׁ (4Q325 f1:3,6), בְּרוֹשׁוֹ (1QS 7:8), רֹאוֹשׁ (1QIsa. 1:5; 4Q418 f126ii:7), and רוֹאשׁ (1QIsa. 1:6). These may indicate that the *’alef* was not pronounced any more.¹

The phrase after בְּרוֹשׁ has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO: אֲמַת הַמִּימָה סַכְכָּא [(?) הַבָּאָה], “the water conduit [which penetrates (?)] Secacah.”² MILIK: אֲמַת הַמִּימָה שֵׁן סַכְכָּא, “the aqueduct which is [at] Sekaka.”³ LURIE: אֲמַת

1 In the Masoretic Text רֹאשׁ is always spelled with an *’alef* (600 times). However, its homonym, רֹאשׁ, “bitter, poisonous herb,” occurs 12 times, and once is spelled as רוֹשׁ (Deut. 32:32). Cf. לוֹמַר (MH) vs. לֵאמֹר (BH), “to say”; cf. יֹאמַר (1QIsa. 8:1) and יֹאמַר (1QIsa. 1:11), vs. יֵאמַר (BH), “he will say.” *’alef* with a *holam* is often represented by a *waw* in Mishnaic Hebrew, and by a *waw*, *waw* plus *’alef*, or *’alef* plus *waw* in the Dead Sea Scrolls (see LLBIS, 16-17, 125; E. Qimron, *The Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1986), 17-18, 20-23; Thorion, 168). See also #22, 5:6.

2 Allegro, 41, 147 n. 100; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

3 Milik, 290-91; Milik^E, 140 (there is a typographical error in the reading; the suggested

ככא, "the water canal [which comes to] Secacah."⁴ BEYER: "the water canal [which goes to] Sokoka (Qumran)."⁵ VERMES: "the water conduit [... at] Sekhakha."⁶ WISE: "At the head of the aqueduct [of the] Secacah [Valley]."⁷ PIXNER and GARCIA MARTINEZ follow Milik.⁸ WOLTERS does not restore the lacuna."⁹

The following are some of the possible restorations, vocalizations, and interpretations for this phrase. They include the scholars suggestions.

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [הַבָּאָה אֶל] סֶכְכָּא or בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [הַבָּאָה לְ] סֶכְכָּאֵל[סֶכְכָּא, "In/at/by the head of the water canal [that comes/goes to (the)] Secacah" (cf. Lurie and Beyer, respectively); cf. [...] אֶלְוִלְמוֹמְ, "In/at/by a/the water canal that come[s/goe[s to/from ...]" (see #16, 4:4); וְאֶקְבָּצֻם אֶל הַנָּהָר הַבָּא אֶל אַחָוָה, "And I (Ezra) gathered them (the Jews who went up to Jerusalem) to the river that comes/goes to Ahava (in Babylon)" (Ezra 8:15).

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [הַבָּאָה מִן] סֶכְכָּא or בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [הַבָּאָה מִן] סֶכְכָּא, "In/at/by the head of the water canal [that comes/goes from] Secacah"; cf. בְּקֶבֶר-, "In/at/by a/the grave which is in Wadi Kefah/Kippah, as it comes/goes from Jericho to Sacacah" (see #24, 5:12-13).

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁבִּן סֶכְכָּא\שֶׁבִּן סֶכְכָּאֵל] (which is in/of (the)) Secacah" (cf. Milik); cf. בְּסִדְקִי\בְּסִדְקִי שֶׁבִּסֶּכְכָּא\שֶׁבִּסֶּכְכָּא, "In/at/by a/the fissure which is in (the) Secacah" (see #22, 5:5).

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁל] הַסֶּכְכָּא or בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁל] סֶכְכָּא, "In/at/by the head of the water canal [which is in/of (the)] Secacah."

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁל גִּי] הַסֶּכְכָּא or בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁל גִּי] סֶכְכָּא, "In/at/by the head of the water canal [which is in/of (the) Valley of] Secacah" (cf. Wise); cf. בִּגְרִיבִיגֵר שֶׁל גִּי הַסֶּכְכָּא, "In/at/by a/the heap of the Valley of Secacah" (see #20, 4:3).

בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁבְּגִי] הַסֶּכְכָּא or בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם [שֶׁבְּגִי] סֶכְכָּא, "In/at/by the head of the water canal [which is in/of (the) Valley of] Secacah"; cf. בְּגִי, "In the outer Valley (see #34, 8:4).

Concerning these restorations, it should be noted. (1) The biblical phrase בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם הַבָּאָה אֶל is masculine, while both בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם הַבָּאָה אֶל and בְּרוֹשׁ אֶמֶת הַמַּיִם הַבָּאָה אֶל are feminine. (2) The prepositions אל and ל have the same meaning, אל is more common in Biblical Hebrew than ל, while in Mishnaic Hebrew

reconstruction is in the note).

4 Lurie, 85-86, 85 n. 2 (there is a typographical error in the reading; the suggested reconstruction is in the note).

5 Beyer, 227-28; cf. Lefkovits^{diss} 1, 372, 417, 419-422.

6 Vermes, 375.

7 Wise, 193.

8 Pixner, 348; Garcia Martinez, 462.

9 Wolters, 40-41.

the opposite is true. **אֶל** occurs in the Scroll, **אֶל הַכֵּלִין**, “in/among the vessels” (see #33, 8:3), and **אֶל סְמַל**, “to the left” (1:13, alt.), but **ל**- is used more often, e.g., **הַבּוֹאֹת לְמִזְרָח וּלְמִמְּוָה**, “which are coming/going to the east” (see #1, 1:2). The preposition **מ**- is a contracted form of **מִן**. (3) **שֶׁב**- and **שֶׁל** are practically interchangeable. (4) If the text is restored as **לְסִכְכָּא** [הַסִּכְכָּא], or **שֶׁב־סִכְכָּא**, then the word is interrupted, the restored part is at the end of line 5:1, and **סִכְכָּא** is at the beginning of the next one. Regarding Secacah, see #20, 4:13; for interrupted words, #12, 3:1-2.

אַמָּה (fem., pl. **אַמּוֹת**, BH, MH; **אַמִּין**, A) means “forearm” and “cubit” (i.e., the distance between the elbow and the top of the middle finger; see #1, 1:2-3). In Mishnaic Hebrew it also means “canal, channel, aqueduct.”¹⁰ According to Rashi, **אַמָּה**, “canal,” is so named because it is one **אַמָּה**, “cubit,” deep and one **אַמָּה**, “cubit,” wide (b. B.Q. 50b). Jastrow defines **אַמָּה** (MH) as “water canal, river arm, canal dike, sewer.”¹¹ The term **אַמָּה**, “water canal,” occurs in the Scroll four times (1:11, 4:3, 5:1, 7:3); plus in a possible restoration, **מֵא** [בֵּא] (Milik, see #33, 8:1). **אַמָּה**, “canal,” was made in the same manner as **בּוֹר**, **שִׁיחַ**, **מַעְרָה**, **מַקְוֵה**, etc. (cf. **בְּקֶרֶת הַטְּבִילָה**, “cave of the immersion”; see #4, 1:12). **מַיִם**, “water,” occurs in additional three times in the Scroll (7:17, 9:11, 10:15). The verb **בּוֹא**, “to come, go, arrive, enter,” when it refers to a body of water, means “to flow, run.” Verbal and nominal forms of this root occurs nine times in the Scroll (e.g., 4:3). Both **אַמַּת הַמַּיִם** and the shortened **אַמָּה** are common in Mishnaic Hebrew.¹² E.g.,

Rabbi Judah said, “It was a precedent **מֵאֲבֵל לְצִפּוֹרִי בָּאָה שְׁהִיָּתָה** (with the water canal that used to come/go from Abel to Sepphoris) and at the advise of the sages (people) used to draw water from it on Sabbath” (t. ‘Eruv. 9:26).

On the fifteenth (of Adar) representatives of the Court (of Jerusalem) are going (to the country site) **וְחוֹפְרִין אֶת הַבּוֹרוֹת וְאֶת הַשִּׁיחִין וְאֶת הַמַּעְרֹת וְאֶת הַמַּקְוֹת** (and they are hollowing out the cisterns, the pits, the caves, the ritual baths, and the water canals) (t. Sheq. 1:2).

The phrase **מִן הַצָּפוֹן**, “from/on/to the north,” is ambiguous. If the text is restored as **לְהַבְאָה אֶל־סִכְכָּא** [הַבְּאָה אֶל־סִכְכָּא], it may indicate that: (1) the water canal is coming from the north to Secacah; (2) there were more than one canal in that region; (3) the cache was located north of the water canal below a large stone

10 Perhaps **אַמָּה** (BH, MH), “hand-maid,” is related to **אַמָּה**, “forearm.” Cf. **וְהִשְׁלָחָה אֶת אֲמָתָהּ**, “and (Pharaoh’s daughter) sent her maid servant and took it (the floating box in which the baby Moses was)” (Exod. 2:5). In the Talmud, “Rabbi Judah and Rabbi Nehemiah (expounded), one says ‘her maid servant,’ the other says ‘her hand’ (as it were vocalized as **אַמָּתָהּ**)” (b. Soṭ. 12b; see also Rashi on the above verse).

11 Jastrow, 75b; cf. ESh^{dic} 1, 104b.

12 Sharvit notes that **אַמַּת הַמַּיִם** is Mishnaic Hebrew (“Iyyunim,” 131).

or monument. If it is restored as [הבאה מן]סככא, then the water is coming from Secacah from the north, i.e., both the water source and Secacah are north of the location of this cache. If the text is restored as [שב]סככא, or [שבגי ה]סככה, or [של גי ה]סככה, then the canal was located in the city of Secacah, or in the Valley of Secacah, and the cache was located northward of the water canal below the large stone (monument). Regarding geographical directions, see #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

Finally, the first part of this item resembles the verse, וְנָהָר יֵצֵא מֵעֵדֶן, “And a river goes out from Eden to water the garden, and from there it divides and becomes four heads” (Gen. 2:10). The Targumim render ראשים, “heads,” as רִישֵׁי נְהָרִין, “river heads” (TO, PsJ), and ראשי נהרין רבִּרְבִּין, “large river heads” (TN). The middle part of this item resembles the verse, הִנֵּה מַיִם עֹלִים מִצָּפוֹן וְהֵיוּ לְנַחַל, “Behold, waters are rising out of north, and they shall become a swift river” (Jer. 47:2).

(5:2-3) תַּחַת הָאֲבֵן הַגְּדוֹלָא, “be[low] the large [stone (monument)]” — ALLEGRO¹³: “u[nder ? ...] the great [...]” (i.e., תַּחַת הַגְּדוֹלָא [...]). ALLEGRO: תַּחַת הַיִּמָּא (?), “u[nder (?)] the great [settling basin (?)].” ALLEGRO¹⁴: “under the great [...]”¹³ MILIK: תַּחַת הָאֲבֵן הַגְּדוֹלָא, “under the large stone.”¹⁴ BEYER: תַּחַת הַיִּד הַגְּדוֹלָא, “beneath the great [monument].”¹⁵ VERMES follows Allegro¹⁶, while the other scholars agree with Milik.¹⁶

The restoration of תַּחַת seems to be certain. Regarding תַּחַת, see #25, 6:5; #49, 10:15.

הַגְּדוֹלָא (i.e., the feminine adjective גְּדוֹלָה, “large, big, great,” plus the definite article), must refer to a feminine noun (with or without the definite article). Therefore, any feminine noun that appropriate, could be suggested for restoration. The following, using only the limited vocabulary of the Scroll, are some possibilities.

תַּחַת אֲבֵן הַגְּדוֹלָא (Milik) or תַּחַת אֲבֵן הַגְּדוֹלָא, “be[low] the large [stone (monument)]”; cf. עִם הָאֲבֵן הַגְּדוֹלָה, “with the large stone” (2 Sam. 20:8); תַּחַת הָאֲבֵן הַשְּׁחוּרָא, “below the black stone” (see #56, 12:2); עַד בּוֹר הַגְּדוֹל, “till the large pit” (1 Sam. 19:22). Regarding אֲבֵן, see #47, 10:9.

תַּחַת הַיִּד הַגְּדוֹלָא or תַּחַת הַיִּד הַגְּדוֹלָא, “be[low] the large [monument]”

13 Allegro, 41; Allegro, 23.

14 Milik, 289. Milik places a dot above the *het*, and Beyer has a regular *het*. Both readings are surprising, since the three drawings have only a *taw* before the lacuna, but no *het* nor a letter fragment.

15 Beyer, 227-28.

16 Vermes, 375; Lurie, 86; Pixner, 348; Lurie, 85; Pixner, 348; Wolters, 40-41; Garcia Martinez, 462; Wise, 193.

(cf. Beyer); cf. *אֶת הַיָּד הַגְּדֹלָה*, “the great hand” (Exod. 14:31); *תַּחַת יָד*, “below the monument of Absalom” (10:12); *תַּחַת יַד פַּרְעֹה*, “under the hand of Pharaoh” (Gen. 41:35).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת מַסְמָא], “be[low] the large [sealing-stone]”; cf. *תַּחַת הַמַּסְמָא הַגְּדֹלָא* (see #52, 11:6-7).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת הַמַּסְבָּא] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת מַסְבָּא], “be[low] the large [stair-case]”; cf. *בְּשֵׂיַת הַמַּסְבָּא*, “In the tower of the staircase” (see #5, 1:13).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת הַחוּמָא] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת חוּמָא], “be[low] the large [city-wall]”; cf. *בְּכוּרֵי בְּבוּר שְׂתַחַת הַחוּמָא*, “In/at/by a/the pit/cistern which is below the city wall” (2:10).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת הַמַּעְלָא] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת מַעְלָא], “be[low] the large [step(s)]”; cf. *תַּחַת הַמַּעְלָהּא שֶׁל הַשֵּׁת הָעֲלִיּוֹנָא*, “below the steps of the upper deep pit” (12:4); *בְּבוּר הַמֶּלַח שְׂתַחַת הַמַּעְלֹת*, “In/at/by the salt pit which is below the steps” (2:1).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת מַשְׁמְרָהוּמַשְׁמְרָת] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת הַמַּשְׁמְרָהוּמַשְׁמְרָת], “be[low] the large [guard post]”; *תַּחַת פְּנֵת הַמַּשְׁמְרָהוּמַשְׁמְרָת הַמְּזֻרְחִית*, “below the corner of the eastern guard post” (7:11-12).

הַגְּדֹלָא [תַּחַת שׁוּקָת] or *הַגְּדֹלָא* [תַּחַת הַשׁוּקָת], “be[low] the large [sink]”; cf. *לְתַחַת הַשִּׁקָּת*, “below the sink” (10:15-16).

חֲפוּרֵי כֶסֶף שְׁלֹשׁ אַמּוֹת [שְׁלֹשׁ כֶּסֶף כֶּכָּ 7] (5:3-4), “is buried [thr]ee cu[bits] (deep) 7 k(arsh) of silver,” or “dig [thr]ee cu[bits] (deep, there are) 7 k(arsh) of silver”; cf. *חֲפוּרֵי כֶסֶף שְׁלֹשׁ אַמּוֹת* [שְׁלֹשׁ כֶּסֶף כֶּכָּ 23] (23 k(arsh) of silver,” or “dig three cubits (deep, there are) 23 k(arsh) of silver” (see #23, 5:10-11).

אַמּוֹת שְׁלֹשׁ is the scholars restoration.¹⁷ MILIK offers two additional solutions, *אַמּוֹת חֲמִשׁ*, “[fi]ve cub[its],” and *אַמּוֹת שְׁלֹשׁ*, “[si]x cub[its].”¹⁸ All three suggestions are acceptable. Accordingly, the second partially restored word is interrupted, the restored part is at the end of the line, and the *šin* is at the beginning of the next one. Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1-2; for *חֲפוּר*, #17, 4:7; for *אַמָּה*, #1, 1:2-3; for *כֶּכָּ*, Appendix A.

17 Allegro^{Pr}; Allegro, 41, 147 n. 102; Allegro^{rev}, 23; Milik, 290; Milik^E, 140; Wolters, 40; Garcia Martinez, 462; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193. Beyer (227) restores the text as *אַמּוֹת שְׁלֹשׁ חֲמִשׁ*.

18 Milik, 290.

ITEM 22

בסדק שבסככא מזר[ח ל->] 5:5
 אשווח שלומו כאלין של 5:6
 דמע ובתכן אצלמ 5:7

- 5:5 In the fissure which is in Secacah, eas[t of the]
 5:6 Pool of Solomon, (there) are dedicated
 5:7 vessels, and their lists (are located) next to them.

COMMENTARY

(5:5) בַּסְדֵּק־בַּסְכָּכָא־שֶׁבַּסְכָּכָא, “In/at/by a/the fissure which is in (the) Sacacah” — This follows the readings of the scholars,¹ except LURIE who reads בסרק (i.e., בַּסְרֵק, with a *reš*), “in the hole”; cf. the Targumim of וְהָבֹור־רִיק is וְגֹבָא סְרִיק (PsJ), “and the pit (was) empty” (Gen. 37:24); אֲנָשִׁים רִקִּים is גְּבָרִין סְרִיקִין (Judg. 9:4); also, אֵילָן סֶרֶק (MH), “tree which bears no edible fruit.” Lurie adds that סרק is an additional word in the vocabulary of the inhabitants of the Araba for pits, such as בור, חפיר, שיח, ריק, אשוח, etc.²

The following possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations can be offered for this phrase (including the scholars versions).

בַּסְדֵּק־בַּסְכָּכָא־שֶׁבַּסְכָּכָא, “In/at/by a/the fissure which is in Secacah” — The verbal forms of סדק (MH, A) mean “to cleave, tear apart,” while the nominal forms סֶדֶק (MH, masc.) and סְדִיקָא (A, masc.), “fissure, crack.” E.g., נִסְדְּקָה חֲבִית שֶׁל מַיִם, “a water barrel became chipped” (t. B.Q. 10:28); חוּרֵי הַמְּעָרָה וְסְדִיקֵי הַמְּעָרָה, “the cavities of the cave (i.e., *mikve*) and the fissures of the cave (i.e., *mikve*)” (m. Miq. 6:1), where סֶדֶק and חור are parallel words; cf. חור (8:2, alt.); וּמִסְדִּיקֵי פֶרֶסְתָּא ... וּפֶרֶסְתָּהּ לֹא סְדִיקָא, “or from those that do part the hoof ... but their hoof do not part” (TO and PsJ, Lev. 11:4); the Targum for וַיִּקְרַעַהּ שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר קְרָעִים is וַיִּקְרַעַהּ עֶסֶר וַיִּתְּרֶנָּה לְתֵרִין עֶסֶר is וַיִּקְרַעַהּ שְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר קְרָעִים, “and tore it into twelve pieces” (1 Kgs 11:30).

The סֶדֶק, “fissure,” in this item is connected to the Pool of Solomon. סֶדֶק, a synonym of חַרְיִץ־חֲרוּץ, “ditch” (5:8), may be an Aramaism, and it may be

1 Allegro, 41, 147 n. 104; Allegro^{rev}, 23; Milik, 289-90; Milik^E, 140; Pixner, 348; Wolters, 40-41; Garcia Martinez, 462; Beyer, 227-28; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193. Allegro^{Pr} renders, “In the vine.”

2 Lurie, 86-87, 86 n. 1. In these quotations ריק and סריק are adjectives. סרק and סריק

a *Saf'el* (ספֿעל) form of דק, “to crush, thresh, be fine.”³

בְּסִדְקִי וּבְסִדְקִי שְׂבִסְכָּאִי שְׂבִסְכָּאִי, “In/at/by a/the grain-storage/market which is in Secacah” — סִדְקִי (probably from *σιτοθήκη*, *σιτοδόχη*) means, “grain storage, market stand, market place”; e.g., שָׁל אֶשְׁקֵלֶנּוּ לְסִדְקִי, “we used to go down to the market of Ashkelon and buy wheat” (y. Shevi. 6:1 [17b]; y. Yev. 7:3 [32b]).⁴

בְּסִרְקִי וּבְסִרְקִי שְׂבִסְכָּאִי שְׂבִסְכָּאִי (cf. Lurie), “In/at/by the Plain of Secacah” — Lurie’s interpretation is questionable. In the phrase וְגֹבֵא סִרְקִי the adjective סִרְקִי, “empty,” modifies גֹּבֵא, “the pit,” thus סִרְקִי cannot mean “pit.” Rather סִרְקִי may mean “empty place,” or better “plain”; cf. the possible meaning of שְׁוֵה (see #5, 1:13). Regarding סִכְכָּה, see #20, 4:13.

מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁיִיתָהּ לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ שְׁלוֹמוֹ (5:5-6) or מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁיִיתָהּ שְׁלוֹמוֹ — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “to the Eas[t ? ... in (?)] the pit of its cistern” (i.e., ... מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ של יָמֹ). ALLEGRO: “in the pla[ster (?)] of the ‘Solomon reservoir’.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “in the spo[ut (?)] of the ‘Solomon’ reservoir.”⁵ MILIK: מִזְרְחָה אִשִּׁיָּה שְׁלוֹמוֹ, “to the eas[t] of Solomon’s Pool.”⁶ LURIE: מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ שְׁלוֹמוֹ, “eas[tward of] Solomon’s [re]servoir.”⁷ BEYER: מִזְרְחָה אִשִּׁיָּה שְׁלוֹמוֹ, “to the eas[t] of (King ?) Solomon’s Reservoir.”⁸ The other scholars agree with Milik.⁹

The drawings of BAKER and MILIK have אִשִּׁיָּה (single *waw/yod*), while ALLEGRO’s אִשִּׁיָּה (double *waw/yod*). The latter is supported by the photographs of the ZUCKERMANS. Accordingly, the text can be restored as: (1) מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ, (2) מִזְרְחָה לְאַשְׁוֹתָהּ, (3) מִזְרְחָה לְאַשִּׁיָּה, or (4) מִזְרְחָה לְאַשִּׁיָּה; all having the same meaning. The second word of this phrase is interrupted, the restored letter is at the end of the line, and the others are at the beginning of the next one. The restoration is almost certain; cf. מִזְרְחָה לְגִלְעָד, “east to (the) Gilead” (1 Chron. 5:10); מִזְרְחָה לְמִזְבֵּחַ, “east to the altar” (2 Chron. 5:12). Regarding interrupted words, see #12, 3:1-2; for אִשִּׁיָּה, #13, 3:8.

may be *Saf'el* forms of רִיק and רִיק respectively (cf. Jastrow, 1029b; ESh^{dic} 4, 1847b).

3 Cf. Jastrow, 957b-58a; ESh^{dic} 4, 1763b-64a. Regarding the שפֿעל and שפֿעל forms, see Jastrow, ix; M.Z. Segal, *Diqduq Lešon hamMišnah*, 122. דק and דק are related to the Akkadian *daququ*, “to break into pieces,” Arabic *daqq* (see BDB, 200b), and Aramaic דרִיק (with an extra *reš*).

4 The printed edition of the Palestinian Talmud has לְסִרְקִיָּה, לְסִרְקִיָּה, which seem to be an error; cf. *Qorban Ha'edah* and his reading on Yevamot. See also, Jastrow, 976b; AC 6, 26b; BY 5, 3969 and nn. 3-5; ESh^{dic} 4, 1764a.

5 Allegro, 41, 148 nn. 105-07; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

6 Milik, 289-90, 244 C-70, 257-58 C-201, 263 D-10; Milik^E, 140.

7 Lurie, 86-87 and nn. 2-3 (there are several typographical errors in the translation).

8 Beyer, 227-28.

9 Pixner, 348 and n. 23; Wolters, 40-41; Garcia Martinez, 462; Vermes, 375; Wise, 193.

Double *waw/yod* spellings are only variant orthographic representations, and may indicate consonantal values. They occur three-four times in the Scroll: אשוור (= אַשְׁוֹרָא שְׁוֹרָא) or אשייה (= אַשְׁיִיָּהּ שְׁיִיָּהּ) in this item, אוצר (= אוֹצֵר, 8:2), חפור (= חַפּוּרִיָּהּ פּוּר, 10:13), and הבייבא (= הַבִּיבָּה, 7:14-15, alt.). Cf. the Targum for הָהָר, "the mountain," is טורא (TO) vs. טוּרָא (PsJ, Frag.; Exod. 19:20, etc.); and the plurals of some monosyllabic nouns, such as שור, "ox," שוּרִים (pl.) vs. שְׁוּרִים - שְׁוּרִים (pl.); שוק, "market, street," vs. שְׁוּקִים - שְׁוּקִים (pl.).

The phonetic spellings of שְׁלוֹמוֹ (twice in the Scroll), and שְׁלוֹמוֹה (4QMMT C:18) justify the Masoretic vocalization of the archaic spelling of שְׁלֹמֹה, Solomon.¹⁰ Other phonetic spellings in the Scroll are: לְסִמְלוֹ = לְשִׁמְלוֹ, "to its (masc.) left" (10:6; cf. Jonah 4:11), and בְּרוֹשׁ = בְּרָאשׁ, "at the head of" (see #21, 5:1; #35, 8:8).

Both אַשְׁוֹרָא שְׁלֹמוֹ, the "Pool of Solomon," and הַרְצִיָּהּ שְׁלֹמוֹ, the "Ditch of Solomon," in the next item, may have been named after King Solomon, or after a person named Solomon who made or owned them (see #23, 5:8-9); cf. שְׁעֵשֶׁה שְׁלֹמֹה, "(the) Pool which made Solomon" (b. Yoma 58a; b. Zev. 62b; b. 'Eruv. 14b), referring to the pool of Solomon's Temple (1 Kgs 7:23-26). "East of the Pool of Solomon" resembles the phrase "toward the east at Solomon's pool" in "The Description of Jerusalem" by Josephus (War, v, iv, 2). The latter is identified with בְּרִכַּת הַמֶּלֶךְ, "the King's Pool" (Neh. 2:14),¹¹ בְּרִכּוֹת מַיִם, "pools of water" made by/for Qohelet (Eccl. 2:6).¹² Regarding בְּרִכַּת, see #11, 2:13.

(5:6-7) כַּלִּין שֶׁל דָּמַע — The word כַּלִּין = כָּלִין is spelled *plene* (ALLEGRO, MILIK, LURIE, THORION).¹³ Cf. וְנִשְׁאַר אָנִי וְנִשְׁאַר אָנִי, "and I remained" (Ezek. 9:8; see Radak), vs. וְנִשְׁאַר גַּם הוּא, "and he also remained" (Zech. 9:7).¹⁴ The absolute כַּלִּין שֶׁל דָּמַע is the same as the construct כָּלִי דָּמַע (1:9, 3:9, etc.; see Appendix D). BEYER renders כאלין αίχμηλοί, "boxes."¹⁵

(5:7) וּבִתְקוּיָתָבִן אֲצִלָּם, "and their lists are next them," or "and their notes are next to them" — There are five such phrases in the Scroll, and always at the end of their respective items. For a detailed discussion, see Appendix E.

10 In the name שְׁלֹמֹה the first *holam* is defective, the second is *plene*. The latter is an archaic spelling. There may be several archaic spellings in the Scroll (see #13, 3:9; #33, 8:2).

11 Slothi says that "the king's pool" is usually identified as the Pool of Siloam or *Birkat el-hamma*, "the Red Pool" (Daniel, Ezra, Nehemiah [1951], 191).

12 S.M. Lehrman, *The Five Megilloth, with Hebrew Text, English Translation and Commentary* (1946), 116.

13 Allegro, 148 n. 108; Milik, 228 B-5a, 252 C-136; Lurie, 86 n. 5; Thorion, 168.

14 For similar spellings in Mishnah manuscripts, see *MNM* 2, 1234-35.

15 Beyer, 227-28.

ITEM 23

מַעַל הַחֲרִיצ שֶׁל שְׁלוֹמוֹ <->	5:8
ו עַד הַרְגַּם הַגְּדוֹל	5:9
אֲמוֹת שְׁשִׁין חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת	5:10
שְׁלוֹשׁ כֶּסֶף כֹּכ 23	5:11

- 5:8 From above the Ditch of Solo-
 5:9 mon sixty cubits toward
 5:10 the Large Sepulcher, (there) is hidden three
 5:11 cubits (deep) 23 k(arsh) of silver.

COMMENTARY

(5:8-9) מַעַל הַחֲרִיצָה הַחֲרוֹץ שֶׁל שְׁלוֹמוֹ עַד, “From above the Ditch of Solomon toward” — MILIK, PIXNER, SHARVIT, WOLTERS, and BEYER: מַעַל הַחֲרִיצָה שֶׁל שְׁלוֹמוֹ;¹ ALLEGRO and LURIE: מַעַל הַחֲרוֹץ שֶׁל שְׁלוֹמוֹ;² “From above the Ditch of Solomon, toward.”

It is also possible to read this phrase as מַעַל הַחֲרִיצָה הַחֲרוֹץ שֶׁל שְׁלוֹמוֹ וְעַד, “From above the Ditch of Shallum/Shalom, and toward.”³ If the reading is שְׁלוֹמוֹ, then it is interrupted, מַעַל שְׁלוֹמוֹ is at the end of the line, the ו is at the beginning of the next one, and it is followed by עַד. If the reading is שְׁלוֹמוֹ, then the next word is וְעַד. Regarding phonetic spellings, see #22, 5:6; for interrupted words, #12, 3:1-2.

The preposition set מַעַל הַ- (וְ)עַד הַ- ... “from above the ... (and) till/toward the,” is like מִן הַ- (וְ)מַעַל הַ- ... “from the ... till/toward the” (see #4, 1:11-12). Cf. מַעַל לְבֵית דָּוִיד וְעַד שַׁעַר הַמַּיִם מִזְרָח ... מַעַל לְחֹמֶת מַעַל, “from above the house of David unto the Water Gate eastward ... from above the tower of the furnaces toward the broad wall” (Neh. 12:37-38); מִן הַצָּפוֹן אֲמוֹת שֵׁשׁ עַד נִיקְרַת הַטְּבִילָה, “on/from the north, six cubits toward the cave of immersion” (see #4, 1:11-12). The combined preposition מַעַל, literally “from above,” means “from”; cf. מִלְּמַעְלָא, “from above” (see #44, 10:2), and מִתַּחַת, “from below” (11:2; see

1 Milik, 289, 244 C-71 (cf. Dan. 9:25; m. Kil. 5:3), 264 D-11; Pixner, 348; Sharvit, 132 (MH, the same as in Dan. 9:25); Wolters, 40; Beyer, 227.

2 Allegro, 40, 148 n. 112 (as in Dan. 9:25, same as חֲרִיצָא, Trg. Job 38:25); Lurie, 87-88 and n. 1 (as in Daniel, and like חֲרִיצָא in m. Kil. 5:3 and in b. Meg. 14a).

3 Cf. Lefkovits^{diss} 1, 432-35. Allegro^P renders, “From beside the ‘trench of Peace’ (?)”

#49, 10:15). עַד means "until, till, toward, up to, as far as, at, by, near."⁴

חַרִּיץ (*Pe'il*) and חָרוֹץ (*Pa'ul*), "ditch, moat," are masculine nominal formations of the root חָרַץ, "to cut, sharpen"; cf. the feminine formations of חָרִיבָה and חָרוּבָה, "ruin" (see #1, 1:1). חָרוֹץ occurs once in the Masoretic Text (Dan. 9:25).⁵ חָרִיץ (pl. חָרִיצִין) is commonly used in Mishnaic Hebrew. E.g., "חָרִיץ (a ditch) ... (which is) ten (handbreadths) deep and four (handbreadths) wide (m. Kil. 5:3); הַחֹפֶר בּוֹר שֵׁיחַ וּמַעְרָה חָרִיצִין וְנִעְצִין, "who is digging a round pit, a long but narrow pit, a square-shaped and covered cave, square shaped but uncovered caves, or caves having a narrow bottom and broad upper part" (m. B.Q. 5:5).⁶ The first citation deals with the size of a חָרִיץ; while in the second בּוֹר שֵׁיחַ, and מַעְרָה are synonymous to חָרִיצִין.

The reading of שְׁלוֹמוֹ, the phonetic spelling of שְׁלֹמֹה, Solomon, as in the previous one, is almost certain. Yet here is also possible to read as שְׁלוֹמַ, "Shallum, Reward" or שְׁלוֹם, "Shalom, Peace, Perfect." שְׁלוֹם is the name of various individuals in the Masoretic Text (e.g., King of Israel, 2 Kgs 15:10, 13-15; King of Judah, Jer. 22:11). שְׁלוֹן, Shallun (Neh. 3:15), is a variant of this name. The personal name שְׁלוֹם (Shalom, Peace) may have originated in the Mishnaic era.⁷ Furthermore, הַחֲרִיצוֹתָרוֹץ שֶׁל שְׁלוֹם, "the ditch of peace," resembles the verses, כְּנָהָר שְׁלוֹם וּכְנַחַל שׁוֹטֵף, "like a river of peace, and like an overflowing stream" (Isa. 66:12); וְדַרְכֶּיהָ דְרָכֵי נֶעֱם וְכָל, "Her ways are ways of pleasantness, and all her paths are peace" (Prv. 3:17).

In the previous item מִזְרַח לְאַשׁוּרִים שְׁלוֹמוֹ is in the construct state (= מְזֻרָח, "from the east"), while in this item שְׁלוֹמוֹ שֶׁל הַחֲרִיצוֹתָרוֹץ is in the absolute state. The construct state is preferred in Biblical Hebrew, while the

(i.e., מעל החרוצ של שלום).

4 Cf. BDB, 723b-725b. H.L. Ginsberg demonstrated that עַד can mean "at, by, near" ("A Preposition of Interest to Historical Geographers," *BASOR* 122 [1951], 12-13).

5 Rashi explains that חָרִיצִין were made around the חֹמָה (wall) to further protect the city, which is called in Old-French *fosez/fosed* (*fossê*), "ditch, moat"; Greenberg, 226, 309 n. 682; Gukovitzki, 80 #1175). See also the comments of Sa'adiah Ga'on, *Mešudat Zion* and *Mešudat David*. In the Bible חָרוֹץ also means "sharp, diligent (adj.), strict decision (noun)," while חָרִיץ (masc.) means "a cut, thing cut, sharp instrument" (see BDB, 358b-59a). The roots חָרַץ, חָרַט, חָרַת, and חָרַשׁ are related (see #34, 8:4).

6 Cf. Rashi and Bertinoro. חָרִיץ is explained by Rashi as "broad and round like a מַעְרָה (cave), it is not covered, but its entire mouth is open" (b. B.Q. 50b).

7 Cf. אִמָּה שְׁלוֹם, Imma Shalom, the wife of the Tanna Rabbi Eliezer ben Hyrcanus and the sister of Rabban Gamaliel of Javneh (late first - early sec. cent. CE; e.g., b. 'Eruv. 63a; San. 116a-b; B.M. 59b). There are many similar biblical personal names: e.g., שְׁלֹמִי, Shelomi (Num. 34:27); שְׁלֹמִית, Shelomith (fem., Lev. 24:11, 1 Chron. 3:19; masc. Ezra 8:10); שְׁלֹמוֹת, Shelomoth (1 Chron. 24:22, 26:26); שְׁלֹמִיָּה and שְׁלֵמִיָּה, Shelemiah (Jer. 36:14, 37:3, etc.); שְׁלֹמִיָּאֵל, Shelumiel (Num. 1:6, etc.); מִשְׁלָם, Meshullam (e.g., Neh. 8:4); מִשְׁלֵמֶת, Meshullemeth (fem., 2 Kgs 21:19), etc. Also שְׁלֵמָה, Salma (1 Chron. 2:11, 21:54), שְׁלֵמָה, Salmah (Ruth 4:20), and its variant and שְׁלֹמֹן, Salmon (Ruth 4:21); and שְׁלֵמִי, Salmai (Neh. 7:48; in Ezra 2:46 the *ketiv* is שְׁלֵמִי).

opposite is true in Mishnaic. The following show various usages: **עַל סֵפֶר** (const.), “upon (the) Book of Words of Solomon” (1 Kgs 11:41), **עַל מִטַּת שְׁלֹמֹה** (abs.), “his couch that of Solomon” (Songs 3:7); **עַל מִטַּת אִישׁ** (const.), “upon (the) couch of the man of God” (2 Kgs 4:21); **שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים** (abs.), “Song of the Songs, which is Solomon’s” (Songs 1:1); **לָמָּה נִקְרָא שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל שְׁלֹמֹה קוֹהֶלֶת** (abs.), “why it is called his name that of Solomon, Qohelet” (Eccl. Rabbah on 1:1).

(5:9) **עַד הַרְגְּמוֹהֶרֶגֶב הַגָּדוֹל** — cf. **שֶׁל הַרְגְּמוֹהֶרֶגֶב** (see #26, 6:8). Since *mem* and *bet* are often indistinguishable in the Scroll, it is possible to read the two cases in both ways. This phrase resembles the verse, **וְעַד הַנָּהָר הַגָּדוֹל ... וְעַד הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל**, “and to the great river ... and to the Great Sea” (Josh. 1:4). Interestingly, **רָגֵם** and **רָגֵב** may be related to one another.⁸

רגמורגב has been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO⁹: “boulder, stone (heap ?)” (i.e., **רגמ**). ALLEGRO: **רגב**, “watchtower”; in the Bible means a “small earth clod.” The Septuagint reads for the Masoretic Text **אֲבָן** and **נֶגֶב** as “*argab*, *ergab*, which must be larger than an “earth clod.” Cf. the biblical place name ‘Argob, Mishnaic Regeb, and of Josephus’ Ragaba, “a fortress (*phourion*) across the Jordan.” Allegro notes the possible reading of **רגם**.⁹ MILIK: **רגם**, “block of stone, Rock.”¹⁰ LURIE: **רגב**, an “earth clod” to control the flow of the water; Milik reads **רגם**.¹¹ PIXNER: “huge rock, rock,” i.e., **רגם**.¹² SHARVIT: **רגם**, its origin is unknown; its verbal form means “stoning” (BH, MH).¹³ WOLTERS: **רגם**, “stoning heap.”¹⁴ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “rim, rock.”¹⁵ BEYER: **רגם**, “stone scraps.”¹⁶ VERMES: “stone, Stone.”¹⁷ WISE: “cairn.”¹⁸

The masculine adjective **הַגָּדוֹל**, “the great,” indicates that the noun **רָגֵם** or **רָגֵב** must be masculine.

רגב occurs twice in the Masoretic Text: **וְרֵגְבֵי נָחַל**, whose Targum is **וְרֵגְבֵי שְׂתֵי דְנִחְלָא**, “the clods of the wadi” (Job 21:33); and **וְרֵגְבֵי דְבָקוּ**, whose Targum is **וְרֵגְבֵי שְׂתֵי אֲדָבְקוּ**, “and the clods stuck together” (Job 38:38); and of **וְרֵגְבֵי עֶפְרָא** is **וְרֵגְבֵי שְׂתֵי עֶפְרָא**, “and the clods of earth” (Job

8 Jastrow, 1449b; ESh^{dic} 6, 2462a.

9 Allegro, 41, 43, 148-49 n. 114, 150 n. 131; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

10 Milik, 289-91, 240 C-24, 264 D-14, 233 B-16e; Milik^E, 140.

11 Lurie, 87-88 and n. 3, 92.

12 Pixner, 348-49.

13 “Iyyunim,” 133 and n. 46.

14 Wolters, 40-43.

15 Garcia Martinez, 462.

16 Beyer, 227-28.

17 Vermes, 375.

18 Wise, 194.

7:5).¹⁹ Its Aramaic cognate is רִגְבָא (pl. רִגְבֵי יָאֵה); e.g., רִגְבֵי יָאֵה דְּטַבְרִיָא, “the clods/stones of Tiberias” (Lev. Rabbah 16; Eccl. Rabbah on 12:6).²⁰

In a *Yosher* for the first day of Sukkot starting with אֵימַת, the *paytan* says, לְרִגְבַּי חָלָלִים, “into the grave of the massacred.” This is explained by the commentaries *Matteh Levi* and *Beth Levi* (based on Job 21:13) as לְבֵאֵר שְׁחַת, “to the pit of destruction” (Ps. 55:24), as its Targum עֲמִיקָא, “to the deep hell.” Likewise, יוֹרְדֵי רִגְבַּי, in a *Seliḥah* by Rabbi Solomon the Babylonian (c. 980), means “those who descend into the grave.”²¹

There are two difficult verses in the following biblical narrative: “and you (David) shall remain אֶצֶל הָאֶבֶן הָאֵזֶל (beside the Stone of Ezel),” whose Targum is, “and you shall remain אֶתָּא אֲבָן (beside the marker stone);” “and David rose up מֵאֶצֶל הַנֶּגֶב (from beside the South or Negev),” whose Targum is, “and David rose up מִסֵּטֶר אֲבָן אֶתָּא דְּלִקְבֵּל דְּרוּמָא (from beside the marker stone that is facing south)” (1 Sam. 20:19 and 20:41, respectively).²²

In these verses אֲבָן הָאֵזֶל is parallel to נֶגֶב.²³ The Targum for אֶצֶל הָאֵזֶל is אֶתָּא אֲבָן (“the marking stone”); while of הַנֶּגֶב is דְּרוּמָא אֶתָּא. The latter composes two explanations of הַנֶּגֶב: (1) אֶתָּא אֲבָן, “the marking stone”; and (2) דְּלִקְבֵּל דְּרוּמָא, “which is facing south.” However, is possible that the *Urschrift* of the Targumist had בִּנְגֵב (אֲשֶׁר) אֶצֶל הָאֵזֶל.

אֶבֶן הָאֵזֶל, “the Stone of Ezel,” may be a toponym between Ramah and Nob in the Territory of Benjamin. Cf. הָאֶבֶן הַעֶזֶר, “Eben-ezer, the Stone of Help,” between Mizpah and Shen, erected by the Prophet Samuel (1 Sam. 4:1, 5:1, 7:12).²⁴ Actually אֶבֶן הָאֵזֶל may be a variant of אֶבֶן הַעֶזֶר, *’alef-’ayin*

19 Jastrow (265a) connects גֹּשׁ with גְּרִישָׁתָא. Ben-Yehuda (2, 731b n. 1.) says that Ibn-Saruq connects גֹּשׁ with גִּשְׁת. Ben-Yehuda adds that for others אֲבָן, עֶפֶר, and גֹּשׁ are synonyms.

20 Rashi and Rik translate רִגְבֵי as בִּלְשֹׁשׁ, *blestes*, in Old-French, “clod” (see Greenberg, 209, 305 n. 625). Likewise, Rashi renders בִּלְשֹׁשׁ for אֲרָמָה (b. Naz. 65a; see Gukovitzki, 30 #447 and its note). Regarding אֲרָמָה and גְּרִישָׁתָא, see #18, 4:9. Ibn-Ezra, based on Arabic, explains נַחֲלֵי רִגְבֵי, “ditches of the wadi,” and Ralbag as “ditches of the flat land.” Ralbag interprets רִגְבֵי as “earth clods.” Kohut connects רִגְבָא and רִגְבַּי (BH) with the Arabic *rjm*, *Erdscholle*, “clod” (AC 7, 251a). Jastrow (1446b) translates רִגְבֵי as “clod, boulder.” According to Ben-Yehuda (7, 6404 n. 4.), Ibn-Janah was the first who connected רִגְבַּי to Arabic *’ar-rajah* (sg. *rujbah*), a depth of a wadi where water gathers. Ben-Yehuda adds that it is like the Syriac רִגְבָא, “mud in the water cistern”; also אֲרָגֶב (Argov) means “wadi” or “well,” for which a district in the Bashan is named. See also *Sefer haššōrašim*, 467.

21 See, A. Rosenfeld, *The Authorised Selichot for the Whole Year* (1979), 201.

22 אֶצֶל הָאֵזֶל or אֶתָּא אֲבָן is a “marker stone” that assists travelers, like a mile stone; cf. the root אָזַל, “to walk, pass” (Prov. 20:14, BH; Dan. 2:17, etc., BA). See Rashi, Radak, Rid (who quotes the Targum for אֶצֶל הָאֵזֶל as הֵלִיקָא), also, Ibn-Janah, *Šōrašim*, 467.

23 JPSⁱⁱ notes that Negeb of verse 41 is identical with the Ezel Stone of verse 19 (1 Sam. 20:41).

24 Also, אֶבֶן בְּהֵן בֶּן רְאוּבֵן, “the Stone of Bohan ben Reuben” on the border of Judah and Benjamin (Josh. 15:6, 18:17); אֶבֶן הַזֹּהֶלֶת, “the Stone of Zohelēth” east of Jerusalem near

and *lamed-reš* interchanges.

The Septuagint renders both אָבֶן הָאֵזֶל and נֶגֶב as Αργαβ (Argab) - Εργαβ (Ergab), a toponym. Mandelkern translates Αργαβ back to Hebrew as הָאֶרְגָב (this Argov) for אָבֶן הָאֵזֶל, and מֵאֵצֶל הָאֶרְגָב ("from beside Argov") for מֵאֵצֶל הַנֶּגֶב.²⁵ BDB emends אָבֶן הָאֵזֶל and נֶגֶב to הָאֶרְגָב הָלֵאז, "this heap," based on the Septuagint, even lists אֶרְגָב as a masculine noun with the suggested meaning of "heap, mound."²⁶

In addition, אֶרְגֹב, Argob, is a region in Bashan (Deut. 3:4,13-14; 1 Kgs 4:13), and רֶגֶב בְּעֶבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן, Regev in Transjordan was famous for its oil (m. Men. 8:3). Some commentators identify רֶגֶב as אֶרְגֹב.²⁷

רֶגֶב may be a variant of נֶגֶב, "dry land, south, Negev (southern Palestine)," a *reš-nun* interchange. The verbal form of נֶגֶב in Mishnaic Hebrew and in Aramaic means "to dry." E.g., "to fill (the barrel's hole) וַיִּגְוֹב (and have dry up)" (m. 'A.Z. 5:3); נִגְוֹבוּ אִפִּי' (ה) (ד) אֶרְעָא (TO, PsJ, TN), "the waters were dried up ... the faces of the ground were dried" (Gen. 8:13). Steinberg says that the root of רֶגֶב is רָגַ; and the meaning of רֶגֶב in Aramaic is "being thirsty and dry without water."²⁸ Thus, עַד הַרְגֵב (= הַנֶּגֶב) could mean, "toward the great Negev/dry-land/south."

The above biblical problem may be explained as follows. מֵאֵצֶל הַנֶּגֶב is a variant of מֵאֵצֶל הָרֶגֶב; and since רֶגֶב is a synonym of אָבֶן, it means מֵאֵצֶל הָאֵבֶן, "from beside the stone." Consequently, אֵצֶל הָאֵבֶן הָאֵזֶל is the same as אֵצֶל הָרֶגֶב הָאֵזֶל. Moreover, אֶרְגֹב could be רֶגֶב with a prosthetic *'alef*. Perhaps the original Hebrew text of the Septuagints had in both verses רֶגֶב or אֶרְגֹב (rather than אָבֶן הָאֵזֶל and נֶגֶב), and they considered it as a toponym. אֵזֶל could be the name of a stone, monument, mark, sign, or it means "walking, by passing." The first verse identifies the purpose of the stone, while the second only mentions "the stone" where David and Jonathan agreed to meet each other.

Based on the above discussion: (1) רֶגֶב, אָבֶן, עֶפֶר, and גֹּשׁ are synonyms. (2) רֶגֶב could mean: (a) "clod" of earth; (b) "ditch"; (c) "grave." (3) The biblical רֶגֶב, נֶגֶב, אֶרְגֹב, and אֶרְגֹב, are the same as רֶגֶב of the Scroll.

Another possibility is to read the word in question as רָגַם. The verbal form of רָגַם means "to stone, to kill by stoning" in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew, Aramaic, and Arabic. In Arabic *rajam* (pl. *rijam*) means "grave, pit, cistern,

En-rogel (1 Kgs 1:9); הָאֵבֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה אֲשֶׁר בְּגִבְעוֹן, "the Great Stone which is in Gibeon" (2 Sam. 20:8; see MK 2, 1351c; SB, 7a; BDB 7a; ESh^{con} 1, 18b).

²⁵ MK 2, 1351c.

²⁶ BDB, 7a, 23b, 918b.

²⁷ Kohut suggests that Ragav is the same as Argov and Παργαβή, Ragaba, mentioned by Josephus (JA 13, 15, 5). He adds that the Samaritan Targum renders אֶרְגֹב as רִיגֹבָאָה (AC 7, 251a). See Kehati on this Mishnah.

²⁸ SB, 771a.

well," and *rujum*, "tombstone," a sort of "stone heap."

In addition, two biblical problem words are connected with רָגֶם. (1) רָגֶמָם, "their heap" (Ps. 68:28), where רָגֶמָה (fem.) may be a feminine form of רָגֶם; and (2) כְּצִרּוֹר אֶבֶן בְּמִרְגָּמָה, "like a cluster of stones in a heap" (Prov. 26:8), where מִרְגָּמָה could be a "heap," i.e., רָגֶמָה with a locative *mem*.²⁹ Accordingly, הָרָגֶם הַגָּדוֹל could mean "the large sepulcher/heap/monument"; and שֶׁל הָרָגֶם, "of the sepulcher/heap/monument."

רָגֶם is also a biblical personal name: "And the sons of Jahdai (were) רָגֶם (Regem), and Jotham, and Geshan, and Pelet, and Ephah, and Shaaf" of the Tribe of Judah (1 Chron. 2:47); also "when Bethel-sharezer and רָגֶם מֶלֶךְ (Regem-melech) and his men sent to ask the favor of the Lord" (Zech. 7:2).³⁰ It is conceivable that in Palestine existed a place named רָגֶם, Regem. Accordingly, עַד הָרָגֶם הַגָּדוֹל could mean, "toward the (the place) Great Regem," and שֶׁל הָרָגֶם, "of the (place) Regem."

Based on the above discussion: (1) רָגֶם may be semantically similar to בּוֹר, שֹׁחַ, שִׁיחַ, מְעָרָה, שִׁית, חֲפִירָה, and חֲפִירָה. (2) רָגֶם could mean "heap" (cf. גֵּל and יָגֵר; see #20, 4:13) or "monument" (cf. יָד; see #48, 10:12). If these assumptions are correct, then the masculine nominal form of רָגֶם, unknown from other Hebrew sources, is rediscovered in the Scroll. (3) רָגֶם could be an unattested toponym.

(5:10-11) אַמּוֹת שְׁשִׁין חֲפִירָהּ פּוֹר אַמּוֹת שְׁלוֹשׁ כֶּסֶף כֹּחַ, "(a distance of) sixty cubits, (there) is hidden three cubits (deep) 23 k(arsh) of silver," or "(a distance of) sixty cubits, dig three cubits (deep, there is) 23 k(arsh) of silver" — The first measurement refers to the distance between the ditch and the sepulcher; the second indicates the depth where three karsh of silver is hidden. Regarding אַמָּה, see #1, 1:2-3; for חֲפִיר, #17, 4:7; for כֹּחַ, Appendix A.

29 See Šorašim, 468; BY 4, 3308b-3309a and n. 1. The Targum, Rashi, *Mešudat David*, and *Mešudat Zion* consider רָגֶמָם as a verbal form. According to BDB (920b), רָגֶמָה means "heap (of stones,) then crowd (of people)"; and מִרְגָּמָה, "sling," elsewhere "stone-heap."

30 The last verse can be rendered as, "when Bethel, Sarezzer, and Regem-melech and his men sent to ask the favor of the Lord"; or "when Sarezzer and Regem-melech and his men sent (to) the House of God (or to Beth-el) to ask the favor of the Lord" (cf. Targum).

ITEM 24

בקבר שבנחל הכפא	5:12
בבואה מירחו לסככא	5:13
חפון אמות שבע ככ 32	5:14

- 5:12 In the grave which is in Wadi Kefah
 5:13 as it comes from Jericho to Sacacah,
 5:14 are buried seven cubits (deep) 32 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

(5:12) בְּקִבְרֵי בִקְפָּה שֶׁבְּנַחַל הַכֶּפֶּא — “In/at/by a/the grave which is in/at Wadi Kefah/Kippah.” Regarding בִּקְפָּה, see #14, 3:11.

נַחַל have been analyzed as follows. ALLEGRO¹: “the Wady of the Rock (*Kepha*).” ALLEGRO: “the Wady *Kippa*.” If the root of כפא is כפף, “arch, bend over,” cf. כפה, “arch doorway, vaulted chamber” (MH), and “palm, branch, frond” (BH), semantically equivalent with קמר (MH, A), “bend over, arch,” and קימרון, “arched lid” of a chest (m. Kel. 16:7, 18:2), then “must almost certainly lie behind the modern Arab *Qumran*.” If so, נחל כפא is Wady Qumran.¹ MILIK: “in the torrent ha-Kippa.” כפא or כפה (MH, A) means “arch, vault, prison, branch of a palm tree.” In addition, the spice כיפת הירדן was used in incense.² LURIE: “the Wadi Kippa,” where כיפת הירדן, “the Jordan amber,” used for Temple incense (y. Yoma 4:5; b. Ker. 6a) was grown.³ The other scholars agree with Allegro and Milik.⁴

נַחַל (masc., BH, MH, A) means “wadi, river, stream, torrent, valley”; in כפא שבנחל it is in the construct state. נַחַל occurs again in the phrase מִהַנַּחַל הַגָּדוֹל, “from the Great River,” where it is modified by the masculine adjective גָּדוֹל (see #45, 10:3-4). נַחַל may be related to נַחֲלָה (fem.), “possession, inheritance” (from the root נחל, “to give/take possession”), and to נָהָר, “river” (*he-het* and *lamed-reš* interchanges).

הַכֶּפֶּא consists of כפא plus the prefixed definite article *he*. כפא can be interpreted as follows.

1 Allegro, 41, 145 n. 97; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

2 Milik: 289-90, 240 C-28, 252 C-131, 264 D-12; Milik^E 140.

3 Lurie: 88-89, and n. 1.

4 Pixner (348): “Wadi Ha-Kipa”; Garcia Martinez (462): “the ha-Kippa stream”; Wolters (40-41): “the Wadi Kippa”; Vermes (375): “the wady of Kippa”; Beyer (227-28): “in Wadi Kappa (of the Arch)”; כפא is an Aramaism; Wise (194): “the Wadi Kepah.”

כִּיפָה (fem., MH) means “dome, arch, prison, chamber.” E.g., בֵּית הַיָּה, הַמּוֹקֵד כִּיפָה וּבֵית גְּדוֹל הָיָה, “(in the Temple) the house where the fire was maintained (had) a כִּיפָה (dome) and it was a large building” (m. Tam. 1:1). Regarding מוֹקֵד, see #30, 7:8.

כִּיפָה (MH), feminine formation of כִּיפִי (masc., BH, MH), “rock, stone, ball,” is a synonym of אֶבֶן, “stone, rock.” E.g., כִּיפַת הַבֶּרֶד vs. אֶבֶן הַבֶּרֶד, “hail stone” (m. Oh. 8:5 and m. Miq. 7:1, respectively); cf. כִּיפֵי הַבֶּרֶד, “hail stones” (TA, b. Mo’ed Q. 25b; see Rashi). כִּיפִי (pl. of כִּי, masc.) appears twice in the Masoretic Text: וַיַּחֲבִיטוּ עַל הַכִּיפִים, “and they climb up upon the rocks”; Trg. וַיַּחֲבִיטוּ לְאַטְמָרָא בְּכַפֵּי, “and they climbed up to be hidden in the rocks” (Jer. 4:29); and חֲרֵי עֶפֶר וְכַפִּים, “in holes of earth and rocks”; Trg. בְּנִקְרִיתָא דְעֶפְרָא וְאַבְנֵי, “in the caves of the earth and the stones” (Job 30:6). Also, כִּיפָא is the Targum of סֶלַע, “rock.”⁵ Thus, כִּי (H), כִּיפָא (A), אֶבֶן (H), אֲבָנָא (A) and סֶלַע (H) are synonyms; while חוֹר/חֹר, “hole,” is a synonym of נִקְרָאָה, “cave.” Regarding אֶבֶן, see #47, 10:9; for חֹר, #33, 8:2; for נִקְרָא, #4, 1:11-12; for סֶלַע, #10, 2:11.

נַחַל הַכֶּפֶא, “Wadi of the Dome,” or נַחַל הַכֶּפֶא, “Wadi of the Rock,” as well as נַחַל הַגְּדוֹל, “the Great Wadi” (see #45, 10:3-4), are geographical names similar to the thirteen river-beds or valleys named in the Masoretic Text. E.g., נַחַל הַשִּׁטִּים, “the Valley of Shittim/Acacia” (Joel 4:18), נַחַל קִישׁוֹן, “ancient brook (that is) Kishon Brook” (Judg. 5:21), נַחַל קִדְרוֹן, “brook Kidron” (2 Sam 15:23, etc.; cf. קִדְרוֹן – קִדְרוֹן, see #35, 8:8).

Petra (Πέτρα, Rock), the ancient capital of the Nabateans, is a ruin located 140 miles south of Amman in Jordan. Petra may be identical with סֶלַע (Rock) of Edom (2 Kgs 14:7; Isa. 16:1; and possible Judg. 1:36).⁶ Its Aramaic name is כִּיפָא; cf. the Targumim of ... מִהַסְלַע וּמֵעֵלָה, is וּגְבוּל הָאֲמֹרִי, “And the border of the Amorites (extended) ... from Sela/Keifa’ and upward,” (Judg. 1:36)⁷; of סֶלַע הַמַּחֲלָקוֹת

5 This is noted by Rashi (Jer. 4:29; Job 30:6) and Radak (Jer. 4:29). Often the Targum of סֶלַע is כִּיפָא; e.g., Num. 20:8,10-11 (TO, PsJ). The Aramaic כִּיפָא - כִּיפָא also means “shore, border, edge.” E.g., Onkelos renders עַל שֵׁפַת נַחַל אֲרֹנִן as עַל כִּיפָא דְאַרְנֹן, “From Aroer, which is on the edge/shore of the valley/river of Arnon” (Deut. 2:36). However, if כִּיפָא means “the shore,” then כֶּפֶא must be a feminine formation of כִּיפִי (masc.); cf. כִּיפָא (fem.) vs. כִּיפִי (masc.; see #32, 7:14), since a word cannot have two definite articles, an Aramaic א- and a Hebrew ה-. Moreover, נַחַל הַכֶּפֶא, “the river of the shore,” is meaningless, unless it has a reversed word order instead of the expected שֶׁל הַכִּיפָה, “shore of the river,” cf. כִּיפָא דְנַחַל, “shore of the river,” mentioned above.

6 Cf. BDB, 701a; SB, 596; ESh^{con} 2, 1510b. The three סֶלַע references, according to Mandelkern (2, 1488b), refer to three locations. See also M. Avi-Yonah, “Petra,” *EJ* 13, 341-43; “פֶּטְרָה” in *EH* 27, 587-88; D. Pagis, “פֶּטְרוֹס” in *EH* 27, 596-97.

7 JPSⁱⁱ renders this verse as, “The territory of the Amorites extended from the Ascent of Akrabbim—from Sela—onward”; and notes that some Septuagint mss. read “Edomites,” i.e., הָאֲדוֹמִי instead of הָאֲמֹרִי.

(Sela-hammahlekoth) is כִּיף פִּלְגוּתָא, “Rock of Separation” in the Wilderness of Judah (1 Sam. 23:28); of סֶלַע רִמּוֹן is כִּיף רִמּוֹן, “Rock of (the) Rimmon” in Benjamin;⁸ and of סֶלַע עֵיטָם is כִּיף עֵיטָם, “Rock of Etam.”⁹ Perhaps כִּיפָה was also used in Hebrew for סֶלַע or Petra. This assumption may indicate that נַחַל הַכְּפָא, Wadi Kefah, Wadi of the Rock, or Wadi Petra, was located near Petra. Yet it may also refer to a different wadi whose Hebrew name was נַחַל הַסֶּלַע, “Wadi of the Rock” (see #52, 11:5).

Finally, כִּיפָא, Keifah - Keifa¹, is also a personal name. E.g., Jesus said to one of his students, “You are Simon son of John. You are to be called Cephas,” i.e., כִּיפָא, “rock” in Aramaic, rendered as Πέτρος in Greek, Petrus in Latin, Peter in English (John 1:42).¹⁰ These names appear in Jewish sources as כִּיפָא,¹¹ פִּיטְרוֹס־פִּיטְרוֹס (Petrus),¹² פֶּטֶר (Peter), and Kaifes (= Cephas).¹³

(5:13) בְּבוֹאָהּ וּבִבּוֹאָהּ מִירֵחוֹ לְסִכְכְּאָוּלְסִכְכְּאָ, “as it comes/goes from Jericho to

8 Judg. 20:45,47, 21:13. רִמּוֹן means “pomegranate,” and the rock may have had such shape; or the deity Rimmon was worshipped on that cliff; cf. בֵּית רִמּוֹן, “Temple of Rimmon” (2 Kgs 5:18, 3X), located in or around Damascus.

9 Perhaps the complete name is סְעִיף סֶלַע עֵיטָם, “Cleft of the Rock Etam” (Judg. 15:8,11), which is rendered by Jonathan as שְׂקִיף כִּיף עֵיטָם, “overhanging rock of Etam.” The rock might have been located near Etam in Judah (cf. 1 Chron. 4:3,32; 2 Chron. 11:6). Most scholars do not consider “Rock Etam” as a compound toponym (e.g., MK 2, 1493c; BDB, 743b; ESh^{con} 3, 1588b).

10 See also D. Flosser, “פֶּטְרוֹס” in *EH* 27, 596-97; J.J. Castellet, “Peter, Apostle, St.” in *NCE* 11, 201; P.W. Schmiedel, “Simon Peter,” *EB* E 4, 4559-4627.

11 In the middle ages some Jewish scholars identified כִּיפָא רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן, Rabbi Simon Keifa², a saintly person who lived in Rome, as being St. Peter. See S. Rabin and Z.H. Gelberg, “כִּיפָא” in *OY* 10, 182b-83a; also, A.L. Gordon, “Iyyun Tefillah,” in *Siddur Ošar haiTefillot* (1915), 326-27; *Machsor Vitry* 1, 282 and n. 5.

12 The Palestinian first generation Amora רַבִּי יוֹסִי בֶּר פִּיטְרוֹס חֲמוּי דְּרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן לֵוִי, Rabbi Yose ben Petrus the father-in-law of Rabbi Joshua ben Levi (c. 220-50 CE; e.g., y. Mo‘ed Q. 3:5 [13b]). See M. Margalioth, “ר’ יוֹסִי בֶּן פֶּטְרוֹס” in *ETGL* 2, 543.

13 E.g., רַבִּי פֶּטֶר בֶּן יוֹסֵף, Rabbi Peter ben Joseph (Tosaphot b. A.Z. 74b; b. Giṭ. 8a; etc.), martyred during the Second Crusade. Some read פֶּטֶר as Pater (= Father). See I. Broydé, “Peter,” *JE* 9, 656a; M. Ta-Shma, “Petter ben Joseph,” *EJ* 13, 348; E.E. Urbach, *Ba’alei haTosaphot, Toledoteihem, Hibbureihem, Šitatam* (1980), 223-25. פֶּטֶר בֶּן יוֹסֵף, “Rabbi Pesah son of Rabbi Peter,” appears on a gravestone in Buda from the year 1278. Kajfes (= Kaifes) occurs twice in the list of the Jews in Buda during the Turkish occupation from the year 1547. See A. Scheiber, *Jewish Inscriptions in Hungary From the 3rd Century to 1686* (1983), 110-15; also, F. Grünvald and S. Scheiber, eds., *Magyar-Zsidó Oklevéltár* 5, Part 1 (1959), 189. Although the name פֶּטֶר seems to be Greek, it may be Hebrew in origin; e.g., כָּל בְּכוֹר פֶּטֶר רָחֵם מִבְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, “every first-born that opens the womb among the sons of Israel” (Num. 3:12). Rabbenu Peter might have been a first-born son of his mother. Thus, פֶּטֶר, Peter, “first-born of a mother,” is like the name בְּכוֹר, Bekhor, “first-born”; cf. the name of the tosaphist Rabbi Joseph ben Isaac Bekhor Shor (12th cent.). Bekhor is a common name among Sepharadi Jews.

(the) Sacakah" — ALLEGRO^{pr}: "in the entrance towards the East and to Secakah" (i.e., בבִּיאַת הַמִּזְרָח וּלְסַכְכָּא). ALLEGRO: בבִּיאַת הַמִּזְרָח לְסַכְכָּא, "in the eastern road to Secakah"; *biyya'* is the Latin *via*, "road, highway," rather than *biah*, "entrance."¹⁴ Regarding *via*, apparently Allegro relies on Jastrow's explanation of בִּיאַ - בִּיַּא - בִּיה - בִּיַּה - בִּיַּה.¹⁵ ALLEGRO^{rev}: "on the way from Jericho to Secakah" (as Milik).¹⁶ MILIK: בְּבִיאַת מִירְחוֹ לְסַכְכָּא, "coming from Jericho to Sekaka."¹⁷ LURIE: בְּבִיאַת מִזְרָחִי לְסַכְכָּא, "at the entrance (to the grave) from east to Secakah," or according to Milik, "on the way between Jericho toward Secakah."¹⁸ PIXNER (reads as Milik): "on the way from Jericho to Sekakah"; this is the clearest geographical indication in the Scroll.¹⁹ WOLTERS follows Pixner.²⁰ GARCIA MARTINEZ: "in the approach from Jericho to Sekaka."²¹ BEYER (reads as Milik): "when one from Jericho to Sokoka (Qumran) comes (that is, at the crossing of the wadi and the road)."²² VERMES: "(going) from Jericho to Sekhakh," or "at its entry from Jericho to Sekhakh."²³ WILMOT: read מִזְרָחִי and restore the phrase as, בְּקִבְרִי, >ה< מִזְרָחִי בְּנַחַל הַכַּפָּא בְּבִיאַת לְסַכְכָּא. WISE: "at the point of entry as you go from Jericho to Secakah."²⁵

בְּבִיאַת (with a *bet*) or כְּבִיאַת (with a *kaf*) consists of the preposition בְּ- or כְּ-, and בִּוא (*Qal* gerund of בִּוא, "to come/go") plus a *he* (third pers. sg. poss. suffix, fem. or archaic masc.). It can be vocalized as בְּבִיאַת or כְּבִיאַת; e.g., וַיְהִי כְּבִיאַתָּה vs. וַיְהִי בְּבִיאַתָּה, "and when she came" (Josh. 15:18 and 1 Kgs 14:5, respectively).²⁶ However, בְּבִיאַת (כְּבִיאַת) is in apposition to נַחַל הַכַּפָּא, and נַחַל is masculine, therefore, the *he* must be the archaic masculine suffix -ה, i.e., בְּבִיאַת = בְּבִיאַת or כְּבִיאַת = כְּבִיאַת, "as it (masc.) comes/goes" (see #13, 3:9).

14 Allegro, 41, 144-47 n. 97, 149 n. 118.

15 Jastrow, 158a-59b. Kohut derives בִּיַּא - בִּיה from βίος, *Lebensunterhalt*, "livelihood" (AC 2, 45). Also see I. Wartski, "שימושי המילים היווניות בִּיַּה, בִּי, בִּי," in his *Lešon ham-Midrašim* (1970), 190-210.

16 Allegro^{rev}, 23.

17 Milik, 289-90, 240 C-28, 252 C-131, 262 D-2, 263 D-7, 264 D-12; Milik^E, 140, 147.

18 Lurie, 89.

19 Pixner, 348 and n. 24.

20 Wolters, 40-41.

21 Garcia Martinez, 462.

22 Beyer, 227-28.

23 Vermes, 375 (there is a conglomeration of two readings in the translation; it must be a typographical error).

24 "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," 20.

25 Wise, 194.

26 There are seven cases in the Masoretic Text where the *ketiv* is בְּ-, while the *qeri* is כְּ- (Josh. 4:18, 6:5; Judg. 19:25; 1 Sam. 11:6,9; 2 Sam. 5:24; Esth. 3:4). According to Gordis (143-44), both are appropriate forms.

It is also possible to read בְּבִיָּאָה\בְּבִיָּאָה (with a *yod*), “in (the) entrance” (Allegro¹⁷, Lurie). בְּבִיָּאָה, “entrance,” occurs in the Scroll several times (see #13, 3:9-10). Accordingly, the first part of this item means, “In the grave at the entrance of the Wadi Kefah/Kippah.”

is similar to the phrases: [...אֶלּוּלוּמִן] "in/at/by the canal which com[es/go[es to/from ...]"; and אֶת הַמַּיִם [הַבָּא אֶל סֶכְכָּאֵל סֶכְכָּאֵל] "the water canal [which comes/goes to/from (the)] Secacah" (see #16, 4:3; #21, 5:1). They also resemble the verses: וַיָּבֹא יַעֲקֹב שָׁלֹם עִיר שָׁכֵם אֲשֶׁר בְּאֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן בְּבֵאוֹ מִפְּדַן אֲרָם, "And Jacob came to Salem, the city of Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan, as he came from Paddan-aram" (Gen. 33:18);²⁷ וַיִּשְׁלַח יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֲנָשִׁים מִירֵחוֹ, "And Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai" (Josh. 7:3).

(5:14) 32 חָפוּן־חֶפְזוֹן (= חָפוּר־חֶפְזוֹר) אֲמוֹת שֶׁבַע כֹּכ, “are buried seven cubits (deep) 32 k(arsh of) s(ilver),” or “dig seven cubits (deep, there are) 32 k(arsh of) s(ilver)” — Regarding חָפוּן - חָפוּר, see #12, 3:6; #17, 4:7; for אֲמוֹת, #1, 1:2-3; for כֹּכ, Appendix A.

27 For other interpretations, see *The Living Torah*, 161.

ITEM 25

6:1	[במ]ערת העמוד של שני
6:2	[ה]פתחין צופא מזרח
6:3	[ב]פתח הצפוני חפור
6:4	[א]מות שלוש שמ קלל
6:5	בו ספר אחד תחתו
6:6	ככ 42

- 6:1 [In the c]ave of the pillar of [the] two
 6:2 entrances facing east,
 6:3 [at the] northern entrance there is buried
 6:4 three [c]ubits (deep) a *qalal* (vessel),
 6:5 in it (is) one document, below it
 6:6 (there is) 42 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

These restorations, originally suggested by ALLEGRO in his preliminary reading, are consistent with the readings of the other scholars.

(6:1) **עמוד** (masc.) [במ]ערת העמוד, “[In/at/by the c]ave of the pillar” — **עמד**, “to stand/-rise”). It also occurs in the phrases, **הגדול שבב[חלת]שבב[חלת]**, “in/at/by a/the la[rge] cistern [which in in (the) Ka]helet in/at/by a/the pillar in its northern (section)” (4:1); and **בקר צדוק**, “in/at/by (the) grave of Zadok below the pillar of the exedra” (11:3). Often caves and niches had support pillars. E.g.,

A wall **בין שתי מערות** (which is between two burial niches) or **בין שתי חרות** (between two [burial] caves) ... (if the) uncleanness (is) **תחת העמוד** (under the pillar [supporting the ceiling]) ...” (m. Oh. 6:6).¹

There are additional, although less likely, interpretations. In the Talmud **עמוד** also means “continuous flow, jet of water.”² Accordingly, **המערת העמוד**

¹ See the comments of *Mišnah Aharonah* and *Tif’eret Israel*. Also cf. **בין שני הבתים**, “between the two buildings” (4:6). Regarding **מערה**, see #7, 2:3; #59, 12:8; for **בוך**, #56, 12:2; for **עמוד**, #15, 4:1.

² E.g., **הוא נפיש עמודיה ... דנפיש עמודיה**, “that does not have a large jet ... that has a

could mean, “In the ritual bath of the water jet.”

The Midrash and Talmud refer to the city of **בֵּית אָוֶן**, Beth-aven (i.e., House of Falsehood), as **בֵּית הָעֶמֶד**, “dung house.”³ Thus, **בְּמַעְרַת הָעֶמֶד** (= **הָעֶמֶד**) could mean, “In/at/by the dung cave.” The *waw* may represent a Tiberian *qamas*; cf. **הַבּוֹאֹת** for **הַבָּאוֹת** (see #1, 1:2).

עַמּוּדָא, the Aramaic equivalent of the Hebrew **הָעֶמֶד**, is a place name; **פּוּנְדֵקָא דְּעַמּוּדָא פּוּנְדֵקָא דְּרִטִּיבְתָא**, “Pundeqa’ de‘Ammuda’, Pundeqa’ deRetivta’,” literally “the inn of the pillar, the green inn” (y. Dem. 2:1 [6a]). According to Jastrow, these inns were located near Caesarea in Palestine.⁴ Thus, **בְּמַעְרַת הָעֶמֶד** could mean, “In/at/by the cave/ritual bath of ‘Ammud,” or “In/at/by the cave/ritual bath (located in) ‘Ammud.”

(6:1-3) **שְׁלֹשִׁי שְׁנֵי פִתְחִין ... [בְּ]פִתְחַת הַצְּפוֹנִי** (6:1-3) “of [the] two entrances ... [in/at/by the] northern entrance” — **פִּתְחִים** is the plural of **פֶּתַח** (masc.), “opening, entrance, gate” (BH, MH; see #4, 1:11). This cave had two entrances. Similarly, some chambers and compartments of the Temple of Jerusalem also had two entrances or gates. E.g.,

All chambers of the Temple ... except the chamber of wine and oil, because it has **שְׁנֵי פִתְחִים** (two entrances), one across the other ... Rabbi Judah says, all chambers of the Temple that have **שְׁנֵי פִתְחִים** (two entrances), one across the other, like the gates of the Temple compartments ... (t. Yoma 1:3).

Finally, **שְׁנֵי הַפִּתְחִין** may be an idiom for a certain measurement, a distance between two entrances. E.g.,

Rav Hīsa said, “One should always enter **שְׁנֵי פִתְחִים** (two entrances) into the Synagogue.” (The Gemara asks,) What do you mean by **שְׁנֵי פִתְחִים** (two entrances)? Rather say, (One must enter into the Synagogue) **שִׁיעוּר שְׁנֵי פִתְחִים** (the distance of two entrances), and then pray (b. Ber. 8a).⁵

(6:2) **צוּפָא צוּפָא מְזוֹרָח** — **צוּפָה** (masc.) and **צוּפָה** (fem.) mean “he/she/it faces” (*Qal* act. part. sg. from the root **צָפָה**, “to watch, face, see, look”).⁶ If

large jet” (b. ‘A.Z. 73a). See Jastrow, 1087a; AC 6, 213b; KS 2, 185.

³ Gen. Rabbah, 39:15 (referring to Josh. 7:2); cf. y. Shab. 9:1 [33b]; y. ‘A.Z. 3:6 [16a]. See Jastrow, 281b, 1086b; AC 6, 213b-14a; ESh^{dic} 5, 1943a; *He‘Arukh*, 188a, 210. Krupnik - Silbermann (2, 185a) list among the meanings of **עֶמֶד**, “fecal mass, jet of urine.”

⁴ Jastrow, 1087a, 1471b.

⁵ See also *Machzor Vitry* 1, 14, and note **ת** by the editor S. Hurwitz. According to the Halakhah, if one enters a Synagogue, **שְׁעוּר הַיְשִׁיבָה כְּרִי הַלֵּוֹךְ בְּ פִתְחִים**, “the required minimum amount one must sit (i.e., remain) is (the time it takes) to walk (the distance of) two entrances” (Rema in *Šulḥan ‘Arukh* — *Orah Ḥaim*, 151:2). The measurement of “two entrances” is equal to “eight handbreaths” (*Mišnah Berurah*, ad loc.).

⁶ **צָפָה** is a third radical *he* verb. **צוּפָה** (fem.), “she watches,” appears once in the Masoretic Text (Prov. 31:27). Cf. **הִמָּה** (masc., Jer. 4:19), **הוּמָה** (fem., 1 Kgs 1:41), and

צופא refers to מערה (fem., "cave"), i.e., the cave is facing east, then it should be vocalized as צופה; if it refers to עמוד (masc., "pillar"), i.e., the pillar is facing east," then it should be vocalized as צופה.

צופא occurs in an additional six places in the Scroll, where it is prefixed by the definite article.⁷ In all seven cases צפא is always followed by a direction (once prefixed with the preposition *lamed*). Cf. אפך כמגדל הלבנון צופה פני, דמשק, "your face/nose is like the tower (masc.) of Lebanon facing (masc.) toward Damascus" (Songs 7:5).⁸

The following table presents the seven cases of צופא in the Scroll.⁹

מזרח	צופא	[במ]ערת העמוד של שני [ה]פתחין	6:1-2
מערב בדרום	הצופא	בשלף של השוא	8:10-11
צפון	הצופא	בצריח	8:11-12
מזרח	הצופא	בצריח	9:4-5
ים	הצופא	בצריחי החורון ברוח	9:7
מערב	הצופא	בתבסת ראש הסלע	11:5
למזרח	הצופא	במערא של הבנא של רגב	6:7-9

Finally, since צפה is a rarely used verb in Biblical and Mishnaic Hebrew, as well as in Aramaic, it is very interesting that it appears seven times in the Scroll.¹⁰

(6:4) שם קלל, "there (is) a *qalal* vessel" — The term שם, "there," appears in additional two places in the Scroll: שם שני דודינוֹדִינ, "there (are) two two pots" (see #17, 4:8); and שם קלל <י> כסף, "there (are) silver vessels" (see

הוקיָה (fem., Isa. 22:2), "he/she/it uproars" (from the root המה, "to uproar"); also שחורִיָא in the Scroll may be a variant of שחורה (fem.), "black" (see #47, 10:9).

⁷ Beyer (227) emends the first case to צופא <ו>.

⁸ Also, "צופה הייתי" (I used to watch or I watched) Rabban Gamaliel and Rabbi Joshua" (m. Suk. 3:9); "(Scripture says,) 'And it was a man מן הרמתים צופים' (from Ramathaim-zophim; 1 Sam. 1:1) ... Rabbi Samuel ben Nahmani said, 'A man who comes מִשְׁתִּי רְמוֹת שֶׁל צופים (from two hills that are facing) one another'" (b. Meg. 14a); in the Targumim, וְהָאֵלֶּה הֵיִא, "which is facing upon the desert" (Frag.), and הָאֵלֶּה הֵיִא, "and behold, it is facing upon the desert" (TN, Num. 21:20); also in the Samaritan Targumim (J and A, Gen. 31:49). See AC 7, 32b-33b; "Iyyunim," 129 and n. 22; Thorion, 171-72; A. Tal, *The Samaritan Targum of the Pentateuch* (1983), pt. 3, 63.

⁹ P. Muchowski discusses these cases in his article, "Language of the Copper Scroll in the Light of the Phrases Denoting the Directions of the World," *Methods of Investigation of the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Qumran Site* (1994), 323.

¹⁰ There is a second root for צפהⁱⁱ, "to cover," its verbal forms occurs 47 times in the Masoretic text; e.g., צפה זהב, "covered with gold" (Exod. 36:34; 1 Kgs 6:15,22,30; 2 Kgs 18:16). However, both roots may actually be the same (cf. Mandelkern 2, 1001d). In the Masoretic text the verbal forms of צפהⁱ occurs 36 times, while its synonym, ראה, "to see," 1299 times.

(masc.) vessel in which there is סִפֶּר אֶחָד (masc.), “one document/book” or “one Torah scroll.”¹⁶ Cf. וּסְפָרִין אֶל הַכֵּלִין, “and there are documents/books in/among/upon the vessels” (סְפָרִים is the plural of סִפֶּר, see #33, 8:1). In addition, כְּתָב, a synonym of סִפֶּר, also occurs in the Scroll: מִשְׁנֵא הַכְּתָב הַזֶּה, “a copy of this document” (12:11); כְּתָב חֲרָת עַל הָאֶבֶן, “an engraved script upon the stone” (8:4); and in the reading suggested by Sarfati, כְּתָבָן אֶצְלָמוֹן (see Appendix E).

The preposition תַּחַת (BH, MH), “under, below, beneath,” appears in the Scroll twenty times (plus once in a reconstructed text, 5:2). Since תַּחַת usually takes plural suffixes, תַּחַתוֹ must be a defective for תַּחְתָּיו, “under it (masc.); e.g., תַּחְתָּו (ketiv) vs. תַּחְתָּיו (qeri, e.g., 2 Sam. 2:23);¹⁷ cf. שׁוּלּוֹ (in the Scroll) vs. שׁוּלָיו (Exod. 28:33; Isa. 6:1), “its (masc.) rim” (see #38, 9:1); also, 17 תַּחְתֵּיהָ כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב כֹּכ, “below it (fem., there are) 17 *kk* silver and/or gold” (see #34, 8:6-7).

42 בּוֹ סִפֶּר אֶחָד תַּחְתָּו כֹּכ is ambiguous, it could mean: (1) The document is in the *qalal* vessel, and below the *qalal* vessel there is 42 karsh of silver. (2) There are 42 karsh of silver under the document, and both are in the *qalal* vessel. Many scrolls found in the Qumran caves were hidden in earthen vessels. One can speculate that this item refers to such scroll. Moreover, there is a theory that the Qumran caves were actually *genizah* deposits (see Introduction; #2, 1:5; #33, 8:3; #54, 11:9).

The phrase שְׁמֵ קָלָל בּוֹ סִפֶּר אֶחָד, “three (is) a *qalal* (vessel), in it (is) one document,” shows that there is no need to indicate אֶחָד (masc.) or אֶחָת (fem.), “one,” after a singular common noun, it is understood (see #1, 1:3). Regarding כֹּכ, see Appendix A.

¹⁶ Cf. Allegro, 149-50 n. 127.

¹⁷ According to Gordis (86-92), in these cases the *qeri* forms guide against erroneous readings of defective spellings.

ITEM 26

במערא של הבנא	6:7
של הרגמ הצופא	6:8
למזרח חפר בפתח	6:9
אמות תשע ככ 21	6:10

- 6:7 In the cave of the builder
 6:8 of the sepulcher which is facing
 6:9 toward east, (there) are buried by the entrance
 6:10 nine cubits (deep) 21 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

(6:7-8) **בַּמְעָרָא בְּמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבִּנָּא שֶׁל הָרְגָמֵי הָרֶגֶב**, “In/at/by a/the cave of the builder of the sepulcher/ditch/Regeb” — ALLEGRO^{pr}: “In the cave of The Teeth of the stone (heap ?)” (i.e., **של הכנא של הרגב**). ALLEGRO: **במערא של הפנא של הרגב**, “In the inner chamber of the corner of the watchtower”; read **הפנא**, rather than **הבנא**, “the apparent upper stroke of the third letter is a slip of the stylus.” ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the cavity at the base of the watchtower.”¹ MILIK: **במערא של הכנא של רגם**, “In the Cave of the Rock Base.”² LURIE: **במערא של הפנא של הרגב**, “In the cave which is at the corner of the clod.”³ THORION: It is difficult to understand Milik’s reading of **של הרגם של הכנא**.⁴ WISE follows Lurie, while the other scholars agree with Milik.⁵

Both the absolute **שֶׁל בְּמַעְרָא** and the construct **בְּמַעְרַת** mean, “in (the) cave of” (see #7, 2:3; #59, 12:8).

The third word in the drawings differ. BAKER^{dr} and MILIK^{dr}: **הכנא, הבנא**, or **הכנא**. ALLEGRO^{dr}: **הבבא** or **הבכא**; the upper right hand of the ’alef is connected with an almost horizontal line to the previous letter, which resembles a *bet/kaf*. This problematic word defines **מַעְרָה**.

Since often in the Scroll *mem* and *bet* are indistinguishable, the next two words can be read either as **שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב** (masc.), “of the clod (of earth), ditch,

1 Allegro, 43, 150 nn. 130-32; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

2 Milik, 290-91, 240 C-24, 248 C-99, 264 D-14; Milik^E, 140.

3 Lurie, 92.

4 Thorion, 171.

5 Wise, 194; Pixner, 349; Wolters, 42-43; Garcia Martinez, 462; Beyer, 229-30;

grave, Regeb, Argab (toponyms),” and even “the Negeb” (i.e., Dry Land, or South Land, south of Palestine, a *nun-reš* interchange), or *שֶׁל הָרֶגֶם* (masc.), “of the grave, sepulcher.” In addition, *שֶׁל הָרֶגֶם* and *שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב*, “of the ...,” are practically the same as *שְׁבָרָגָם* and *שְׁבָרָגָב*, “which is in the ...,” respectively (–הּ *של* and –בּ *של* are interchangeable; see #20, 4:13). *הָרֶגֶם* – *הָרֶגֶב* occurs earlier in the Scroll; for a detailed discussion, see #23, 5:9.

The following are possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations of this difficult phrase.

בְּמַעְרָאֵבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבְּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶם הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the cave of the builder of the sepulcher/ditch/Regeb/Negeb” — *בְּנָא* = *בּוֹנֵה* (*Qal* act. part. masc. third pers. sg. of the root *בנה*, “to build”; also used as a noun), plus a final *’alef-he* interchange. Cf. *וַיְהִי בְנֵה עֵיר*, “and (Cain) became a city builder” (Gen. 4:17); *הַבּוֹנֵה בְּשָׁמַיִם מַעְלֵיתוֹ*, “He who builds His upper chambers in the heavens” (Amos 9:6); *כִּי בְנֵי הַגּוֹלָה בּוֹנִים הַיְכָל לַיהוָה*, “that the sons of the exile are building a Sanctuary for the Lord” (Ezra 4:1); *אָבָא יוֹסֵף הַבְּנָאִי*, “Abba Joseph the builder” (Exod. Rabbah 13).

This suggestion resembles the following inscriptions. *זו אַרְוֹנוֹ שְׁלִרְבִּי הִלֵּיל*, “This is the coffin of Rabbi Hillel, the son of Rabbi Levi, who made this burial cave,” a Hebrew funeral inscription from Beth She‘arim from the Tannaic period.⁶ *סִימון בְּנָא* (= סִימון בְּנָא הַכֹּהֵן), “Simon (who) built the Sanctuary,” a double Aramaic funeral inscription from Givat Hamivtar north of Jerusalem from the late Second Temple period.⁷ *בְּנָה וְהִקְדִּישׁ* (= *בְּנָא וַאֲיָקֶדֶשׁ ת עֲכַסְנִדְרַע*), “he built and consecrated the exedra,” a Neo-Punic inscription, probably from the second century CE (*KAI* 1, 25; 2, 133 [#129:1]). In addition, the paleography and the spelling of first two inscriptions are similar to that of the Copper Scroll. In the the first inscription *לוי* is spelled with double *waw*, cf. *אשווה* (see #22, 5:5-6); the second inscription has a regular *nun* in the final position, and the *bet* can hardly be distinguished from a *kaf*.

בְּמַעְרָאֵבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבְּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by the cave of (the) Bunah/-Habbunah of (or which is in) the Regeb/Negeb” — *בְּנָא* = *בּוֹנֵה*, *Bunah*, is a personal name (e.g., 1 Chron. 2:25). *בְּנָא* may be related to *בְּנוֹי* (e.g., Neh. 3:24), *בּוּנִי*, *Bunni* (Neh. 9:4, 10:16), *בְּנֵיָה*, *Benaiah* (e.g., Ezek. 11:1; 2 Sam. 23:22), and to *בְּנָאָה*; e.g.,

Rabbi *בְּנָאָה* (Bannaah) used to mark *מַעְרָתָא* (burial caves). As he approached *מַעְרָתָא דְאַבְרָהָם* (the burial cave of Abraham)” (b. B.B. 58a).⁸

Vermes, 375.

⁶ *Beth She‘arim* 3, 162, 251-52 (Sarcophagus no. 89 — Inscription no. 28).

⁷ V. Tzaferis, “קבורת שמעון בונה ההיכל,” in *Qadmoniot* 1 (1968), 137-38; the article includes two photographs; “Crucifixion — The Archaeological Evidence,” *BAR* 11 (1985), 50; J. Naveh, “כתובת-קבר חדשה מגבעת-המיבתר,” in *Qadmoniot* 6 (1973), 113f.

Occasionally personal names are prefixed with the definite article. E.g., בְּנֵי הַסִּפְרֶת, “the sons of Hassophereth” or “the sons of the Sophereth” (Ezra 2:55; see Ibn-Ezra), vs. בְּנֵי סִפְרֶת, “the sons of Sophereth” (Neh. 7:57), יוֹחָנָן בֶּן הַקָּטָן, “Johanan son of Hakkatan” or “Johanan son of the Katan” (Ezra 8:12), הַקּוֹץ, Hakkoz or “the Koz” (1 Chron. 24:10), vs. קוֹץ, Koz (1 Chron. 4:8; see #30, 7:9).

בְּמַעְרָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבֵּנָא (= הַפְּנָא) שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the cave of the corner (tower) of (or which is in) the Regeb/Negeb/ditch” — הַפְּנָא הַבֵּנָא for הַסְּבִיִן, “the corner (tower)” (*bet-pe* interchange; cf. Allegro, Lurie); cf. הַסְּבִיִן, “the thresholds” (see #53, 11:8). Regarding פְּנָא, see #12, 3:1.

בְּמַעְרָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַכְּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the cave of the (Village) Kanah which is in the Regeb/Negeb” — Cf. כְּפַר כְּנָא, Kafr Kanna, an Arab village in the Galilee, 6.5 km. northeast of Nazareth.⁹ Its name implies that originally it was called כְּפַר כְּנָאוּה, Kefar Kannah. Also cf. כְּנָה, Canneh (Ezek. 27:23), the same as כַּלְנֶה Calneh (Gen. 10:10; Amos 6:2), a city in northwest Mesopotamia. Moreover, כְּנָא could be a variant of קְנָה, Kanah, a city in Asher (Josh. 19:28); also cf. נַחַל קְנָה, “brook of Kanah” (Josh. 16:8, 17:9), between Ephraim and Menasseh (*kaf-qof* interchange).

בְּמַעְרָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל חֲכִנָּא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the (burial) cave of (the) snake/Hakhinah which is in the Regeb/Negeb” — חֲכִנָּא = חֲכִנָּאוּה means “snake”; e.g., כְּאִרְסָה שֶׁל חֲכִנָּה, “like a venom of a snake” (Ruth Rabbah 6:4). In addition, חֲכִנָּא, Hakhinah, may be a personal name; cf. רַבִּי חֲנַנְיָה בֶּן רַבִּי חַנְיָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבֵּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the cave of the drain which is in the Regeb/Negeb/ditch” — הַבֵּנָא = הַבֵּינָא, “the drain” (cf. Allegro); cf. בְּבִיבְאִיבְבִיבָא, “in a/the drain” (12:8). בִּיבָאוּה is a rarely used feminine form of the masculine בֵּיב (see #42, 9:11).

בְּמַעְרָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבֵּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב, “In/at/by a/the cave of the drain which is in the Regeb/Negeb/ditch” — הַבֵּנָא = הַבֵּינָא, “the drain” (cf. Allegro); cf. בְּבִיבְאִיבְבִיבָא, “in a/the drain” (12:8). בִּיבָאוּה is a rarely used feminine form of the masculine בֵּיב (see #42, 9:11).

בְּמַעְרָאִיבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַבֵּנָא שֶׁל הָרֶגֶב (Allegro^{dr}), “In the cave of the baca-tree which is in the Regeb/Negeb,” or “In the cave of lament which is in the sepulcher/Regeb/Negeb” — בָּכָא, “baca,” is a tree, perhaps mulberry or balsam (2 Sam. 5:23-24; 1 Chron. 14:14-15); cf. עֲמֻק הַבָּכָא, Valley of the Baca-tree (Ps. 84:7, see Ibn-Ezra and *Mešudat David*). However, according to the Targum, Rashi, etc., the latter means “Depth of the Lament” or Gehenna; i.e., equating בָּכָא with בָּכִי (masc.), “cry, lament”; e.g., וַיִּבְכוּ בָכִי, “and they wept (in) a loud cry” (Judg. 21:2).¹⁰

8 Also spelled as רַבִּי בַנָּאִי (Rabbi Bannai, b. Ket. 50b), and רַבְּבָנָאִי (Rabbanai, b. Ber. 38b; b. B.M. 2a).

9 Its church was built on the ruins of a Byzantine synagogue, as suggested by the remains of two Aramaic inscriptions. Jews lived in this village from the Second Temple era till the 16th century. It is considered a holy city by the Christians. See SY, 93b; M. Avi-Yonah, “Kefar Kanna,” *EJ* 10, 887; “כפר-כנא” in *EH* 20, 1003-04.

10 From the Middle Ages on the term עֲמֻק הַבָּכָא, “Valley of the Cry/Lament,” has been used by Jews to describe the atrocities committed against them by the rulers of the host-

בְּמַעְרָאִבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַכָּא שֶׁל הָרְגְמוֹהָרְגְב (Allegro^{dr}), “In the cave of the burial niche of (or which is in) the sepulcher/Regeb/Negeb/ditch” — כָּא = כּוּכָה is an unattested feminine form of כּוּיֶכּוֹךְ (masc., MH), “burial niche,” that may appear in the Scroll several times (see #56, 12:2-3; #59, 12:9).

בְּמַעְרָאִבְמַעְרָא שֶׁל הַכָּא שֶׁל הָרְגְמוֹהָרְגְב (cf. Allegro^{pr}), “In the cave of the molar (or peak) of (or which is in) the sepulcher/Regeb/Negeb/clod/ditch” — In Aramaic כָּא is a synonym of שִׁינָא, “(the) tooth” (same as the Hebrew הַשֵּׁן); e.g., כְּכִיָּה וְשִׁינֵיהָ פּוּמִיָּה, “his molar(s) and his tooth/teeth (of) his mouth” (PsJ Num. 21:35).¹¹ שֶׁל הַכָּא שֶׁל הָרְגְב, “of the molar of the clod,” could mean “of the peak of the clod,” the same way as בְּשֵׁן הַסֵּלַע, “in/at/by the tooth of the rock,” means “at the peak of the rock” (see #10, 2:11; Appendix A).

(6:8-9) הַצּוֹפָאִה צוֹפָא לְמִזְרָח־לְמִזְרָח, “which is facing (masc./fem.) toward (the) east” — If this phrase refers to the feminine מַעְרָה, it should be vocalized as הַצּוֹפָה (fem.), i.e., the cave is facing east. If it refers to רֶגֶם or רֶגֶב (both masculine), then it should be vocalized as הַצּוֹפָה (masc.), i.e., the sepulcher or clod is facing east. Regarding צוֹפָא, see #25, 6:2; for geographical directions, see #4, 1:11; #10, 2:10; #14, 3:11-12; #19, 4:11.

(6:9-10) 21 כְּכִיָּה בְּפִתְחוֹתֵי אֲמוֹת תִּשַׁע כֹּכ, “(there) are buried by an/the entrance nine cubits (deep) 21 k(arsh of) s(ilver),” or “dig by an/the entrance nine cubits (deep, there are) 21 k(arsh of) s(ilver)” — חֲפֹר is a defective spelling of חֲפֹרִי, “hidden,” or חֲפֹר, “dig” (see #12, 3:6; #17, 4:7). Cf. בְּ[פִתְחוֹתֵי] אֲמוֹת תִּשַׁע חֲפֹרִי, “[in the] northern entrance is buried/dig three [c]ubits (deep)” (see #25, 6:3). Regarding פֶּתַח, see #4, 11; for כֹּכ, Appendix A.

Finally, WILMOT unnecessarily changes the word order of חֲפֹר בְּפִתְחוֹת אֲמוֹת תִּשַׁע into חֲפֹר אֲמוֹת תִּשַׁע.¹²

countries, by their inhabitants, as well by their enemies. The most famous one is, רַב לָךְ שָׁבַת, “It is long enough for you (i.e., Jews) dwelling in the Valley of the Lament (i.e. Diaspora),” in the liturgical poem לְכָה רוּרִי by the Kabbalist Rabbi Solomon Alkabets (16th cent.), which is being sung Friday evening in all Synagogues.

11 Jastrow (638a) suggests that כָּא is a collective noun, i.e., “molars.” Regarding כָּא, see Appendix A.

12 “David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll,” 20.

ITEM 27

במשכן המלכא בצד 6:11
 המערבי חפר אמות 6:12
 שתימ עסרה ככ 27 6:13

6:11 In the Tomb of the Queen, at the western
 6:12 side, are buried twelve
 6:13 cubits (deep) 27 k(arsh of) s(ilver).

COMMENTARY

(6:11) **בְּמִשְׁכַּן הַמֶּלֶכָּא**, “In/at/by the tomb/dwelling of the queen” — ALLEGRO^r: “In the Counselor’s tomb (or dwelling, tabernacle).” ALLEGRO: “In the Tomb (?) of the Queen.” **מִשְׁכָּן**, “dwelling,” in Isa. 22:16 means “tomb.” This could refer to palace of Solomon’s Egyptian queen (1 Kgs 9:24), or to Queen Helena of Adiabene’s palace (JW V vi 1, § 253; VI vi 3, § 355) or mausoleum (JW V ii 2, §55; V iii 3, §119), etc. ALLEGRO^{rev}: “In the Tomb of the Queen.”¹ MILIK: “In the Abode of the Queen”; it is probably a mausoleum in the region of Jericho, rather than the tomb of Helena of Adiabene (Qubur Muluk), to the north of Jerusalem.² LURIE: “In the Tomb (or residence) of the Queen.” Although once **משכן** is parallel with **קבר** (Isa. 22:16), the text probably refers to a palace of Queen Salome Alexandra (r. 76-67 BCE).³ SHARVIT: **משכן**, “tomb.”⁴ PIXNER: Like Milik. The toponyms, “the Abode of the Queen” (6:11) and the “Fording of the Highpriest” (6:14-7:1) must be located in the vicinity of Herodian Jericho.⁵ WOLTERS: “In the Queen’s Residence.”⁶ BEYER: “In the resting place of the Queen.”⁷ GARCIA MARTINEZ: “In the queen’s residence.”⁸ VERMES: In the Dwelling of the Queen.⁹ WISE: “In the Queen’s Mausoleum.”¹⁰

מִשְׁכָּן (masc., from the root **שכן**, “to dwell, camp,” with a prefixed loca-

1 Allegro, 43, 150 nn. 135-36; Allegro^{rev}, 23.

2 Milik, 291, 249 C-110, 258 C-206, 264 D-15; Milik^E, 140, 148.

3 Lurie, 92-92 and n. 1.

4 “Iyyunim,” 130.

5 Pixner, 349 and n. 26.

6 Wolters, 42-43.

7 Beyer, 227-28.

8 Garcia Martinez, 462.

9 Vermes, 376.

tive *mem*) means “dwelling place.”¹¹ Its synonym מִשְׁכָּב (masc., from the root שכב, “to lie down,” with a prefixed locative *mem*), “resting place,” also appears in the Scroll (see #57, 11:16). מִשְׁכָּן (const. מִשְׁכָּנִי, pl. מִשְׁכָּנוֹת, const. pl. מִשְׁכָּנִי, מִשְׁכָּנוֹת) occurs 140 times in the Masoretic Text (once in Aramaic, Ezra 7:15). It usually refers to the Tabernacle (e.g., Exod. 25:9) or to the Temple (e.g., Ps. 43:3), i.e., Dwelling of the Lord, while occasionally it means “dwelling” of certain people, such as מִשְׁכָּן קֹרַח, “the dwelling of Korah” (Num. 16:24, 16:27); מִשְׁכָּנוֹת עוֹל, “dwellings of the wickedness” (Job 18:21); מִשְׁכָּנוֹת הָרָעִים, “dwellings of the shepherds” (Songs 1:8). Once in the Masoretic Text קֶבֶר, “grave,” and מִשְׁכָּן are parallel words, where clearly מִשְׁכָּן refers to a tomb.

What do you have here (Shebna)? Whom do you have here, קֶבֶר, “grave” (that you have cut out a grave here for yourself)? חֲצַבִּי מְרוֹם קֶבֶר (Cutting on height his grave), חֲקִקִי בַּסֵּלֶעַ מִשְׁכָּן לוֹ (carving in the rock a dwelling for him)? (Isa. 22:16).¹²

The term מַלְכָּה (const. מַלְכָּת, pl. מַלְכוֹת), “queen,” is the feminine form of מֶלֶךְ (pl. מַלְכִּים, const. מַלְכִּי), “king” (from the root מָלַךְ, “to counsel, lead, rule”). In the Masoretic Text מֶלֶךְ occurs 2518 times in Hebrew and 180 times in Aramaic.¹³ However, מַלְכָּה only 35 times, and twice מַלְכָּתָא (“the queen”) in Aramaic (Dan. 5:10). This ratio of less than 1.5 percent indicates that the queens were essentially behind the scene in the political, religious, and public life. Therefore, to find in the Scroll the term מַלְכָּה, but not מֶלֶךְ, is unique. Obviously, “the queen’s dwelling” may refer either to a palace or to a tomb. Based on the nomenclature of the Scroll where many burial sites are listed, both מִשְׁכָּן and מִשְׁכָּב seem to refer to a “tomb.” In addition, if one intends to hide valuable objects, he will not bury them in a palace, but rather

10 Wise, 194.

11 The cognates of שָׁכַן are: *šakanu*, “to set, lay, set up a dwelling, etc.” (Akkadian); שכנ (Canaanite and Ugaritic); שכין (Aramaic); *sakana*, “rest, dwell” (Arabic). שָׁכַן may be an old *šaf’el* form of the root כּוּן, “stand upright, raise, prepare” (see J.A. Soggin, *Old Testament and Oriental Studies* [1975], 144).

12 Allegro and Lurie mention this verse. The motives and advises of שֶׁבְנָא עַל הַבַּיִת, “Shebna, the Palace Overseer” to King Hezekiah is discussed in the Talmud (e.g., b. San. 26a-b). See S.I. Schönfeld, “שֶׁבְנָא (שבנה)” in *OY* 10, 39. A sepulcher with an inscription of three lines on its faced was discovered in the Village of Siloam. The beginning of the first line has been reconstructed as, [קֶבֶרֶת שֶׁבְנָא] הוּא אֲשֶׁר עַל הַבַּיִת, “This is [the tomb of Shebna] the Palace Manager,” on the base of Isa. 22:15-16. See E.Y. Kutscher, “כתובת ‘שֶׁבְנָא’” in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* (1977), 170-71; N. Shupak, “Shebna,” *EJ* 14, 1329-30. However, according to the prophesy of Isaiah, Shebna had to die in the Diaspora (Isa. 22:17-19; see Rashi, Radak, and *Mešudat David*). Thus, this tomb cannot contain the remains of Shebna, yet it is possible that it was prepared by him.

13 The Aramaic forms are: מַלְכָּא (abs.), מַלְכָּתָא (emph.), “(the) queen”; מֶלֶךְ (abs.), מַלְכָּא (emph.), “(the) king”; pl. מַלְכִּין (abs.), מַלְכִּיָּא (emph.), “(the) kings,” etc.

in a tomb. As often in the Scroll, much information is withheld. Thus, **מִשְׁכָּן הַמֶּלֶכָּה** could refer to either an unnamed or to a well known queen's tomb or dwelling. One can merely speculate as to whose tomb or palace the compiler(s) had in mind. Any of the suggestions of Allegro, Milik, and Lurie are feasible.

Finally, **בְּמִשְׁכָּן הַמֶּלֶכָּה**, "in the tomb of the queen," brings to mind the double inscription found on a sarcophagus in the Tombs of the Kings near Jerusalem that reads **צדה מלכתה** in Aramaic script and **צדן מלכתא** in Syriac script, "Sedah/Sedan the Queen" (*'alef-he*, as well as final-*he*-final-*nun* interchanges). These inscriptions may refer to **הַמֶּלֶכָּה הַלִּינִי הַלִּינִי**, Queen Helena of Adiabene, who embraced Judaism (c. 30 CE) and later settled in Jerusalem (cf. t. Suk. 1:1).¹⁴

(6:11-12) **בְּצִדוֹ בְּצִד הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "in/at/by the western side" — **צד** occurs in additional two places in the Scroll, and always precedes **הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "the western"; **בְּצִדוֹ הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "in/at/by its (masc.) western side" (10:8), and **מִן הַצֵּד הַמַּעֲרָבִי**, "from/to/on the western side" (10:12-13).

Finally, **בְּצִד הַמַּעֲרָבִי בְּצִד הַמִּלְכָּה**, "In the tomb/dwelling of the queen, at the western side," resembles the biblical phrase **עַל צְדֵי הַמִּשְׁכָּן**, "upon/at the sides of the Tabernacle" (Exod. 26:13).

(6:12-13) 27 **חֲפָרוּ חֲפָר אֲמוֹת שְׁתֵּימ עֶסְרָה כֹּכ**, "are buried twelve cubits (deep) 27 k(arsh of) s(ilver)," or "dig twelve cubits (deep, there are) 27 k(arsh of) s(ilver)" — Regarding **חֲפָר**, see #12, 3:6; #17, 4:7; for **עֶסְרָה**, #38, 9:2; Appendix B; for **כֹּכ**, Appendix A.

14 See E.Y. Kutscher, "הכתובת העברית והארמית בירושלים מימי הבית השני" in *Hebrew and Aramaic Studies* (1977), 351; A. Schalit, "Helena," *EJ* 8, 288-89.

ITEM 28

ביגר שבמגזת הכוהן	6:14
הגדול ח[פור אמות]	7:1
תשע כ[...]	7:2

- 6:14 In the heap, which is at the Bridge of the High
 7:1 Priest, are bu[ried] nine
 7:2 [cubits] (deep) [...] k(arsh of) [s(ilver)].

COMMENTARY

(6:14-7:1) בִּיגֵר־בְּיָגֵר שְׁבִמְגֹזַת הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל, "In/at/by a/the heap, which is at/by the Bridge/Pass of the High Priest" — ALLEGRO^{PT}: "In the heap of stones (or hill) which is in the ford of the Priest." ALLEGRO^{PT}: "In the heap of stones (or hill) which is in the Great Pass of the Priest." ALLEGRO: "In the dam-sluice (?) which is in the Bridge of the High Priest"; if last word is read as הגדולה, then it means, "The Great Bridge of the Priest" (cf. Allegro^{PT}). The reading is מְגִיזָה or מְגִיזָה; etc. The Bridge of the High Priest could connect the Qiphonos Gate (m. Mid. 1:3) with the Hashmonean "king's palace" on the south-west promontory in Jerusalem. It could be located at the Wilson' Arch; etc. ALLEGRO^{REV}: "In the dam (?) which is in the Bridge of the High Priest."¹ MILIK: "In the tumulus which is found at the Ford of the High Priest," probably of the Jordan river. It resembles the crossing of the Jordan by Joshua and Eleazar the High priest (Josh. Chs 3-4). Milik mentions the Targumic מְגִיזָה.² LURIE: "At the earthen dike which is at the ford (in the estate) of the high priest." Lurie, based on the Targumim and Talmud, discusses the term מְגִיזָה. Lurie originally suggests that this bridge was built by Herod to connect his palace with the Temple (similar to Allegro). However, he concludes that that the Scroll refers to an earthen dike at the ford in the estate of the high priest; there the treasures hide the cache of this item.³ PIXNER: "At the stone heap which is at the fording place of the Highpriest." The toponyms, "the Abode of the Queen" (6:11) and the "Fording of the High-priest" must been located in the vicinity of Herodian Jericho.⁴ WOLTERS: "In

1 In Allegro's provisional reading the typewritten translation was corrected both by hand and by typewriter. (There seems to be some scribal errors.) Allegro, 43-44, 150-51 nn. 139-140; Allegro^{REV}, 23.

2 Milik, 290-91, 240 C-29, 258 C-205, 264 D-16; Milik^E, 140.